



INTERNATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY



# *The Olympic Movement and AI: Opportunities and Challenges*



65th

INTERNATIONAL SESSION  
FOR YOUNG OLYMPIC AMBASSADORS

ANCIENT OLYMPIA



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*The Olympic Movement and AI:  
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65th INTERNATIONAL SESSION  
FOR YOUNG OLYMPIC AMBASSADORS

7–19 JUNE 2025

Editor

KONSTANTINOS GEORGIADIS  
Professor, University of the Peloponnese  
Dean, International Olympic Academy

ANCIENT OLYMPIA

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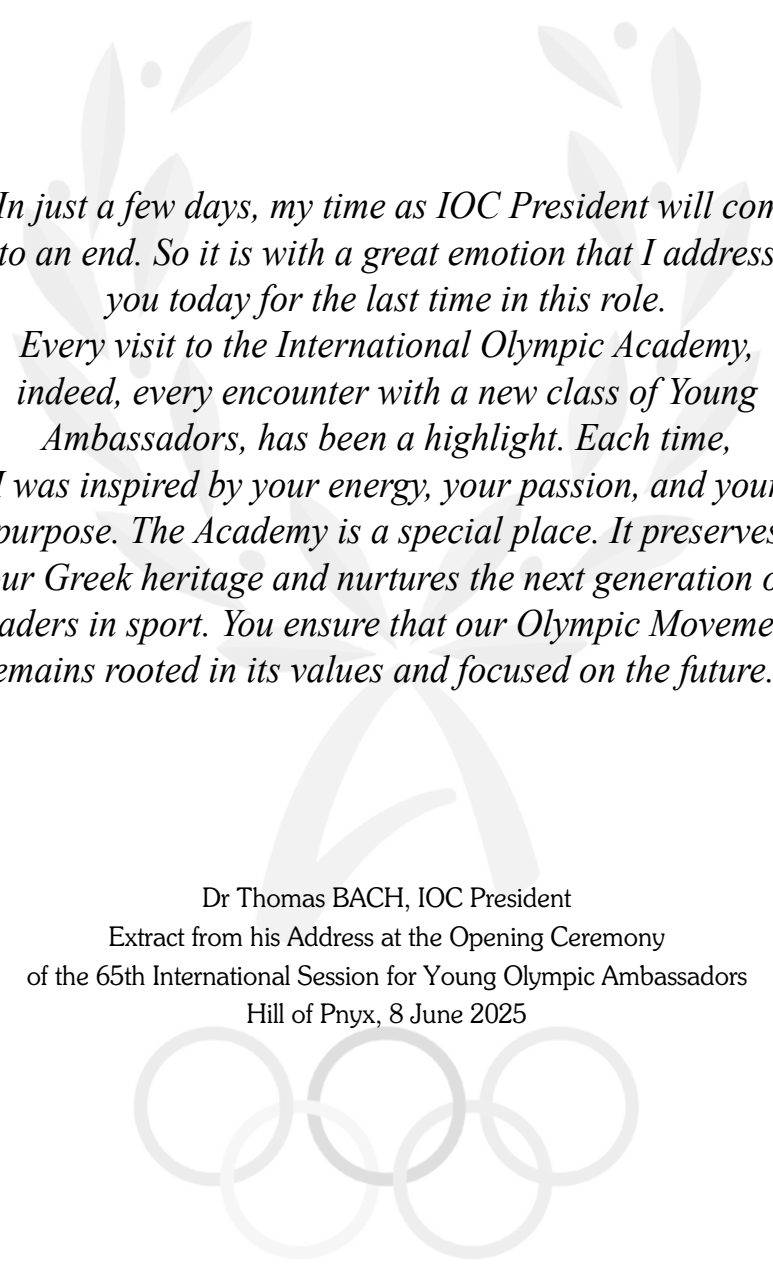
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*“In just a few days, my time as IOC President will come to an end. So it is with a great emotion that I address you today for the last time in this role.*

*Every visit to the International Olympic Academy, indeed, every encounter with a new class of Young Ambassadors, has been a highlight. Each time, I was inspired by your energy, your passion, and your purpose. The Academy is a special place. It preserves our Greek heritage and nurtures the next generation of leaders in sport. You ensure that our Olympic Movement remains rooted in its values and focused on the future.”*

Dr Thomas BACH, IOC President

Extract from his Address at the Opening Ceremony  
of the 65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors  
Hill of Pnyx, 8 June 2025



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## FOREWORD

The International Olympic Academy has, for more than six decades, served as a unique international center for Olympic education, intercultural dialogue and the promotion of the values of Olympism. Through its international Sessions, the Academy cultivates a global educational community in which young people from different cultural, social and academic backgrounds meet in the symbolic environment of Ancient Olympia to exchange ideas, reflect critically on contemporary global issues and strengthen their commitment to peace, human dignity and international understanding through sport.

The 65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors, held in Ancient Olympia from 7 to 19 July 2025, continued this longstanding educational mission with remarkable success. Bringing together 146 participants from 95 countries, supported by lecturers, coordinators and members of the staff of the International Olympic Academy, the Session became a living laboratory of intercultural communication and experiential learning. The thematic orientation of the Session focused on two particularly timely and interconnected subjects: “The Future of Sport” and “Olympic Movement and AI: Opportunities and Challenges.” These themes reflected the growing necessity for the Olympic Movement to respond creatively and responsibly to the rapid technological, social and environmental transformations that characterise contemporary society.

The contemporary world is experiencing profound changes generated by digital innovation, artificial intelligence, environmental crises and shifting cultural identities. Sport, as a universal social institution, is inevitably affected by these developments. Artificial intelligence increasingly influences athletic performance, data analysis, communication strategies, event organisation and educational practices. At the same time, it raises important ethical questions concerning privacy, equality, human autonomy and the preservation of the fundamental values of sport. Within this framework, the Session sought not only to examine the practical applications of technological innovation in sport, but also to encourage critical reflection on the moral responsibilities associated with

these developments. The discussions emphasised that technology must remain human-centred and aligned with the Olympic values of excellence, friendship, respect and peace.

Equally significant was the Session's emphasis on sustainability and global responsibility. In an era marked by climate change and increasing ecological concerns, the Olympic Movement is called upon to serve as a model of environmental awareness and sustainable development. Participants examined how sport organisations, educational institutions and local communities can contribute to ecological responsibility through innovative educational initiatives and environmentally conscious practices. Sustainability was approached not merely as a technical issue, but as a moral obligation toward future generations, closely connected with the broader humanistic philosophy of Olympism.

The educational philosophy underpinning the Session was deeply rooted in the principles of Olympic education. Olympism was presented not simply as a philosophy of sport, but as a comprehensive pedagogical framework that integrates intellectual cultivation, ethical development, social responsibility and intercultural understanding. The lectures, workshops and group discussions highlighted the importance of interdisciplinary and intercultural education capable of fostering empathy, critical thinking and active citizenship among young people. Through experiential learning activities and collaborative dialogue, participants were encouraged to understand Olympism as a dynamic and living philosophy relevant to the challenges of the modern world.

A particularly valuable aspect of the Session was the active participation of the Young Olympic Ambassadors themselves. Coming from diverse national, cultural and educational environments, participants contributed their own experiences and perspectives to the discussions, thereby enriching the educational process through genuine intercultural exchange. The working groups focused on issues such as artificial intelligence, ethics, sustainability, inclusion and social innovation, allowing participants to collaboratively formulate proposals and educational recommendations for the future. These discussions reinforced the understanding that the Olympic Ambassador should function not only as a representative of Olympic values, but also as an active citizen capable of promoting dialogue, solidarity and peaceful coexistence within local and international communities.

The Report confirms the overall success of the Session and demonstrates the high level of participant satisfaction regarding both the academic content and

the organisational structure of the programme. The questionnaire evaluation revealed particularly positive responses concerning the quality of the lectures, the effectiveness of the coordinators, the collaborative atmosphere of the working groups and the opportunities for intercultural communication. Participants emphasised that the Session strengthened their commitment to promoting Olympic values and inspired them to develop educational and social initiatives in their own countries.

This Report therefore constitutes not only a record of the activities and conclusions of the 65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors, but also a reflection of the continuing relevance of the Olympic ideal in the twenty-first century. At a time when societies face growing polarisation, technological uncertainty and environmental challenges, the principles of Olympism continue to offer a powerful educational and cultural framework capable of promoting human dignity, solidarity and peaceful coexistence. The International Olympic Academy, through its international educational activities, remains committed to cultivating these values and to empowering young people to become responsible leaders and active agents of positive social change.

Finally, this publication aims to preserve the educational legacy of the Session and to provide future researchers, educators, Olympic institutions and young leaders with a valuable source of reflection and inspiration. The conclusions and educational proposals included in this Report demonstrate that the new generation of Young Olympic Ambassadors possesses both the willingness and the capacity to contribute meaningfully to the promotion of ethical leadership, intercultural understanding and sustainable development through sport and Olympic education. In this sense, the 65th International Session represents not only a successful educational event, but also an important contribution to the ongoing global dialogue concerning the future of sport, humanity and the Olympic Movement.

Prof. Konstantinos GEORGIADIS  
*University of the Peloponnese*  
*IOA Dean*







# Opening Ceremony

HILL OF PNYX, 8 JUNE 2025





**ADDRESS**  
**by the President of the International Olympic Academy**  
**Professor Charilaos TSOLAKIS**

I welcome you all on behalf of the Ephoria of the International Olympic Academy here at the Pnyx, the birthplace of democracy where great politicians, generals and orators once spoke, inspiring the eternal struggle for equality, freedom, solidarity, and peace. These fundamental values are also recognised as core values of Olympism. They lie at the heart of a philosophy that honours and promotes human dignity, fair participation, mutual respect and the peaceful coexistence of peoples.

As the new President of the International Olympic Academy, I am particularly moved to welcome all of you—young people who have travelled from every corner of the world to spend a few days in the “Mecca of Olympism”, as former IOC President Avery Brundage so aptly described Ancient Olympia.

You represent 102 Olympic Committees and have come to our country to experience first-hand what we call Olympic Culture.

Your purpose here is to reflect on the history and ideals of the Olympic Movement—on the principles handed down to us by its pioneers, who envisioned sport as a powerful means of promoting positive social values, role models, and ideals, and as a vehicle for the education of youth. This mission is more vital than ever today, as we stand at a crossroads of profound change—in a modern society that is constantly reorganising and evolving through technological advances which promise to transform our world as never before.

We are currently witnessing a dramatic, game-changing technological revolution that is setting sport and education on new, innovative paths. The growing integration of artificial intelligence (AI), through its countless applications and tools, is reshaping many aspects of sport—generating both expectations and concerns: expectations because from coaching and refereeing to the fan experience and athlete performance, data will become more extensive and

accurate and will be processed more quickly, thereby upgrading the end result, but also concerns because the use of artificial intelligence undoubtedly raises ethical dilemmas and introduces new risks—risks related to fairness and equality, privacy and consent, but also the integrity of competition.

The real challenge, ladies and gentlemen, is not simply to make athletes faster or stronger, but to preserve the human meaning of effort—the passion, the perseverance, the belief in ourselves. After all, technology cannot replace the value of a dream, the sweat of hard work, or the heartbeat just before making a jump or hearing the whistle blow. And Olympism calls on us to honour precisely that: human authenticity, the “noble emulation” and “the light of truth”.

In the field of education too, the impact of artificial intelligence is undeniable. Yet its use raises significant ethical concerns that must be anticipated and addressed—both to prevent conflict with the foundations of education in general and with Olympic education, which embodies a transformative philosophy of life, in particular.

On the whole, I believe what we need is a convergence of tradition and innovation—a framework that promotes innovation while upholding the values of Olympism. The Olympic Movement, as an institution with deep roots and a timeless vision, now bears the key responsibility of charting the right strategy and establishing appropriate standards to ensure that artificial intelligence is used wisely and responsibly in shaping the future of sport. As IOC President Thomas Bach, who honours us with his presence today, aptly stated, “we must be leaders of change, not the object of change.” Artificial intelligence is a powerful force for transformation, one that must serve the improvement of sport, provided that it is integrated with ethics, moderation and vision. Sport is, and must remain, fundamentally human.

Dear Young People, starting tomorrow, and for the next 10 days, you will be in Ancient Olympia, the birthplace of the Olympic Games, to analyse all of the above issues with the guidance of distinguished personalities from the world of education and the Olympic family. You are truly fortunate to be in an environment that inspires, motivates, and unites—a place where Olympic values prevail and where you will have the opportunity to exchange views, present ideas, and propose solutions to challenges facing sport and society. But you are especially fortunate because you will form new friendships that will last a lifetime, friendships that transcend borders and prejudices, politics and ideologies, coexisting with diverse cultures that share your passion. Thus, you



*The President of the International Olympic Academy, Prof. Charilaos Tsolakis, addressed the distinguished guests.*

will become citizens of the world who will contribute positively to your societies through understanding and promoting the Olympic ideals and the principles of the Olympic Movement. Pierre de Coubertin envisioned sport as a means of spiritual and social uplift, and Olympism as a system of values.

And you, dear participants, in this place where democracy was born, will experience these values firsthand, living in an environment of noble competition, mutual respect, friendship, and free expression. As the former President of the IOC, Juan Antonio Samaranch, characteristically said about Ancient Olympia:

*This is an ideal place to reflect on the evolution of our society.  
We are in a haven of peace and balance, where centuries remain  
engraved on the stones, the meanders of the Alpheus river, the*

*beauty of the vegetation and the serenity that reigns in this unique place, Olympia, where sport began its most glorious and finest course.*

Ladies and Gentlemen, as I conclude my speech, allow me to say that in an age dominated by competition, commercialisation and individualism, the Olympic ideal reminds us that sport can—and must—serve as a means of both spiritual and social uplift. For no matter how far technology advances, the values of Olympism remain unchanged. The human being is and will always be at its centre.

So welcome to the country where faith in the value of the human being as a whole was born! Welcome to Greece!

**ADDRESS**  
**by the President of the International Olympic Committee**  
**Thomas BACH**

It is always such an emotional moment to gather here. With the inspiring backdrop of the Acropolis, what better place than the Hill of Pnyx to reflect on the two great gifts of Greek civilisation to the world: democracy and the Olympic Games—both born here in Greece, and both shaping our world to this very day.

The Olympic Movement is forever grateful to Greece for these precious gifts. Our admiration is even greater when we see how they have stood the test of time. This is why we are so honoured and privileged that the President of the Hellenic Republic, His Excellency Constantinos Tassoulas, is joining us today. Your presence, Mr President, highlights the unique role that Greece plays in the Olympic Movement and shows the continued relevance of our noble Greek heritage.

The Olympic Games have their roots in ancient times. At the same time, the Olympic Games are always about the future. They are intrinsically connected to the youth of the world. Each edition of the Olympic Games is an invitation to the young generation to embrace the timeless Olympic values of peace, excellence, friendship, respect, fair-play and solidarity. As Pierre de Coubertin, the founder of the IOC and renovator of the modern Olympic Games, once said, “The Olympic Games are a pilgrimage to the past and an act of faith in the future.” These words capture the unique nature of the Olympic Movement: a 2,800-year-old institution constantly renewing itself through innovation and youth.

This is why I would like to congratulate the International Olympic Academy, under the leadership of its President Charilaos Tsolakakis, for choosing such a timely theme for this Session: The Olympic Movement and AI: Opportunities and Challenges. This theme reflects the forward-looking spirit of the Olympic Games. It is exactly this faith in the future that explains why the Olympic Games

have always embraced innovation. The power of the Olympic Games is their universality. So, what better platform to explore how artificial intelligence can transform society and how it must be guided by human values?

It was in this spirit that the IOC began its journey into the world of AI about three years ago. We could already see back then that the rapid development of AI was shaping every facet of our lives at breakneck speed. It was never a question of if, but how and when AI would change the world of sport.

When we launched Olympic Agenda, our comprehensive reform programme in 2014, we did so under the slogan: “change or be changed”. This call to action is even more urgent today, as the pace of technological change is being turbo-charged. Just as we did with Olympic Agenda, we knew that we needed to lead change rather than be overtaken by it. This same mindset guided our approach to AI. Our guiding question was simple: will we be the leaders, or the object of change? As the leaders of the Olympic Movement, our answer was clear: we also want to be the leaders of change when it comes to AI in sport.

As a values-based organisation, our first concern was not technology, but people. How can AI serve humans in sport? How can it support athletes, enhance fairness, and protect integrity? How can it promote Olympic values in a rapidly changing digital age?

These humanistic questions shaped our Olympic AI Agenda—our strategic framework to harness AI responsibly and in a human-centred way. This Agenda, launched in 2024, is both visionary and practical. It defines our ambition and guiding principles and embraces AI’s full potential while protecting human dignity.

With this Agenda, we are shaping a vision: one where technology serves the athlete, and not the other way around. One where AI strengthens the role of sport as a force for good in society—and does not exacerbate existing inequalities.

Unlike other areas of society, in sport we are not confronted with the ultimate ethical question of whether AI will replace the human being. The 100 metres will always be run by an athlete—a human being. Therefore, we are in the position to concentrate on the potential of AI to support the athletes. We want to use AI to empower athletes, coaches, and the entire Olympic community to expand opportunity, to promote wellbeing, to foster greater solidarity and to preserve human dignity.

This spirit of solidarity is a cornerstone of the Olympic Movement. It also shapes our approach to AI. Our Olympic AI Agenda is not just about



*Thomas Bach delivered his address for the last time in his capacity as IOC President.*

innovation—it is about inclusion. It is about ensuring that the AI revolution in sport does not deepen existing gaps and divisions but, on the contrary, helps to close them. In line with our mission to promote solidarity across all 206 National Olympic Committees, we are committed to making AI a force that uplifts everyone. By integrating solidarity into our AI strategy, we aim to ensure that new technologies enhance equal opportunity and shared progress across our global Olympic community.

This is why another key pillar of our Agenda is accessibility. As universality lies at the heart of the Olympic Games, we must ensure that AI in sport is accessible to all. This means AI technology must be available for everybody in our Olympic community, not just for a privileged few. Like sport itself, it must be universal. AI can expand access, reduce barriers, and spread the benefits of sport more widely.



We are already putting our AI Agenda into action in this spirit of solidarity and equality.

In Senegal, ahead of the Youth Olympic Games Dakar 2026, we launched an AI-powered talent identification project with Intel and the Senegalese Olympic Committee. Using mobile phones and simple testing equipment, we reached over 1,000 young people across the country. AI helped us to identify 48 promising athletes—many of whom would have been missed by traditional systems. These athletes will now receive targeted support to pursue their dreams. This project shows AI's power to expand opportunity—and reflects our Olympic values of universality and inclusion.

Another example comes from the Olympic Games Paris 2024, where we protected athletes with the largest AI-powered online abuse monitoring programme used in sport. Real-time AI tools filtered harmful content on the social media accounts of over 14,000 Games participants. This was more than a hi-tech solution—it was a clear expression of our values of individual dignity and protecting the well-being of athletes.

In Paris, we also brought fans closer to the athletes. With OMEGA, we introduced AI-powered systems offering real-time insights—split times, biometrics, movement patterns—deepening our appreciation of human performance. These tools did not replace the athletes—they revealed their excellence in even more detail.

With Alibaba Cloud, we made operations at Paris 2024 more efficient and sustainable. AI-powered energy tools helped optimise power use at venues—a practical contribution to our sustainability goals.

AI also proved invaluable in managing the enormous complexity of Paris 2024. From optimising athlete transportation and venue crowd flow to enhancing security through real-time monitoring, AI helped the Organising Committee to plan and operate the Games more efficiently and safely. These applications demonstrate how AI can streamline logistical challenges while improving the experience for athletes, officials, and fans alike—a clear example of how technology can support solidarity by ensuring equal access and smooth participation for all. Importantly, many of these innovations can also benefit sports events of all sizes around the world, making them more inclusive, efficient and sustainable.

When it comes to broadcasting, AI has the potential to revolutionise how fans engage with sport. By combining AI with virtual and augmented reality

technology, spectators will soon be able to tailor their viewing experience. Every person can effectively become the director of their own unique Olympic experience. These kinds of innovation will make the Olympic Games, and sport as a whole, more accessible and immersive, bringing the excitement of the competition to people everywhere in ways never before possible.

In judging and refereeing, AI is already making an impact with systems like VAR in football and Hawk-Eye in tennis. Looking forward, AI can further enhance fairness and accuracy in sports where human judgement has traditionally been decisive—gymnastics, figure skating and boxing, to name a few. By supporting officials with precise data and instant review, AI upholds the integrity of competition while respecting the essential human element that lies at the heart of sport.

Beyond the field of play, AI is also enhancing how we work behind the scenes—from media summaries to archive access, governance training and streamlining office work using generative AI. Across the Olympic Movement, we are using AI to work smarter, faster and with greater impact.

These are just a few examples that show how AI, when guided by values, can be a force for good.

While we are actively seizing the opportunities, we are also mindful of the risks. AI knows no borders. It moves faster than national legislation. It raises fundamental questions about fairness, transparency, responsibility, and control. As a global organisation, we know that we cannot realise our humanistic vision of AI without global regulation. This is why international cooperation is essential. We need common standards. We need guardrails that preserve human dignity, promote innovation, and ensure equitable progress within and among societies.

Therefore we urge the global community to build a global regulatory framework for AI that allows us all to seize the opportunities and to manage the risks.

AI is just one example of a new world order in the making. Historic disruptions are reshaping the international system that has existed since the second World War. We see economic decoupling, growing nationalism, “Global South” vs “Global North”, and a retreat from multilateralism. Cooperation and compromise—once pillars of international relations—are sadly considered disparaging terms in some quarters.

These trends are deeply concerning to the Olympic Movement because they undermine our mission to unite the world in peaceful competition. And yet, they

also show how important the Olympic Games and their message of peace and solidarity have become today. That is why we are more determined than ever to do everything within our power to bring the entire world together in peaceful competition. If we can show that AI—one of the defining forces of our time—can be shaped by values, then we can help shape not just the future of sport, but the future of humanity.

This future, dear Young Ambassadors, belongs to you. We rely on your ideas, creativity and engagement so that together we can promote sport as a force for good in our world. Through your work at the International Olympic Academy, you are giving contemporary meaning to our ancient Greek heritage and carrying Olympic values into the future. Like the athletes, you are demonstrating our Olympic motto in an excellent way: Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together. The word “together” tells us that no matter what challenges we might face—in sport, or in life—we can only go faster, aim higher, become stronger if we stand together—in peace and solidarity.

This is why I encourage you: make the most of your time at the Academy. Learn from our history. Embrace the uniqueness of the Olympic Games.

Dear Friends,

In just a few days, my time as IOC President will come to an end. So it is with a great emotion that I address you today for the last time in this role.

Every visit to the International Olympic Academy, indeed, every encounter with a new class of Young Ambassadors, has been a highlight. Each time, I was inspired by your energy, your passion, and your purpose. The Academy is a special place. It preserves our Greek heritage and nurtures the next generation of leaders in sport. You ensure that our Olympic Movement remains rooted in its values and focused on the future.

Meeting so many inspiring young people here and throughout the world, I have every confidence that the future of our Olympic Movement is bright—and that it is in good hands. My successor, the IOC President-elect Kirsty Coventry, represents a new generation of leadership. She embodies our shared values. She reflects the truly global nature and the youthful, forward-looking spirit of our Olympic community.

Dear Friends,

Greece and the Greek people will always hold a special place in my heart. Every time I return, I am filled with emotion—touched by the beauty of your country, the richness of your culture, and the generosity of your people. It is here

that the Olympic Games were born, and it is here that the Olympic spirit is lived with great passion. I have always felt your warmth and your friendship—and I have always admired the deep emotional connection that the Greek people have with the Olympic Games to this very day. These moments have left a lasting mark on me. Even as my term comes to an end, I hope to return—to ancient Olympia, or here to Athens—to once again share in this Olympic spirit and to celebrate the deep bonds of friendship that unite us. Our friendship goes beyond any official role or function. This is why today I do not say “farewell”. Today, I say “see you soon”, my dear Greek friends.

**ADDRESS**  
**by the President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee**  
**Isidoros KOUVELOU**

It is with deep emotion that I stand before you on this sacred and symbolic hill—the Pnyx—where democracy was born, and where, centuries ago, citizens gathered to speak freely, to think critically, and to build a society with collective commitment and action. To welcome you here, under the Athenian sky, not just as visitors but as active participants in shaping the future of Olympism, fills me with immense hope. For it is not only the city of Athens that surrounds us—it is the spirit of dialogue, inclusion, and responsibility that envelops us.

Your presence here, at this intersection of history and future, is a powerful reminder that the Olympic Movement continues to evolve—and that it is entrusted to minds and hearts like yours.

As someone who has had the honour to serve for many years as President of the International Olympic Academy, I have witnessed the power of Olympic education to transcend borders, to unite youth in common purpose, and to cultivate the timeless values of respect, excellence, and solidarity. During my presidency, we worked tirelessly to enhance the IOA's vision and role—expanding its reach beyond Olympia and beyond Greece, with programmes and collaborations that carried Olympic values to new corners of the world.

Together with National Olympic Academies and National Olympic Committees, we created educational partnerships in different regions. These initiatives were not just projects—they were statements of intent. They showed the IOA's unwavering commitment to building a truly global Olympic education movement—one that embraces diversity, fosters leadership, and prepares the next generation to carry the Olympic legacy forward.

Now, as the newly elected President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee, I reaffirm my commitment to this work and to the IOA's mission. I strongly believe that the IOA must continue to serve as the heart of the Olympic Movement's



*Isidoros Kouvelos addressed the guests and the IOA participants as the newly elected President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee.*

educational vision. From my new position, I will do everything in my power to strengthen the IOA institutionally and practically, offering support, collaboration, and shared goals.

And what better moment to reaffirm these values than today, as you begin your journey through this Session focused on one of the most transformative topics of our time—The Olympic Movement and Artificial Intelligence: Opportunities and Challenges.

Artificial intelligence is not a distant concept—it is already here, reshaping the way we train athletes, manage data, engage with fans, and even define the meaning of performance. But with this power comes responsibility. As future leaders, you are called to ask difficult questions. How do we ensure that AI supports human dignity and equity in sport? How do we preserve fair play and protect athletes in a world increasingly influenced by algorithms and digital tools?

These are not just technical questions. They are ethical questions—and they must be addressed with clarity, compassion, and courage.

Over the coming days, you will engage with leading experts and visionaries. You will take part in vibrant working groups, where your voices, your reflections, and your ideas will shape the dialogue. You will exchange views on how AI can serve, rather than overshadow, the human spirit at the core of sport.

This journey will take you to Ancient Olympia—a place unlike any other. There, in the very birthplace of the Olympic Games, you will be invited to reflect on the past, to engage in the present, and to imagine the future. Where the two rivers meet, next to the ancient Stadium and Cronion Hill, which took its name from Zeus' father, Cronus, you will find not only the legacy of ancient athletes, but the inspiration to carry your mission forward.

Let this Session not be a mere academic exercise—but a deeply personal and collective experience.

Let it deepen your understanding of the Olympic Movement, sharpen your awareness of the challenges ahead, and strengthen your commitment to lead with values, vision, and integrity.

You are the future of the Olympic Movement. And the future is already knocking at our door.

May your days ahead be filled with inspiration, meaningful dialogue, and friendships that will last a lifetime.

Welcome to Athens, welcome to the heart of Olympism—and welcome to your own journey of impact.

Thank you.

**Awarding of Special Honorary Distinction  
to the President of the International Olympic Committee  
Thomas BACH**

President Thomas Bach, a distinguished and well-known lawyer, has had a remarkable career in elite sports, as well as in local and international sport governance and leadership.

In sports competition, Thomas Bach was an elite athlete, becoming Olympic champion in fencing after winning the gold medal in the men's team foil event at the XXI Olympic Games in Montreal in 1976. He also won World Championship titles in the men's team foil in Montreal in 1976 and Buenos Aires in 1977. He was a founding member of the IOC Athletes' Commission and in 1981 he served as an athletes' representative at the XI Olympic Congress in Baden-Baden.

In sports governance and leadership, Thomas Bach became an IOC Member in 1991 and was elected to the Executive Board in 1996, serving as an IOC Vice-President for more than a decade. Throughout his presence in the IOC, Thomas Bach chaired numerous key IOC Commissions.

On the 10th of September 2013, he was elected as the ninth President of the International Olympic Committee and soon after he presented the first Olympic Agenda 2020, which included the meaningful 20+20 Recommendations and was unanimously agreed at the 127th IOC Session in Monaco in December 2014.

In his speech on the occasion of the Opening Ceremony of the 127th IOC Session in Monaco, presenting the Olympic Agenda, he emphasised that:

*The success of today gives you only the opportunity to drive the change for tomorrow. If we do not address these challenges here and now, we will be hit by them very soon. If we do not drive these changes ourselves others will drive us to them. We want to be the leaders of change, not the object of change.*



He was re-elected for an additional four-year term on 10 March 2021, reflecting the international sporting community's continued confidence in his leadership, and in the same year he was elected Honorary President of the International Olympic Academy.



*IOC President and IOA Honorary President, Thomas Bach, was awarded with an IOA Special Honorary Distinction in recognition of his leadership in the Olympic Movement and his unwavering dedication to Sport and the Olympic values, by the IOA President, Prof. Charilaos Tsolakis and the HOC President, Isidoros Kouvelos*

In 2021, at the 137th IOC Session in Lausanne, with the characteristic phrase “In order to shape our future we need a vision of how this new world will look like”, Thomas Bach introduced the Olympic Agenda 2020+5, comprising 15 recommendations developed through a collaborative initiative involving all stakeholders in the Olympic Movement.

It has been widely recognised that these two Agendas have changed the physiognomy and the course of the IOC. By focusing on sustainability, modernisation, digital technologies, inclusiveness and empowering athletes, as

well as transforming how the Olympics are awarded and conducted, he managed to broaden the vision and scope of the Olympic Movement, and gender equality and the Olympic Refugee Team are listed among his personal achievements, proving his ability to navigate complex challenges.

Thomas Bach has also placed great importance on the role of Olympic education in disseminating Olympic values worldwide. During his presidency, the IOC Olympic Foundation for Culture and Heritage has evolved remarkably, and entities such as the Olympic World Library, the Olympic Studies and Research Centres and the Olympic Museums, as well as a number of Olympic educational and academic programmes, have undergone radical development.

The International Olympic Academy has always been at the heart of Thomas Bach's vision for the development of Olympic education internationally. In 2019, President Bach, introduced to the IOC Executive Board an ambitious plan for the radical renovation of the IOA premises in Ancient Olympia, acknowledging the work and the importance of the IOA mission. The project, financed by the IOC, was completed in October 2021, realising the dream of the then IOA President Isidoros Kouvelos.

During his speech at the inauguration of the renovated premises, President Bach, characteristically stated, "The Academy is the bridge that connects us to our past and that carries the Olympic spirit into the future."

During the 144th IOC Session, which took place in Ancient Olympia and Costa Navarino, Thomas Bach was elected IOC Honorary President for life.

The Ephoria of the International Olympic Academy decided to award Thomas Bach with a Special Honorary Distinction in recognition of his instrumental leadership in the Olympic Movement and his unwavering dedication to Sport and the Olympic values.



*H.E. the President of the Hellenic Republic, Constantine An. Tassoulas, declared the opening of the 65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors.*



*H.E. the President of the Hellenic Republic with the Presidents of the IOA and the HOC.*



*The ERT Contemporary Music Orchestra and the Athens Conservatory Youth Choir performed a musical tribute to the renowned Greek composer Mikis Theodorakis on the occasion of the centenary of his birth.*



*IOC President, Thomas Bach and IOA Dean, Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis with the students of the Master's Degree Programme in the IOA Master's Degree Programme in Olympic Studies.*

### Excerpt from Pierre de Coubertin Writings

*“It is not just internationalism and democracy, the foundations of the new human society now being constructed in civilized nations, but science as well that is involved in this sentiment. Through its constant progress, science has given man new ways to cultivate his body, to guide and strengthen nature, and to snatch the body from the constraints of unbridled passions to which it had become subject in the name of individual freedom.”.*

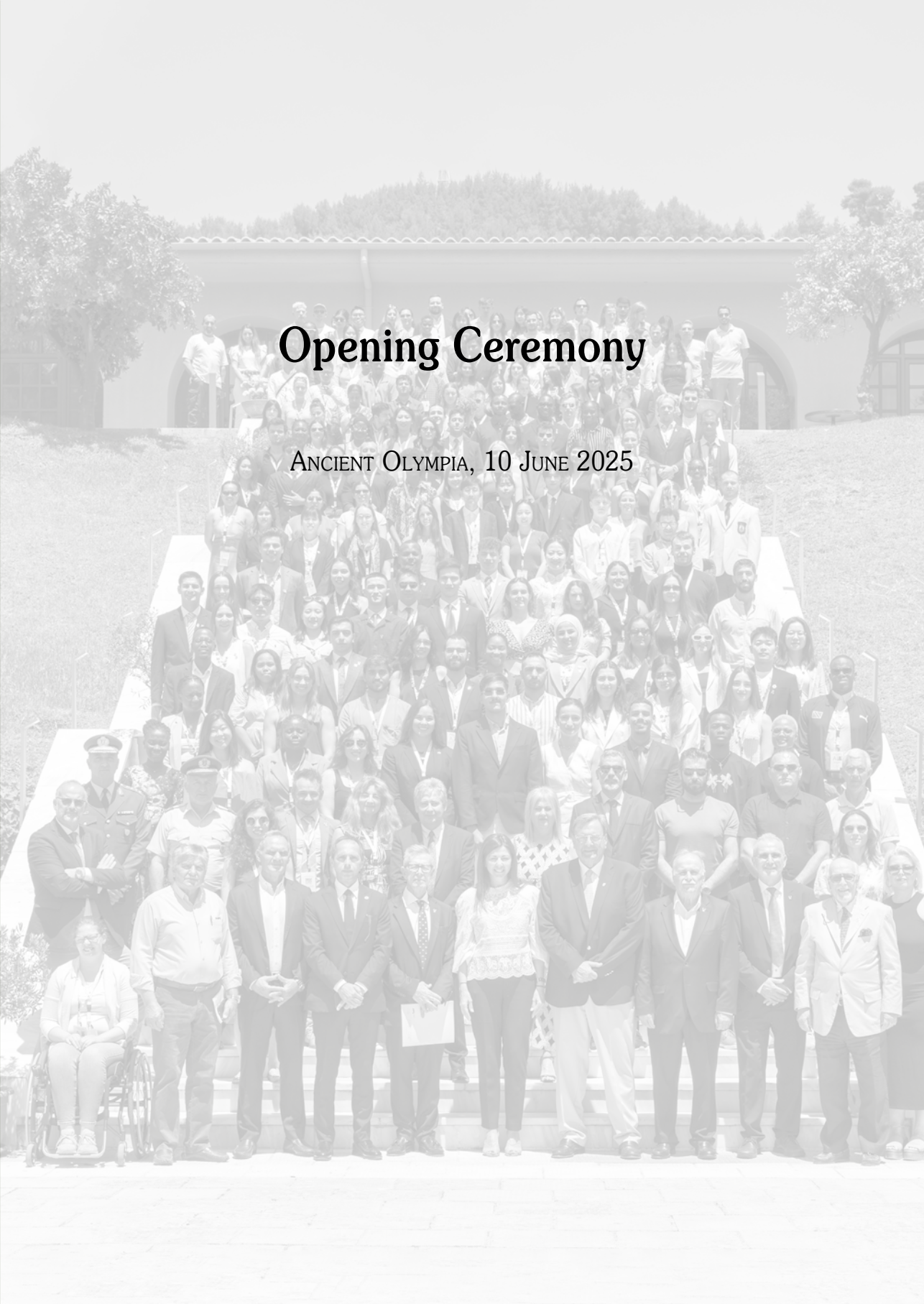
“The philosophic foundation of modern Olympism”, in *Le Sport Suisse*, vol. 31, August 7, 1935, p. 1 (*Pierre de Coubertin (1863-1937), Olympism, Selected Writings*, Norbert Müller (ed.), Lausanne, IOC, 2000, p. 580).



*«Ce ne sont pas seulement l’Internationalisme et la Démocratie, assises de la nouvelle société humaine en voie d’édification chez les nations civilisées, c’est aussi la Science qui est intéressée en cela. Par ses progrès continus, elle a fourni à l’homme de nouveaux moyens de cultiver son corps, de guider, de redresser la nature, et d’arracher ce corps à l’étreinte de passions déréglées auxquelles, sous prétexte de liberté individuelle, on le laissait s’abandonner.»*

«Les assises philosophiques de l’Olympisme moderne», dans *Le Sport Suisse*, vol. 31, 7 août 1935, p. 1.



A large group of people, including students and staff, are posed on the wide stone steps of a building. The group is arranged in many rows, filling the steps from the bottom to the top. In the front row, several individuals are standing, including a man in a wheelchair on the far left. The people are dressed in a variety of attire, from formal suits and blouses to more casual t-shirts and jeans. The building behind them has a light-colored facade with arched windows and a tiled roof. Trees and greenery are visible on either side of the building. The overall atmosphere is formal yet celebratory.

# Opening Ceremony

ANCIENT OLYMPIA, 10 JUNE 2025





**OPENING ADDRESS**  
**of the Session Proceedings**  
**by the President of the International Olympic Academy**  
**Professor Charilaos TSOLAKIS**

Dear Young Olympic  
Ambassadors,  
Welcome to Olympia!

This sacred place stands  
as a powerful symbol linking  
ancient Greek principles to  
the modern Olympic Move-  
ment.

It is with great pleasure,  
also, that I welcome you, this  
time to the fully renovated  
and operational premises of  
the International Olympic  
Academy, next to the land  
that gave birth to the Olympic Games, where you will spend the next 10 days  
and where you will experience at first hand the spirit of Olympism, putting into  
practice its values of friendship, excellence in noble competition and respecting  
diversity—forging close ties as if you were in an Olympic village.

The ruins of Ancient Olympia, including the Temple of Zeus and the ancient  
stadium which you will have the chance to visit tomorrow, serve as tangible links  
to the past, inspiring current and future generations.

This living land is distinguished on the one hand for its Olympic history and  
natural beauty, and on the other hand for the opportunity it provides young  
people to engage in a new form of socialisation. It is a special challenge for you  
to live together, young people from every corner of the earth, in this place with







*Presentation of the Session's participants by the IOA Dean, Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis, and the Head of the YOA Session, Stella Tachtara.*



its strong historical origins and incredible natural setting, starting as strangers to each other. Still, by the end of the Session, you will be lifelong friends.

This is the greatness of the International Olympic Academy.

Each day at the IOA there is an exceptional diversity, which is what defines the IOA, makes it unique, and ensures that, at the end of this journey, you will have created a strong spiritual bond with your “fellow travellers” – a bond that will contribute decisively to your personal and social well-being and, by extension, to the well-being of the modern societies in which you live and create.



*Standing for the Olympic anthem.*

These new societies that are being formed with the rapid evolution of time are certain to have been shaped by the parallel evolution of technology, and especially by artificial intelligence.

How significant do you think the impact of new technology and AI will be on our everyday lives, but more specifically on the field of sports?

How likely is it that these technological developments will also have an impact on our inner world?

How likely do you think it is that the society of the future will preserve intact the Olympic values with which all of us, including you, have been raised?

These are questions that invite you to express your opinion, together with the distinguished lecturers who will be with you in the coming days.

Your approach to the above questions is the one that counts the most.

Because while our generation was suddenly faced with these new discoveries, you are growing up with them.

That is why your opinion matters more than ours!

Dear Friends, I am confident that your stay in Ancient Olympia will mark the beginning of an incredible journey filled with knowledge and experiences, enabling you to share the outcomes of your work with an ever-increasing number of young people back in your countries.

Have a wonderful time at our premises, surrounded by the greenery of Olympia, and be assured that, from now on, you are a member of the International Olympic Academy family.

Thank you.

**ADDRESS**  
**by the Mayor of Ancient Olympia**  
**and IOA Ephoria Member**  
**Aristides PANAGIOTOPOULOS**

I welcome you to Ancient Olympia, a place with strong symbolism, worldwide prestige and timeless cultural value. Your presence here is not just a participation in an international event, but an active contribution to the preservation and dissemination of a system of values that remains steadfastly relevant.

Olympia is not just an archaeological site. It is a living place of introspection around the concepts of peace, proportion and human advancement. Here, an ethical way of life was born: a way of life which places excellence, not as an end in itself, but as an attitude of continuous improvement, with respect to fellow human beings.

In an age of strong challenges and transformations, investing in youth and Olympic education acquires a special meaning. Young Olympic Ambassadors are called to stand as bearers of these values, strengthening intercultural dialogue.

In a world that often is divided by prejudices, inequalities and exclusions, sport becomes a common language. The fact that you, the Young Ambassadors, are called to investigate and spread this message, renders you not just students of a tradition, but active shapers of the future.



The Municipality of Ancient Olympia, as the institutional body responsible for this global symbol, supports initiatives that give substantial content to its historic mission. We believe wholeheartedly that the essence of these values is not found in words, but in actions – and your active participation is precisely such an action.

I warmly wish that your presence in Olympia becomes a source of knowledge, retrospection and deeper understanding of the importance of the Olympic ideals. I am sure that you will leave this place not just with beautiful experiences, but with a sense of responsibility for your role as representatives of these values in the modern world.

Good luck in your works.

**ADDRESS**  
**by the President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee**  
**Isidoros KOUVELOΣ**

Dear Young Olympic  
Ambassadors,

Welcome to Ancient Olympia—this sacred and symbolic site that stands at the very heart of the Olympic spirit, and the place we all hold so dearly. It is here that the ideals of Olympism were born! It is here that we return—not only to remember, but to renew our shared commitment to those values.

Although my official role has changed—after 16 years of serving as President of the International Olympic Academy I am stepping into the position of President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee—my dedication to Olympic education remains a guiding priority in my life and my work!

From this new post, I am determined to strengthen the deep and essential bond between the Hellenic Olympic Committee and the International Olympic Academy. Together, we will support, develop, and expand Olympic education programmes—ensuring that the philosophy of Olympism reaches every corner of the world.



Integrating Olympic education into our national agenda, we will strengthen its presence in schools, sports federations, and communities, ensuring that the legacy of the IOA is not only preserved but also enhanced.

Today, I wish to express my sincere and heartfelt thanks to the Minister of Education and Religious Affairs, Ms Sofia Zacharaki, for honouring us with her presence. Her visible and steadfast support for Olympic education is a true source of encouragement. The launch of last year's pilot programme in junior high schools stands as a testament to the Ministry's belief in the social and educational power of Olympic values. I sincerely hope this initiative will soon be established in primary schools as well—so that we may begin to instil the principles of Olympism in children from the earliest stages of life.

And finally, to all of you—our Young Olympic Ambassadors—as I said at the Opening Ceremony on the historic hill of Pnyx, you are the future of this Movement. Your energy, your passion, your fresh perspective and creativity are what will carry the Olympic ideals forward. May your voices resonate, and may your actions inspire.

With these words, it is now my great honour to invite the Minister of Education, Ms Sofia Zacharaki, to the podium.

Thank you.



*Dr Panagiotis Lattas, Director of the Forest Directorate of Pyrgos, was honoured by the International Olympic Academy in recognition of more than 30 years of dedicated service and his unwavering commitment to environmental protection. The award was presented by the IOA President, Prof. Charilaos Tsolakis, and the IOA Vice-President, Spyros Zannias.*



*Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis presented the history of the Pierre de Coubertin stele to all the guests and participants, while IOA Coordinators recited excerpts from De Coubertin writings.*





*The Session Lecturers Prof. Andy Miah, Prof. Marion Keim and Dr Minhyeok Tak laid a wreath at the commemorative stele of Pierre de Coubertin, where his heart rests, and IOA participants laid a wreath at the Ioannis Ketseas and Carl Diem monument.*









*Guided tour of the Acropolis and the Panathenaic Stadium.*



*Guided tour of the Olympia archaeological site.*







# Proceedings

## LECTURES



*The opinions of the lecturers do not necessarily reflect those of the International Olympic Academy.*

*Out of respect for multiculturalism and diversity of scientific research, we do not intervene in the way each lecturer chooses to present his/her bibliography and footnotes.*

# IMMERSIVE INTELLIGENCE FOR NEXT GENERATION SPORTS: WHERE ESPORTS, ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, AND VIRTUAL REALITIES CONVERGE

**Prof. Andy MIAH (GBR)**

*University of Salford, Manchester, UK*



## **Abstract**

This essay explores the transformative potential of convergent technologies in sports, where artificial intelligence, extended reality (XR), and esports have evolved together in a way that is redefining how sports are experienced, produced, and consumed. It examines trends in audience expectations, theatrical design, and the wider role of the media in shaping the elite sports event to understand what the future of sports media looks like economically and culturally. From AI-driven commentary and dynamic camera angles to metaverse fan zones and adaptive viewing experiences, immersive intelligence is blurring the boundaries between the physical and digital realms of sports, and this has major implications for how the sports think about their future.

## **Introduction**

The history of sport has long been intertwined with the evolution of human technological systems (Miah, 2002). From the architectural ingenuity of ancient stadia to the contemporary use of artificial intelligence and the emergence of



sport science itself, the integration of technology in sport has progressed in step with broader societal advancements. However, this integration has frequently introduced tensions, prompting critical reflection within the sporting world about whether such innovations align with the values and practices that define sport. In some instances, sports have drawn clear ethical lines—most notably around doping—establishing firm boundaries not to be crossed. Yet in areas such as sport science and performance-enhancing technologies, the boundaries are far more fluid. Innovations ranging from high-tech sportswear to sophisticated simulation tools have been embraced by athletes in the pursuit of marginal gains—sometimes with minimal scrutiny, at other times prompting regulatory intervention and outright bans (Miah, 2017).

Within this landscape, debates about the legitimacy of technological integration often centre on the sport itself and whether such innovations compromise the authenticity of athletic performance. These concerns typically arise when technology directly influences outcomes—such as in training, equipment, or performance monitoring. Yet this is markedly different from the integration of media technologies, which aim not to alter the competition but to amplify its narrative. From the time of the Ancient Olympic Games, storytelling has been integral to the cultural significance of sport and its power to inspire. In antiquity, these narratives were preserved through oral traditions and literary accounts passed down through generations. Today, they are predominantly shaped and disseminated by professional media, the contemporary custodians of sport's most compelling stories.

While the media has taken many forms over the 20th century, television has been the dominant force to shape the fortunes of sports. For example, the creation of Olympic broadcast rights contracts in the 1980s was central to the renewed economic viability of the Olympic Movement and the wider sports industry. Ever since, these new arrangements to sell the rights to televise the games have become the central pillar of the modern sports economy and significant resources have been deployed monitor, manage, innovate, and extend these freedoms always to generate greater economic stability for sport.

While these efforts have been relatively stable for the last 40 years, despite significant disruptions to our media culture which have threatened their continuity. The challenge for television came especially towards the end of the millennium with the rise of the Internet and, subsequently, social media and mobile audience experiences. While, initially, social media was considered

a threat to the sports media economy, it subsequently became a central part of its identity, amplifying rather than detracting from the sporting economy. Nevertheless, such transformations have brought disruptions to the sports economy, with new media companies like Google or Meta becoming a bigger part of the sports media ecosystem. Today's sports economy is more critically tied to these data-driven technology providers and this has changed the expectations of what sport's future will become in the future.

Critically, these disruptions—and the new technological possibilities they have enabled—are the underpinning context to sport's exploration of new formats of mediatisation. Yet, it is important to appreciate how media innovation is written into the DNA of modern sport. Media change is not just a new imposition on existing sports economies, but is a critical component of the sports infrastructure. Indeed, since the dawn of television, the Olympic Games have sought to pursue excellence both in athletic performance and in the delivery of the sports media experience for audiences. Evidence of this is found over the last 20 years of Olympic history, where the primary stakeholders aligned with the Olympic Games have foregrounded their own innovation journeys, offering a glimpse into the future for Olympic visitors when they attend the Games. For example, at the Rio 2016 Olympic Games, the first esports event at an Olympic Games took place in the form of a showcase held in British House, which was the first time that esports came close to the Olympic Movement. Also in Rio, 360-degree film making was used by television broadcasters and, in the Olympic Park, Olympic partner Samsung showcased a demonstration of advanced virtual reality simulators alongside their latest mobile phone.

The driver of media change within sports has always been underpinned by the desire to service humanity's fundamental desire to enjoy the most compelling stories about what it requires of athletes to achieve world class performances. As such, the pursuit of new forms of storytelling must be understood as a continuum of innovations, where the latest, new trajectory within that ambition is found in the convergence of esports, immersive technologies, and artificial intelligence. Together, these technological systems create a new kind of immersive intelligence, which is, in turn, ushering in a new era of sports experiences.

## Sport's Future in Artificial Intelligence

Sport's journey towards artificial intelligence follows from the centrality of the digital infrastructure that underpins the production of modern, elite sports. From cybersecurity to transportation, the sports industry has become entirely dependent of the logic of greater digital efficiencies. Yet, there is also a crucial connection between the use of technology for functional purposes and for the forms of storytelling described previously. Indeed, by aligning these two ambitions allows innovation to take place alongside critical conversations about the end points of such work. For example, when the International Olympic Committee launched its Olympic AI Agenda in 2024, one of the projects presented by Worldwide AI partner Alibaba was its use of artificial intelligence to recreate historic footage from the Olympic Games. Their aim was to colourise the monochromatic television footage of early Games and re-tell these story as they were meant to be seen. told.

This transformation to historic artefacts is both fascinating from a technical perspective, but is also laden with a range of ethical and cultural considerations over how the technology makes decisions about how to transform these historic works. Would it adequately reflect the reality of those moments and how would we know? Would this transformation to historical records change humanity's perception of its history and what this might mean for how humanity make sense of the past? Alternatively, the use of AI by Olympic Broadcasting Services during the Paris 2024 Olympic Games in the digital tagging of film content from the sports events is already at a point where it has brought huge efficiencies that can significantly amplify the volume of stories that can be shared by broadcasters, such as creating AI generated highlights package from competitions. However, in keeping with international legal and moral expectations, OBS does not use real-time facial tracking, as a way of identifying athletes, even though this capability exists today.

These examples reveal how the integration of artificial intelligence into sports engages a range of ethical, cultural, and legal questions. They also demonstrate the powerful combination of artificial intelligence with other media systems, which is becoming an increasingly exciting part of the future sports economy.

## **Immersive Esports: The New Normal**

When examining transformations to contemporary sport, it is easy to forget that individual technologies rarely operate in isolation. Indeed, this is most apparent when thinking about changes to the single most transformative consumer technology of modern times, a device which has transformed the fortunes of elite sports—the television. The new normal to establish itself in the 1980s was underpinned by the rise of television consumer culture and transformations to this single object and the lives people lead around them are what is shaping conversations about a new normal, exemplified by the rise of esports and virtual reality experiences. The allure of these new media technologies is reminiscent of the excitement that surrounded the rise of television and its capacity to establish a window into a global experience, previously unseen by the world. Moreover, the excitement surrounding these new cultural practices builds on the last 30 years of digital transformation, which has demonstrated further shifts in how audiences experience sports and what they expect from it.

Television culture, as a dominant feature of 20th century living, has been relatively static as an experience, except for three important transformations. First, at the turn of the millennium, the television was liberated from its cathode ray tube design, allowing a new era of thin-screen technology to proliferate. Today, flexible screens are the latest iteration of this, creating yet another transformation to what kinds of places people may encounter screens. In turn, this has also allowed television experiences to be designed on multiple scales, from vast large screens delivering 8k experiences, to smart phones and gaming consoles. Second, the television was liberated from its fixed antennae, which were reliant on and wedded to the home living room, as the theatre of experiencing what it could deliver. A related obstacle to be overcome was in relation to the delivery of television signals through antennae or cables, which leads to the final critical change in how we make sense of today's television—the emergence of internet enabled television, increasingly delivered by wireless technology. Together, these new components of the televisual experience led to a need for broadcasters to innovate their products and cater for a multi-screen and multi-platform audience, whose enjoyment of sports content occurs in countless places, from Facebook to TikTok. The impact of these three transformations to the televisual assemblage is the foundation on which innovation is now being

deployed into a variety of new sports encounters, where immersive technology and esports reflect this transformation.

In this respect, it is useful to think about the future of sport—and its integration with such technologies as artificial intelligence—as a form of evolution taking place within a wider ecosystem. Indeed, understanding the range of ways in which these systems are interconnected is fundamental to appreciating the momentum behind technological change and how they are interdependent. For example, none of the transformations to sports discussed in this essay will be possible without an abundance of computer chips, which in turn, cannot be manufactured without an abundance of semi-conductors. Indeed, if one examines the global political trade war negotiations surrounding humanity's future, a significant part of the interests are located in the pursuit to secure the rare other materials needed to design computer chips.

Thus, the error one makes when analysing the future of technology and asking questions into its legitimacy, is in hoping to separate one component of a technological system from another. Such naivety is even more relevant when considering today's primary economic investors into modern sports, which now include some of the world's biggest technology brands, including Alibaba, Intel, Samsung, and Google. The growing dominance of such companies is a powerful example of the interdependency between sports and technology. Twenty years ago, it may have been Facebook/Meta or Google who were delivering greater security, but now it includes the technology manufacturing companies on which such platforms rely, such as NVIDIA.

Furthermore, beyond the companies whose core heritage is technology, other organisations are now entering the sporting innovation family in a variety of ways. Such brands as Coca-Cola, Nike, Red Bull, each covet innovation as a core part of their brand identity, whether it is Coca-Cola's creation of an esports YouTube channel or Nike's shoe technology. Increasingly, sports brands have aligned themselves with a wider innovation economy to reach new audiences by investing into fashion, film, and gaming, among other areas. In this respect, when thinking through the future of sport, it is critical to consider the continuity in how different parts of the sports media complex are evolving. Indeed, the transformation to how brands make sense of their identity in times of rapid consumer technology change is apparent and an emerging force for change to the wider entertainment economy in which elite sports events are situated. For example, in 2024, Jaguar car company launched a new campaign that paid

limited attention to the car and emphasised, instead, lifestyle. Such examples are typical of the dynamic nature in which traditional verticals in the sports sponsorship ecosystem are being disrupted by new cultures of technological adoption.



*Prof. Andy Miah, chair holder of Science Communication and Future Media at the University of Salford, and past IOA participant, during his lecture.*

A final component of this new, immersive digital sporting experience is found in the theatrical staging of sports, specifically, in how the playing field is being redesigned around new potentialities, desires and technical possibilities. In this respect, one can also identify the wider innovation trajectories that are shaping this development. For example, on the approach to the Paris 2024 Olympic Games, the Olympic Broadcasting Services announced that these would be the most immersive Games ever, where this meant several, very specific things.

First, announcements were made about how the camera lenses used to film the sports would be different and more typical of cinematic productions, creating an unparalleled experience. It may be no coincidence that this decision takes place at the Games which precede the Los Angeles 2028 Olympic Games, itself the heart of the global film industry, a theme also articulated by the highlight

of the LA 2028 handover ceremony including one of the world's biggest icons, Tom Cruise. Indeed, the emphasis on cinematic experiences comes amidst a journey the IOC has been on to create its own cinematic originals, many of which are accessed through the Olympic channel. Over nearly 10 years, the IOC has been designing its own version of Amazon Prime or Netflix, building on the vast access to exceptional material in the journey of athletes towards the Olympic Games. On the approach to the Paris 2024, it was also announced that NBCUniversal would partner with IMAX cinemas to deliver uniquely immersive experiences of the Opening Ceremony at ticketed events across the USA.

Paris would also become the most immersive Olympic Games ever through its use of new formats of video presentation, such as the Alibaba MUCAR system, which uses a vast multi-camera rig to deliver 180-degree animated highlights, replaying key moments of the competitions. This new technology delivered new ways of seeing sports in near real-time that had never been possible before, reminding audiences that the field of play is still rich with untold stories and that only technology is crucial to achieving these new insights.

Around these new capabilities is also a desire to innovate with the creative staging of the sports arena more widely. For instance, one of the critical advances in Olympic history is found in the impact of the creative teams who produce the Opening Ceremony of the Olympic Games, itself the most iconic creative moment of any Olympic Games programme. Since Rio 2016, this creative influence has increased substantially and now, the theatrical staging of the sports events themselves is accompanied by significant, creative innovation, often taking the form of pre-match audio visual shows, which encompass sophisticated theatrical elements, such as artistic demonstrations during sports intervals. These examples reveal how the theatre of sport has expanded to deliver even more compelling and encompassing immersive experiences, before the sports events even begin.

Together, these transformations reveal why the future of sport is found in further integrations of advanced, immersive experiences, which build on new understandings of the audience experience and what sports must do to sustain a paying audience. Indeed, the anxiety about losing touch with the next generation of potential sports fans grew significantly alongside the rise of the social media and perhaps even more critically, gaming culture. Today's younger generation are more likely to consume gaming content than sports content and the delivery of these experiences occurs through online platforms that are currently outside of the main economic infrastructure of elite sports broadcasting. Platforms like



Twitch, YouTube, or Discord, are servicing a new generation of consumers whose consumer habits often sit outside of the present sports media economy.

Indeed, these new realities of sport also reveal why, in 2024, the International Olympic Committee announced the creation of the Olympic Esports Games. The combined determination to deliver world leading media experiences, combined with an appreciation for changing consumer desires, explains the context in which esports find themselves in closer proximity to traditional sports and the Olympic family specifically. Furthermore, the proactive explanation for this initiative is found in the mission of sports organisations to ensure they continue to serve the world's youth and to remain a relevant, critical partner in that mission. Indeed, former IOC President Thomas Bach said as much in 2021, arguing how the sports industry was crucial to bringing knowledge of well-being and health to what, in many ways, can be an unhealthy culture of gaming. Fortunately, there are also significant allies who are both the extended family of traditional sports and who are pioneers of a new era of sports. From the Esports World Cup and the Global Esports Federation to the World Technology Games, the sports world is accompanied by experienced organisations and individuals who have their own histories located in wider international sports heritage.

### **Active Esports as 22nd Century Thinking**

As humanity enters the second quarter of the 21st century, it is useful to consider what it means to adopt 22nd century thinking in our approach to considering the future of sport. While the pace of technological change appears greater today than ever before, there are other critical transformations taking place around humanity. We find ourselves moving ever closer to climate catastrophe and these concerns have not escaped the public consciousness, when thinking about its use of technology. Indeed, one of the most prominent criticisms of artificial intelligence has been its reliance on vast amounts of energy to function. In this respect, it is a legitimate question to ask whether the continued integration of high-performance computing into sports is to the wider detriment of life on Earth and to ask whether there is merit in returning sports to less technologically dependent times. Indeed, examples of this counterculture are found within adaptations that are being made to contemporary sports, such as the introduction of ski mountaineering within the Olympic Winter Games. Unlike traditional ski

competitions, ski mountaineering takes place off piste, moving it away from the need for perfect snow conditions of the piste and the high-energy demands that this involves. While this may also be seen as a product of necessity as the predictability of snow becomes ever more uncertain, it also reveals how the future of sports remains uncertain.

In this way, 22nd century thinking on the future of sport would benefit from considering the longer-term impacts of technological change and elevating investment into more sustainable experiences. During the Lausanne 2020 Olympic Games, climate activist Greta Thunberg led a march throughout the city, bringing into focus the alignment of how the next generation may approach their lives very differently; more conscientious about flying, less willing to accept industrial agriculture, more mindful of the need for a circular economy, and more ambivalent about the digital lives they lead. In 2023, at the beginning of the global transformation towards generative AI, schools all over the world were beginning to ban the use of mobile phones by pupils and some years before the UN's ICD 2011 first characterised a new entry which it called 'gaming disorder' reflecting a condition of severe addiction impacts of gaming experiences.

In this respect, humanity's relationship with digital experiences feels still precarious and this tension evidences a contested future for sports; both excited to build economic sustainability through new diverse, digital propositions and anxious that an over reliance on technology might encompass a loss of something more central to being human that would be difficult to recover. A useful way to mitigate the risks of society running out of natural resources or conditioning itself away from healthy lifestyles will be to draw these tensions into closer proximity. By prioritising technology for good as a fundamental criterion of investment by sports, it will be more effectively placed to ensure that the moral principles by which it is best developed may be satisfied, but also that it can design sports for a generation who both need to make their era of sports fit their expectations, while also retaining the symbolic and ritualistic contribution that sports make.

## THE OLYMPIC MOVEMENT AND AI: OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES

**Sofia ZACHARAKI (GRE)**

*Minister of Education, Religious Affairs and Sports*



Ladies and Gentlemen,

Dear Representatives of the International Olympic Academy, the Hellenic Olympic Committee, and the educational community,

Dear Young Olympic Ambassadors,

Every journey to Ancient Olympia also marks a return—a return to our roots, but also a return to meaning. This place, where we gather today, serves as a constant reminder that sport was born to unite people and that education enlightens when it is grounded in values.

We stand in a place where athletes competed not for wealth or medals, but for honour, virtue, and the harmonious cultivation of body and spirit. Here, the Olympic Truce was not a distant dream, but a living reality, universally respected and embraced.

And today, you, the representatives of 102 countries from across the world, become the modern guardians of these values. And at the same time, the messengers of a new question:

*How Does the Olympic Movement Meet Artificial Intelligence?*

At first reading, it might seem like a mismatch. From one side, Olympism with its most ancient roots. On the other side, artificial intelligence is no longer a distant vision of science fiction; it is here, shaping the world. It is a “revolution of intelligence”, producing results that no amount of human intelligence alone could achieve. It is a profound shift in human history. It is the cutting-edge of



*The Greek Minister of Education, Religious Affairs and Sports, Sofia Zacharaki, spoke about the opportunities and challenges arising at the intersection of the Olympic Movement and artificial intelligence, while presenting the Ministry's relevant initiatives. On this occasion, the Presidents of the IOA and the HOC presented Ms Zacharaki with a commemorative gift.*

our present and our future. And despite this, it is precisely this convergence that defines the horizon of our era.

Because artificial intelligence is a tool. The Olympic spirit and Olympic education are the objective.

Because with artificial intelligence we can:

- Predict the results of exclusion and design more inclusive policies for children with fewer opportunities
- Strengthen educational experience, making it more personalised, more accessible and more human
- Transmit Olympic values through ways that connect with youth, through interactive programmes, simulations, experiential learning, digital museums, and language models that understand and inspire.

And the most important thing: Artificial intelligence can help ensure that no child, anywhere in the world, is deprived of the right to sport, knowledge, and participation. The ultimate objective is to encourage lifelong practice of sports in line with Olympic values and to protect their health.

The aim is clear: AI can become a tool of democracy and inclusion.

Ladies and Gentlemen,

In Greece the discussion over technology does not remain on paper. In sports, we have made many digital leaps in a short period of time.

With *e-Kouros* we have, for the first time, a digital overview of where and how our citizens are exercising. We know, with transparency and precision, how many clubs are operating, how many athletes and coaches are active, what the infrastructure needs are—and where.

And all this is not just data. It is data with direction. It is the basis for fairer, more targeted policies—policies that are not determined out of emotion, but knowledge.

*e-Kouros* is a proof that digital transformation can change everyday life—not just for the State, but for each athlete, every coach, every neighborhood.

And this digital infrastructure is the step before artificial intelligence because only when you have structure, documentation and transparency, can you utilise artificial intelligence in a way that serves mankind.

Therefore, artificial intelligence is not a goal. It is a tool. A means that must always be guided by human values and principles, which are also aligned with Olympic values. The goal remains that set by the Ancients and renewed by

Pierre de Coubertin: the holistic development of mankind through knowledge, respect, cooperation and excellence.

This is what we serve through the strategic cooperation of our Ministry with the International Olympic Academy.

With a sentiment of responsibility, the Ministry of Education, Religious Affairs and Sports of Greece has set in priority the diffusion of Olympic education through all levels of educational process.

And in this effort, our collaboration with the International Olympic Academy, sealed with the Memorandum of Cooperation that we signed for a period of five years with the possibility of further extension, is of fundamental importance.

Through this memorandum, we plan and implement:

- Educational programmes for students and educators throughout Greece
- Strengthening the Physical Education curriculum by promoting Olympic education topics across all levels of education
- Activities implemented in model and experimental schools that integrate the Olympic values into everyday school life
- Seminars, conferences and camps that bring sports education, multicultural coexistence and cooperation closer together.

Already, thanks to this Memorandum of Cooperation, more than 3,000 children from secondary schools across the country have visited the birthplace of Olympic values, Ancient Olympia.

The Ministry of Education, Religious Affairs and Sports of Greece is here to guarantee that the content of the Memorandum of Cooperation will be supported and implemented in its entirety.

Through this strategic alliance and the good practices that this will bring about, we want Olympic education to cease being a special case, to no longer be revived only once in every four years, with the timely character of the Olympic and Paralympic Games, but to become an everyday reality in Greek schools.

The philosophy of this programme is a journey of education and character, inspired by Olympism, Olympic pedagogy and our deeply rooted sporting tradition.

At its core lies the human being as a whole—body, mind and soul together. A person who learns, who relates, who evolves through competition, effort and coexistence.

The aim is not just gaining knowledge, but also the cultivation of values, the motivation, the discovery of interests, and the strengthening of skills. All these

within a modern framework, which engages with our times and draws from our culture tools to shape active, responsible, and well-rounded citizens.

Dear Ambassadors,

We rely on you. On you, the young people who do not merely carry the past, the ideals and the values of Olympism, but who are building its present and its future.

Yes, artificial intelligence has entered our lives, and we should not turn our backs on it, but utilise its potential to the fullest. We should learn to work with it, so that we can get the best of both sides—human creativity and mechanical precision. But we must not forget that it is the human being who, throughout time, is defined by conscience, responsibility and values.

Your voice, your point of view, your actions, can prove that technology does not alienate—when it serves a higher purpose, it unites.

The historic motto of the Olympic Games, *Citius, Altius, Fortius*, was recently enriched with a fourth word: “Communiter”, which means “Together”. A word that reflects the need for collectivity, unity and a shared vision in the new era of technology and artificial intelligence.

And indeed, TOGETHER we can shape a future where technology does not replace human spirit—but strengthens it. Honours it. Highlights it.

I am inviting you to return back to your countries, not just with memories, but with a mission:

- To talk about the values that you experienced here
- To teach them
- To turn them into a way of life.

And if you allow me just one word that we should all take with us as we leave Ancient Olympia, it would be: Empathy. The ability to feel the other person—to compete alongside them, to admire their achievements, to learn from their abilities, and to grow and evolve.

That is not artificial. It is entirely human. And entirely consistent with our Olympic values.

Thank you.



## NAVIGATING HUMAN–AI INTERACTIONS: OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES FOR ATHLETES

**Assoc. Prof. Agni ORFANOUDAKI (GRE)**  
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### Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) is increasingly embedded within the core operations of modern society, permeating sectors as varied as healthcare, finance, logistics, and education. Sport, as both a professionalised industry and a cultural domain, is not insulated from this transformation. The adoption of data-driven methodologies and intelligent systems has enabled novel approaches to training, talent development, performance monitoring, and audience engagement. This convergence of sport and AI presents both profound opportunities and intricate challenges, particularly as we consider the interaction between automated systems and human expertise.

Today, I aim to unpack this evolving relationship, focusing on the opportunities and limitations that arise when athletes, coaches, and organisations engage with intelligent systems. The central tension we will explore is not simply the capabilities of AI, but the dynamics of human–AI interaction—how decisions are made, mediated, and transformed in this hybrid context.

### What Is AI, Though?

The term “Artificial Intelligence” (AI) broadly refers to the creation of systems

capable of performing tasks that would normally require human intelligence—such as learning, reasoning, and decision-making. The human fascination with building intelligent or autonomous beings, however, long predates modern computing. In Ancient Greek mythology, figures like Hephaestus, the god of craftsmanship, were said to have built mechanical servants of gold to assist him. In the modern era, this vision gained scientific form in the mid-20th century, particularly through the work of Alan Turing, whose 1950 paper *Computing Machinery and Intelligence* posed the foundational question, “Can machines think?” [1]. Turing proposed what is now known as the Turing Test—a method for evaluating a machine’s ability to exhibit behaviour indistinguishable from that of a human.

While early efforts in AI relied on symbolic rules and logic-based systems, the field underwent a dramatic shift with the emergence of machine learning (ML). In contrast to hand-coded instructions, ML systems learn patterns and optimise performance through exposure to data. Today, this data-driven paradigm underpins almost all real-world applications of AI.

### **Promising Applications of AI in Sport**

The increasing power of machine learning has enabled AI to move beyond controlled laboratory settings and into real-world, high-variability domains—sport being one of the most compelling. Athletic environments generate vast and diverse streams of data: biometric, biomechanical, tactical, psychological. From optimising individual training to transforming how competitions are judged and experienced, AI is already shaping the landscape of athletic performance. Let us consider four key areas where these developments are particularly evident:

**Personalised Coaching and Performance Optimisation:** Wearable technologies and sensor-based monitoring tools are now integrated with AI algorithms to provide real-time, personalised feedback to athletes. For instance, platforms such as WHOOP or Catapult utilise biometric and kinematic data to recommend individualised training loads and recovery regimens [2-3]. Video analysis powered by computer vision—used extensively in professional tennis, athletics, and team sports—further augments biomechanical assessment, enabling more targeted and data-supported coaching interventions. The vast majority of professional athletes have started to experiment with such technologies.

**Talent Identification:** Machine learning models can detect subtle performance patterns across large datasets, facilitating the early identification of promising athletes. Several football academies and federations utilise algorithmic tools to evaluate youth performance metrics, sometimes uncovering talent in regions that traditional scouting mechanisms have historically overlooked. The recent partnership between the International Olympic Committee and Intel in Senegal illustrates the potential of AI in this domain [4]. This democratisation of opportunity through algorithmic evaluation represents both a technical and ethical frontier.

**Objective Judging and Scoring:** In judged sports such as gymnastics and figure skating, AI-based motion analysis systems have been proposed to augment or audit human judges. While still evolving, these technologies aim to minimise subjectivity and bias by providing an objective benchmark for movement execution and form.

**Audience Engagement and Real-Time Analytics:** Generative AI and real-time predictive analytics are transforming the way audiences experience sport. For example, during major tennis or football tournaments, live visualisations of serve patterns, expected goals, or fatigue estimates are now commonly integrated into broadcasts, enhancing both understanding and entertainment value.

These are just some distinctive examples of applications of AI in a continuously growing domain that uncovers more applications.

## AI Systems Classifications

To understand the opportunities and challenges that AI can bring to decision-making, it is crucial to distinguish between AI systems based on the type of recommendations they provide. Their outputs can be classified into four broad categories, each serving different functional roles in decision-making:

- **Descriptive Analytics:** These systems summarise past or real-time events to help teams understand performance trends. For example, a coach might review a player's shot distribution across recent matches or analyse sprint frequency during training. Descriptive analytics provide a factual baseline—crucial for diagnosis and reflection but not designed to make forecasts or decisions.
- **Predictive Analytics:** Predictive tools estimate future outcomes based on

patterns in historical data. In sport, they are used to anticipate injury risk, project an athlete's likely performance, or estimate win probabilities under certain conditions. While these predictions are probabilistic, they enable proactive planning when used responsibly.

- **Prescriptive Analytics:** Prescriptive systems go further by recommending specific actions. For instance, they might suggest the optimal time for a substitution or recommend pacing strategies for a marathon runner. These tools combine data and optimisation techniques to propose actions and strategies aligned with performance goals.
- **Generative AI:** Generative AI creates new content—videos, simulations, or training scenarios—by learning from existing data. In sport, it can produce personalised feedback videos or simulate future matches for tactical preparation. Though still emerging, this class of tools is expanding possibilities for athlete education and planning.

In the sports context, all four categories are actively utilised. However, their integration into coaching and competition raises fundamental questions about human judgment and oversight.

## Human Interaction with AI Recommendations

Despite their analytical sophistication, AI systems do not make autonomous decisions in most sporting contexts. Instead, they provide recommendations—a form of decision support. This raises the question: how do athletes, coaches, and managers engage with these suggestions?

The process of interpreting, accepting, or rejecting AI-driven recommendations is nontrivial. Psychological factors, trust calibration, model interpretability, and alignment with domain-specific knowledge all influence human responses. In some cases, AI may support decision-making; in others, it may be overruled or ignored entirely.

It is essential to recognise, however, that humans and AI systems approach decision-making in fundamentally different ways, even when solving the same task. Human reasoning tends to rely on linear heuristics—we often attribute fixed or proportional effects to observable factors. For example, a coach might assume that increasing weekly training volume by 10% leads to a roughly 10% improvement in endurance, or that a taller athlete is uniformly better suited for

a certain position. These assumptions are intuitive, easy to communicate, and often grounded in experience, but they may oversimplify complex relationships.

In contrast, machine learning models—particularly non-linear models like deep neural networks—can capture far more intricate and non-intuitive patterns. For instance, an AI system might discover that the performance benefit of increased training volume depends heavily on sleep quality, recovery time, and past injury history, with effects that vary non-linearly across individuals. Deep learning models are inspired by the structure of the human brain, with layers of interconnected “neurons” that enable them to learn from vast, high-dimensional data. While this complexity enables more accurate predictions, it also introduces challenges related to interpretability and trust, particularly in high-stakes contexts such as elite sport.

Recognising these fundamental differences in how humans and machines interpret data and draw conclusions underscores the need for structured approaches that facilitate productive collaboration between the two.

### **How Can We Then Bridge This Gap Between Human Intuition and AI Recommendations?**

The prevailing paradigm for integrating AI into decision-making—particularly in complex, high-stakes environments like sport—is the human-in-the-loop framework, which emphasises keeping humans actively involved even as AI systems offer guidance or perform supporting functions. The human-in-the-loop paradigm manifests in varied forms:

- **Low-level automation:** AI delivers information (e.g., fatigue index), but humans decide.
- **Intermediate automation:** AI suggests decisions (e.g., lineup adjustments), which are reviewed by humans.
- **High-level automation:** AI executes decisions autonomously (e.g., in Hawk-Eye adjudication).

The human-in-the-loop paradigm is often presented as a safeguard against over-automation, assuming that human experts have the ability to improve upon AI suggestions. However, its efficacy depends critically on the actual skillset of the human experts and how well their roles are defined, supported, and respected within the interaction loop.



*Assoc. Prof. Agni Orfanoudaki from the University of Oxford, and also a member of the IOC AI Working Group, during her lecture.*

### **Why, in an Era of Increasing Automation, Should Humans Remain in the Loop?**

There are several compelling reasons why human involvement remains not only desirable but essential in AI-supported decision-making—especially in domains as complex, high-stakes, and emotionally textured as sport.

First, human expertise includes forms of knowledge that are tacit, experiential, and ethically grounded, which are often inaccessible to algorithmic systems. Coaches, for example, routinely incorporate cues that are difficult to formalise, such as shifts in body language, interpersonal tensions, or knowledge of an athlete's mental well-being. A machine learning model may optimise for physical

performance based on available biometric data, but it cannot contextualise that performance within the athlete's broader psychological or social circumstances. In this way, purely data-driven recommendations risk being technically accurate yet situationally inappropriate.

Second, the social dynamics of sport resist full formalisation. Athletic environments are not only performance-driven but also deeply relational. Trust, motivation, communication style, leadership, and team cohesion all influence outcomes, yet these factors are difficult to observe, let alone quantify, in standard datasets. The coach–athlete relationship, for instance, operates on more than just measurable outcomes—it involves empathy, timing, and moral authority. These are dimensions that current AI systems, however sophisticated, cannot yet replicate or evaluate meaningfully.

Moreover, sport is often characterised by contextual variability and value pluralism. What constitutes a “good decision” may vary depending on strategic goals, team culture, ethical considerations, or long-term athlete development plans. AI systems may optimise narrowly defined objectives—such as maximising short-term win probabilities or minimising injury risk—but such metrics do not always align with holistic or principled coaching philosophies.

Together, these factors help explain why the dominant paradigm in contemporary AI integration is the human-in-the-loop framework. It preserves a meaningful role for human judgment even as AI systems provide analytic support or perform auxiliary tasks.

### **The Automation Trade-Off: Speed vs. Expertise**

This brings us to one of the central tensions in human–AI collaboration: the trade-off between automation and human oversight. Automated systems offer undeniable advantages—speed, scale, and consistency. They can process large volumes of data rapidly and apply objective criteria without fatigue or bias drift. In contexts where timing is critical—such as real-time tactical adjustments or injury alerts—these capabilities are invaluable.

Yet these benefits often come at a cost. Automation may streamline routine tasks, but in doing so, it can also reduce the opportunity for human engagement, diminishing the exercise of professional judgment and potentially leading to over-reliance on algorithmic output.



The challenge, then, is not simply to determine whether to automate, but how much, when, and under what conditions. This trade-off becomes especially salient in sport, where split-second decisions must be balanced against long-term development, ethical considerations, and the preservation of human skill.

One prominent example is the use of AI-assisted judging systems in aesthetic sports such as gymnastics or figure skating. These systems excel at measuring technical precision—quantifying body angles, rotation speed, or balance with a level of objectivity and consistency that is difficult for human judges to match. This can reduce biases and scoring variability, contributing to a more standardised evaluation process. However, these same systems often struggle to assess qualities such as artistic expression, musical interpretation, and emotional impact—elements that are central to the identity and appreciation of these sports. While machines offer rigour in technical domains, it is human judges who remain essential for interpreting the more subjective, performative dimensions of athletic expression.

A second case involves AI-powered talent identification in globally accessible sports like track and field. Machine learning models can process vast amounts of biometric and performance data, making it possible to identify emerging athletes from regions traditionally underserved by scouting networks. This introduces a powerful tool for scaling and democratising early talent recognition. Yet these systems tend to focus solely on observable performance metrics, often ignoring sociopolitical context. Factors such as limited access to facilities, unequal exposure to competition, or restrictive selection systems can obscure genuine potential. Here again, human expertise is necessary—not to replace the algorithm, but to interpret its findings within a broader, ethically and culturally informed understanding of athlete development.

These tensions reveal that optimisation for efficiency does not always align with optimisation for judgment or equity. The correct balance depends on both task characteristics and the relative proficiency of the human counterpart.

## **Behavioural Patterns in Human–AI Interaction**

Empirical research on human-in-the-loop systems reveals that, over time, users often drift toward behavioural extremes in their interaction with AI [5-6]. Specifically, two dominant patterns tend to emerge:

- **Over-reliance:** Users begin to uncritically follow AI recommendations, defaulting to the system's outputs without independent assessment or contextual reasoning.
- **Systematic disregard:** Alternatively, users may habitually ignore AI suggestions, viewing them as irrelevant or untrustworthy, effectively sidelining the system altogether.

Both behaviours undermine the intended synergy of human–AI collaboration. Over-reliance risks deskilling and a gradual erosion of domain-specific intuition. If decision-makers consistently defer to algorithmic outputs, they may lose the capacity to perform the task independently. In sport, this could mean athletes who rely on AI feedback to such an extent that they no longer internalise tactical adjustments, or coaches who become dependent on automated video analysis and neglect their observational acumen. This phenomenon is not merely theoretical. Pilot studies in radiology and aviation demonstrate a measurable decline in skill when operators become passive overseers rather than active participants [7-8].

On the other hand, systematic disregard of AI recommendations limits potential performance gains and introduces inefficiencies. These tendencies highlight the importance of interaction design—how, when, and in what form AI communicates with human users.

### **Toward Adaptive Human–AI Coordination: Planner Agents**

These patterns underscore a deeper challenge: static models of human–AI interaction may be insufficient in dynamic, real-world environments like sport. What is needed is a more flexible, adaptive approach to coordination: one that dynamically adjusts the level and form of AI involvement based on the evolving context and the human user's state. An emerging avenue of research that we are exploring involves the development of planner agents—a second layer of AI designed to optimise the human–AI relationship itself. Rather than offering recommendations directly, these systems decide when and how to engage the human user, with the goal of maintaining skill, trust, and cognitive readiness.

Such agents might modulate AI involvement based on task complexity, user fatigue, or historical accuracy. For instance, in a coaching context, the planner agent could selectively withhold recommendations during routine tasks

to encourage skill retention and intervene only in high-stakes or unfamiliar scenarios.

This form of meta-adaptation—AI managing AI—represents a frontier in collaborative intelligence design and offers potential safeguards against deskilling while enhancing performance.

## Conclusion

As sport enters a new phase of technological integration, the role of AI will continue to expand. However, the most enduring contributions will not arise from full automation, but from systems that enhance rather than displace human agency.

The Olympic Movement, grounded in ideals of excellence, respect, and human development, provides a unique normative lens through which to evaluate this evolution. AI in sport must serve not only as a tool for optimisation, but also as a force aligned with the broader human values that define the spirit of Olympism.

The central challenge we face is not whether to adopt AI, but how to do so in a manner that sustains human expertise, promotes ethical interaction, and preserves the deeply human dimensions of athletic endeavour.

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## THE IMPACT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ON OLYMPIC TELEVISION COVERAGE: THE CASE OF OLYMPIC BROADCASTING SERVICES (OBS) AND OLYMPIC CHANNEL SERVICES (OCS)

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### Introduction

As the world enters the age of artificial intelligence (AI), industries across every sector are undergoing profound transformations, and the world of sports media is no exception. Within the Olympic ecosystem there are two key organisations, both under the International Olympic Committee, that are predominantly engaged in producing and distributing the live and recorded media coverage of Olympic sports, both during the Olympic Games and in the “flame to flame period” in-between: the Olympic Broadcasting Services (OBS) and Olympic Channel Services (OCS).

OBS, founded in 2001, is responsible for the host broadcasting of all editions of the Olympic Games and Youth Olympic Games. Its dual mandate is to produce and provide comprehensive and unbiased television coverage of all Olympic competitions to Media Rights Holders (MRHs) and to deliver the essential technical infrastructure and services needed by these rights holders to conduct their own unilateral coverage. On the digital front, OCS, founded in 2015, manages [www.olympics.com](http://www.olympics.com), the IOC’s official fan-facing digital platform, providing round-the-clock audio-video and textual content, highlights, interviews, and features that keep audiences engaged year-round with Olympic sports and athletes.

The advent of AI has brought about a revolution in the scope and effectiveness of both OBS and OCS operations. From live broadcast enhancements and real-time analytics to personalised content delivery and automated editorial tools, AI technologies are redefining the Olympic viewing experience. This document explores the wide-ranging impacts of the AI revolution on Olympic television coverage through the lens of OBS and OCS, examining the innovations introduced, their implications for the industry, and the broader future of Olympic media.

### **AI in Olympic Broadcasting Services (OBS)**

OBS serves as the operational engine behind the global broadcast of the Olympic Games. As the host broadcaster, OBS not only captures and produces live coverage but also develops the technological ecosystem that enables international media partners to deliver Olympic content to their audiences. The integration of AI into OBS's operations started as early as the Pyeongchang Winter Olympic Games of 2018 and has increased and deepened ever since. In those times, OBS had already started experimenting and operating AI of the predominantly ML (Machine Learning) and DL (Deep Learning) architectural variants. Certain technological breakthroughs in the early 2010s had already elevated ML/DL to valuable tools in the broad area of "pattern recognition" for still and moving pictures. Such functionality is always important for video and audio search in massive content archives, for example those containing the TV coverage of past Olympic Games.

Today, and especially after the latest major deployments during the Olympic Games in Paris 2024, AI of both the ML/DL and LLM flavours is being extensively used by OBS and OCS in their production needs for the coverage of the Olympic events. As there is no wish to deploy technology just for the sake of it, OBS and OCS have attached three main objectives and expectations to the ever-growing introduction of AI into their services and workflows: enhancing the viewer experience, optimising production workflows, and increasing planning and operational efficiency.

## Enhancing the Viewer Experience

OBS's use of AI to elevate viewer experience has been particularly notable in recent editions of the Olympic Games, culminating in significant advancements for Paris 2024. Innovations have included the following:

**Multi-Camera Replays or MUCAR:** AI enables the synchronisation and automated stitching of multiple pictures from a number of still cameras to provide seamless, multi-angle, slow-motion replays of critical moments. This feature enhances the fan experience by delivering a detailed visual representation of athlete performance from multiple angles, especially in sports requiring technical precision such as gymnastics, basketball, etc. (Figure 1)

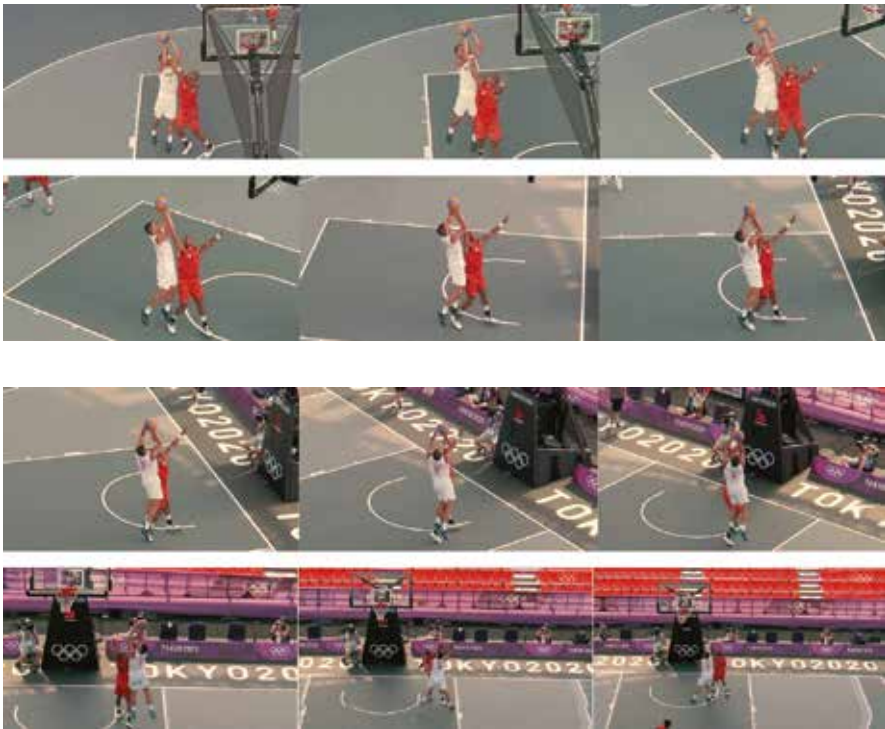


Figure 1: In the Paris 2024 Games, MUCAR technology was deployed for 21 different sports and disciplines.

**Athlete and Object Tracking:** Through collaboration with partners like OMEGA, which is the official timekeeper of the Olympic Games, AI-powered

tracking systems are now used in several sports including rowing, sailing, and marathon running. These systems offer real-time data visualisations of athlete positioning, movement, and speed, providing an enriched broadcast experience. Such features are essential in many sports, where recognising the exact athletes or the apparatus that they may be using can be challenging for the television audience (quite often this is the case even for the local spectators, too). This is, for example, the case with sailing or marathons, where, despite the use of flags on the sails or bibs on the athletes' attire, it may not always be easy for the remote audience to distinguish what is what and who is who. (Figure 2)



*Figure 2*

**Intelligent Stroboscopic Replay:** This tool captures and analyses sequences of athlete movements, breaking them down into visual snapshots. It allows viewers to examine athletic form and technique more closely, contributing to greater appreciation and understanding of the sport. AI is predominantly employed for separating the athletes' bodies from the background and allowing for the creation of a much more engaging visual effect where the "stills" from the athletes' activity are presented over an always live background beside them. (Figure 3)





Figure 3

**Enhanced Data Graphics:** Used in disciplines like running or diving, these graphics analyse athletes’ body positions using AI-generated skeletons, allowing broadcasters to explain scoring criteria, performance differences and variation in techniques in real time. A good example is the graphical representation of the 100 meters’ run where the run can be replayed graphically while providing for the instant speed of the individual athletes, both numerically but also as a “heat diagram”. (Figure 4)



Figure 4

**Serve Reaction Time:** In tennis, AI detects subtle body movements to measure reaction time to serves, offering real-time performance metrics to viewers. The audience can then appreciate, for the first time with objective data, the explosive responsiveness of the best athletes that allow them to react effectively to the serve hits of their opponents, essentially milliseconds after the serve was performed. (Figure 5)



Figure 5

**Ball and Arrow Tracking:** For sports such as table tennis, archery, or golf, AI tools visualise ball spin, arrow trajectory, and ball placement, adding a layer of detail that can enhance audience understanding and thus engagement. The audience can, for the first time, have visual proof of the curved trajectories of balls or arrows, along with detailed numerical information on the speed of spin of balls, which is a main contributor to the curvature of the trajectories in the first place. (Figure 6)



Figure 6

Such AI-driven graphical and numerical enhancements allow OBS to present Olympic events with greater clarity, accuracy, and immersion, enriching the viewing experience for both dedicated fans and new audiences.

### Optimising Broadcast Workflows

AI also plays a crucial role in streamlining OBS's content production processes. Major advancements include the following:

**Automatic Highlights Generation:** OBS utilised the Intel® Geti™ platform to train AI models that automatically detect key moments during the live competition. These models can then be used to produce tailored highlights across multiple disciplines, creating content that is instantly distributable to global audiences. Overall OBS, along with its partner Intel, prepared trained models for 21 sports and disciplines which were then used to produce more than 80,000 highly customised highlight clips during the Paris 2024 Games. More than 13,000 such clips were automatically produced just for athletics. Automated audio-video repurposing from the original live sports coverage, for example, in the shape of highlights or similar type of clips, is a very important type of new content generation, since it is this type of content that is predominantly consumed on social media platforms. One additional important feature of this

platform, also based on AI training of the ML type, is its ability to automatically generate vertically shaped videos out of the originally recorded horizontal ones. (Figure 7, Figure 8)

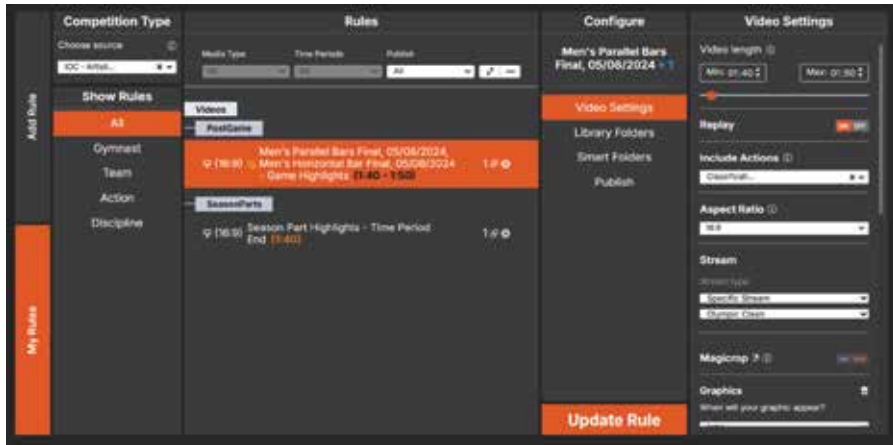


Figure 7

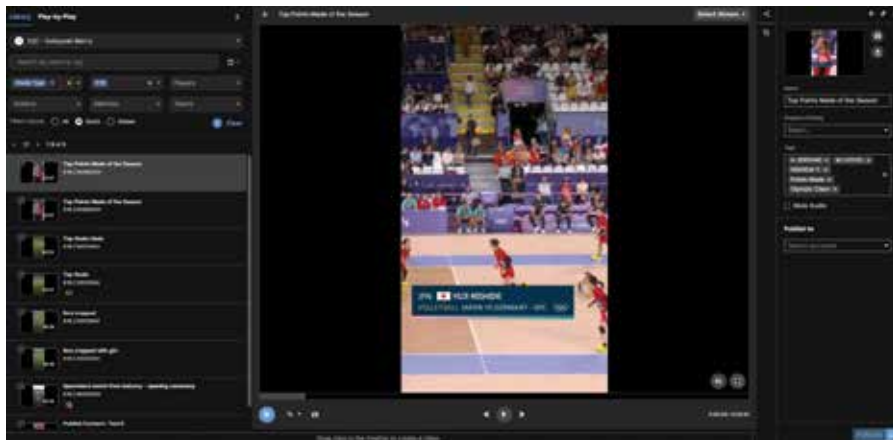


Figure 8

**Generative Assisted Editing:** AI systems assist human editors by recommending optimal cuts, angles, and transitions, from the recorded live television signals. In this case, the AI models are acting as “content creation co-pilots” to human producers and editors, helping them post-produce engaging new content and

Games/Athletes/Host City related stories with a fraction of the effort needed in an unassisted manner. This methodology not only reduces manual labour but accelerates content turnaround, which is a crucial metric for successful content distribution in the context of a live sports event. The Generative Assisted Editing toolset has been developed in-house by OBS engineers and mainly functions by generating markers based on live commentary transcripts and large language model (LLM) summaries, integrated with market-available video editing tools. (Figure 9)

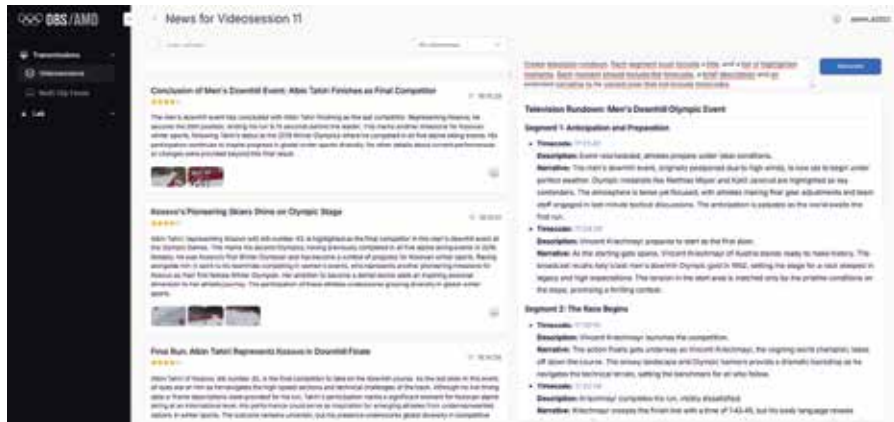


Figure 9

**AI-Powered Logging and Content Classification:** AI automatically logs live footage, tags key moments, and classifies content by sport, athlete, or nation. This supports faster content retrieval and targeted storytelling. Computer vision technology, together with new multimodal LLMs, is used to analyse video and extract descriptions that can be semantically correlated with natural language search queries without the need for specific keywords. The integrated application, also built internally by the OBS engineering team, generates video descriptions and automatic tagging of visual elements, actions, players, emotions, etc., that can then be browsed and searched using natural language. (Figure 10)



Figure 10

## Improving Planning and Operational Efficiency

In the operational domain, OBS has embraced AI to streamline internal processes and reduce the significant burden of planning the host broadcasting of a large multisport event like the Olympic Games. Planning the television coverage of the Olympic Games is a highly complex and laborious endeavour that takes years to complete and requires the active collaboration of hundreds of professionals that work directly or indirectly for OBS, the Media Rights Holders, the International Olympic Committee and the local Olympic Organising Committee. Planning workflow automation is essential for overall efficiency but also to help meet with the stringent deadlines for the planning of an event with immovable dates. Traditional process automation tools, however, have been of limited help due to their inherent inflexibility and weaknesses in imitating the organic nature and amenability of the interaction between human collaborators. AI, and especially of the recent LLM type, with its ability with human language interchange and (limited, but growing) reasoning, is allowing for a serious resurrection of the concept of process re-engineering. OBS is currently quite active in using such tools to enhance and optimise its own planning workflows, either between its own personnel or in its interaction with external third parties, like service providers or the Media Rights Holders.

Currently, OBS has already established Conversational Virtual Assistants/

Agents (CVAs) which have been integrated with two of its most important planning tools: the GRPS which handles the hiring and all related logistics of its 8,000+ strong Games Time crews, and the DoS which handles the technical services bookings of all the Media Rights Holders. Both platforms now utilise CVAs to help their users navigate through the quite complex steps that are required for them to self-provision all the related logistics around their presence in the Games (which is the case with GRPS), or the quantities and detailed specifications of all the technical services that OBS should provide to them during Games times (which is the case with DoS).

### AI in Olympic Channel Services (OCS)

While OBS focuses on the Olympic Games TV coverage on behalf of the Media Rights Holders, OCS complements these efforts by managing the IOC's digital storytelling and fan engagement platforms. The primary responsibility of OCS is to maintain and develop [www.olympics.com](http://www.olympics.com) and its associated digital properties. Through the use of AI, OCS delivers personalised, engaging, and contextually relevant content to fans worldwide.

### Editorial Copilot and Content Creation

OCS has integrated AI into its editorial processes to support content creators. Automated “assistants” use a range of information sources, including existing content and Olympic data, together with AI models to suggest content ideas, while also providing verified facts to speed up the writing process. The Editorial Copilot is an AI assistant that aids the OCS writers and content editors throughout the editorial workflow:

**Brainstorming and Ideation:** It suggests topics based on trending themes and audience interests.

**Drafting and Editing:** The tool enhances grammar, improves narrative flow, and tailors the tone to suit different demographics.

**Emotional Impact:** It provides suggestions to boost the emotional resonance of stories, increasing viewer engagement.

By augmenting human creativity, the Editorial Copilot allows OCS to produce higher-quality content more efficiently and faster.



## Real-Time Fan Engagement and Trend Detection

OCS uses AI to monitor user behaviour and identify, in real-time, engagement patterns across [www.olympics.com](http://www.olympics.com). The trained models function over several different data streams that are indicators of particular fan engagement. More specifically, website traffic analysis is performed in real-time to identify key moments during competitions which trigger user excitement. These moments are scored per country, allowing OCS to highlight events with the highest emotional and cultural relevance for different audiences. Consequently, a “story amplification” process is initiated, which allows for the timely promotion of underrepresented sports or athletes who are gaining unexpected attention. (Figure 11)

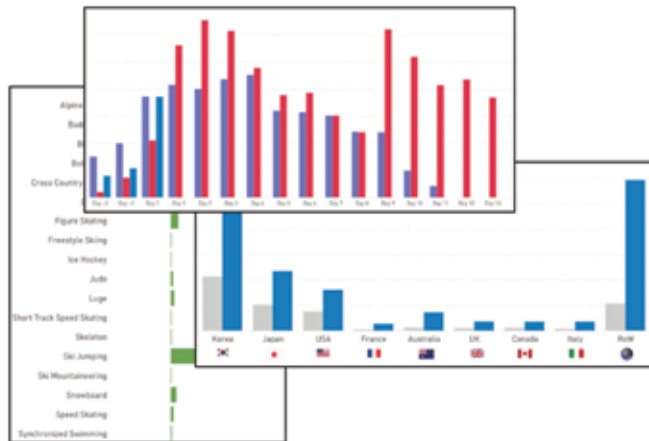


Figure 11

This approach ensures that editorial focus aligns with live audience interests, creating a very effective feedback loop which further drives engagement and makes certain that interest is well served and enhanced well beyond the few already well-known popular athletes or competition sessions (i.e., finals between traditional contestants etc.)



## Personalised and Localised Storytelling

Apart from supporting focused content creation and editing, AI also enables OCS to distribute content that is tailored to individual preferences and regional contexts. AI is an essential element of the [www.olympics.com](http://www.olympics.com) personalisation engine, aimed at delivering properly selected content to individual fans that mostly meets their own interests. The engine is comprised of several modules that, collectively, aim to better “understand the expectations” of the individual user/Olympics fan and then serve her/him with the content that mostly satisfies these expectations. A number of these modules are described below:



*Guillermo Jimenez Navarro analysed how OBS and OCS have incorporated AI on Olympic television coverage.*

*Localised Content Delivery Module:* AI identifies which stories are most relevant for specific countries and regions, optimising content distribution towards users from these areas.

*Content Categorisation Module:* By tagging athletes, sports, and narratives, AI ensures fans receive content aligned with their interest on these dimensions.

*Recommendations Module:* This tool enhances user retention by suggesting related content and live events based on the user's previous interactions.

As a result, fans experience a more personal connection with the Olympic Games, its sports and athletes, which enhances loyalty and emotional investment.

## **Implications and Future Outlook**

The integration of AI into OBS and OCS operations marks a transformative era in Olympic media production and distribution. These advancements not only redefine how the Games are covered and consumed but also illustrate broader trends within the global sports ecosystem.

Within the context of a massive multisport event, like the Olympic Games, AI is helping less well-known sports, within particular territories or fan demographics, to obtain higher visibility and, hopefully, gain more extended fan bases. For example, by providing explanatory graphics and data visualisations, AI makes elite sports more accessible to casual viewers and newcomers. Also, tools around trend detection help further promote diverse stories and enhance the visibility of athletes from smaller delegations that are performing well or in an unexpected manner.

A not uncommon criticism regarding big multisport events, where the Olympic Games is the uncontested leader, is about the potential of a negative impact on the host city, due to their size and temporal nature. On that front, AI, with its capacity to substantially optimise content creation workflows, can certainly help, especially in relation to the reduction of the footprint of the media operations in the host city.

Automated content creation and editing can reduce the carbon footprint and financial overhead associated with traditional media operations. Content producers, including OBS and OCS, but also the Media Right Holders, can operate at scale, delivering thousands of content pieces across dozens of disciplines in real time and with a fraction of the local human presence that this would have entailed without the support of AI.

## Conclusion

Artificial intelligence is emerging as a certain game-changer in the realm of Olympic audio-video media production and distribution. Through strategic implementations by Olympic Broadcasting Services and Olympic Channel Services, AI is reshaping how the Games are produced, delivered, and experienced. OBS leverages AI to enhance live coverage and operational efficiency, while OCS uses AI to deliver personalised, relevant content to a global audience. Together, these organisations exemplify how technological innovation can enrich the storytelling and spectacle of the Olympic Games, without, however, triggering an equivalent increase in operational footprint in the host city. As we look toward future editions of the Olympic Games, AI will remain an ever-important tool for the IOC's vision to inspire and connect audiences around the world through the power of sport, while maintaining the size of the local media operations at an optimised level.

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND ETHICS: CHALLENGES AND PROSPECTS THROUGH THE LENS OF THE OLYMPIC SPIRIT

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### **1. Introduction–Historical and Technological Context of Artificial Intelligence**

The rapid development of artificial intelligence (AI) has brought about a significant revolution in our world. AI is not just a technology. It now functions as an agent, and this is the first time in human history that a technology has had the ability to “act autonomously”. The impact of AI extends to every aspect of human activity, from the economy and health to communication and sports.

However, the term AI is very “misused”, as if you ask 10 different people what they think AI is, you will probably get 10 different answers. AI is defined as the human endeavour to create a machine that can mimic human thought.

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1. Mr Panos Bassios made the presentation during the Session.

The term AI was first mentioned and used in 1956 by Mr John McCarthy, then a young mathematician at Dartmouth College.

### *1.1 Historical Approaches and Types of Machine Learning*

Historically, two main “schools/methods of AI” have been developed:

- Symbolic: The older approach, which was based on classical programming principles.
- Sub-symbolic: This was the precursor to Machine Learning (ML), which is a subset of AI (it is essentially the way we use to teach machines)

Machine Learning is categorised into various types, depending on the training method and the data required:

- Unsupervised Learning: This type of learning requires a very large amount of data (Big Data) to discover patterns without predefined labels.
- Supervised Learning: Requires prior (and quite time-consuming and costly) human work to structure the data, as it is based on labelled data.
- Reinforcement Learning: A third type of learning based on “brute force/ trial and error”, which was also the first method of machine learning.

### *1.2 The Three Categories of Artificial Intelligence (AI)*

AI is categorised into three levels, depending on its capabilities in relation to human intelligence.

#### *1.2.1 Narrow AI–(ANI) (Artificial Narrow Intelligence)*

Narrow AI (or Weak AI) is designed and trained to perform a very specific, limited task or set of tasks. It does not have broad cognitive abilities. Examples include digital assistants (such as Siri or Alexa), facial recognition systems, medical imaging and diagnostics systems, recommendation engines, and autonomous vehicles.

#### *1.2.2 General AI–(AGI) (Artificial General Intelligence)*

General AI (or Strong AI) is the level at which an AI system has the ability to understand, learn, apply knowledge, and solve any problem in the same way a human can. It is a system capable of performing any intellectual task that a human being can do. The reason the term AI has now firmly entered our daily lives is the advent of large language models, particularly the first and most

popular one, ChatGPT by OpenAI, which became the first widely accessible and free General AI system. However, it has only “scratched the surface” of General AI, as this stage has not yet been fully achieved.

### 1.2.3 Super AI–ASI (Artificial Super Intelligence)

Super intelligent AI is a hypothetical level where AI would not only mimic but vastly surpass all human capabilities, including scientific creativity, problem-solving and social skills. An ASI would be significantly smarter than the best human minds in every field. Its existence is closely linked to the concept of Technological Singularity and, for now, it remains a utopian, theoretical stage.

### 1.3. Another Categorisation of AI: Traditional versus Generative AI

Another critical categorisation of AI concerns the distinction between Predictive AI (Traditional AI) and Generative AI (GenAI).

Traditional AI:

- Uses predefined rules and algorithms to make decisions and perform specific tasks
- Relies on labelled data for training and making predictions
- Focuses primarily on solving specific problems or tasks
- Is limited in its ability to generate new or original content
- Examples: Forecasting systems (e.g. sales, traffic, etc.), anomaly detection, etc.

Generative AI (GenAI):

- Uses machine learning techniques to generate new content or data
- Can generate new data or content without the need for labelled examples
- Aims at creativity and the creation of new ideas and content
- Learns patterns and structures from data to generate new content
- Is capable of generating original and unique content based on the patterns it has learned
- Examples: ChatGPT, Gemini, DALL-E, Sora, Copilot, Midjourney, etc.

Recently, the concept of Agentic AI has also been introduced, which is an autonomous form of AI that acts autonomously and proactively to achieve a goal (rather than simply responding to commands).

“Agentic AI” describes systems that can:

- Set goals (or break down complex goals into sub-tasks)

- Plan the sequence of their actions
- Take autonomous action (e.g., use external tools, search for information on the internet, and act on our behalf)
- “Reflect” by learning from outcomes and adjusting their future strategy accordingly



*Mr Panos Bassios explored the ethical dimension of artificial intelligence in sport.*

#### *1.4. Ethical Necessity and Olympic Spirit*

The main part of this study aims to analyse the key ethical challenges posed by AI and serves as a foundation for understanding how AI can either enhance or undermine fundamental values, as expressed through the Olympic spirit: Excellence, Respect and Friendship.

AI, as we have already mentioned, brings about profound changes, making ethics not just a philosophical issue but a practical necessity to ensure social justice and human autonomy.

## 2. The Issue of Trust in Artificial Intelligence

At the core of the ethical discussion about AI lies perhaps the greatest issue of all: Trust. For trust to exist in AI systems, adherence to three fundamental principles is primarily required. These are also referenced in the title of this presentation:

- Accuracy
- Consistency
- Explainability

The absence of any of these factors can lead to dangerous and unacceptable results.

### *2.1. Reliability and Transparency Issues*

One of the most significant reliability issues faced by AI, especially large language models (LLMs), is hallucinations. These refer to the production of information by the system that is convincing but, in reality, is inaccurate or completely fabricated. According to the data presented, hallucinations occur in a significant percentage ranging from 3% to 27% of cases and are caused by the inherent limitations of AI systems in their learning and functioning. This mechanical failure directly undermines the accuracy and consistency of the systems, making their use unreliable in critical applications such as healthcare.

At the same time, the lack of explainability poses obstacles to transparency. When algorithms operate as “black boxes”, it becomes impossible to control and understand how they arrive at specific decisions, which undermines user and regulator confidence.

### *2.2. Biases and Social Justice*

An equally critical ethical issue is bias. AI systems are trained on data that reflect existing social structures and inequalities. As a result, AI tends to amplify social biases, resulting in algorithmic decisions that are unfair or discriminatory against certain groups of people. Algorithmic bias directly threatens the principles of respect and justice, which are core values, especially within the context of the Olympic spirit.



### **3. Other Key Ethical Issues of AI**

Beyond issues of trust, the widespread use of AI raises a number of issues that require immediate regulation.

#### *3.1. Data Protection and Autonomy*

A primary issue is data privacy. AI relies on the collection and analysis of vast amounts of personal data, raising serious concerns about how this data is stored, used, and protected from unauthorised access.

Intertwined with this are the issues of autonomy and legal rights. As AI systems make increasingly critical decisions (e.g., in medical diagnosis or the administration of justice), the question arises as to who bears responsibility in the event of an error and how an individual's right to challenge an algorithmic decision is ensured.

#### *3.2. Information Integrity and Intellectual Property Rights*

The rise of Genetic AI (GenAI) has exacerbated the problem of misinformation. AI's ability to produce realistic, false content (such as deepfakes or fake news) threatens public debate and social cohesion.

At the same time, the issue of intellectual property rights (IP) has come to the fore. The use of existing data to train AI models without proper permission or compensation for creators is a legal and ethical challenge that deeply affects the creative industry.

### **4. Ethical Challenges of AI in Sports**

The application of AI in sports offers tremendous potential for improving performance, data analysis and the spectator experience. For example, in tennis, it can provide benefits in enhancing performance and training (analysing opponents' strategies, technical analysis, biomechanics, accuracy in statistics, personalised training), in refereeing and fairness, and injury prevention, as well as in the spectator experience.

However, this integration also raises specific ethical challenges which must be assessed through the lens of Excellence and Fairness. An example of such

challenges is the scandal involving the sports magazine Sports Illustrated that broke in November 2023 when it was revealed that the magazine had published content written, in part or entirely, using artificial intelligence (AI), but had presented it as if it had been written by real people. The magazine had been publishing articles, mainly product reviews and commercial content, under fake author names. The profile photos and biographies of these “authors” were generated with artificial intelligence and did not correspond to real individuals. The use of AI to create both the content and the “authors” was not disclosed to readers, violating fundamental journalistic principles. When the website Futurism exposed the issue, the publishing company initially attempted to quietly remove the content and denied the articles were AI-generated, claiming instead that the material was commercial content from a third-party partner and that the fake bylines were used to “protect the privacy” of the actual authors, a justification that was widely condemned. The scandal prompted strong reactions from the Sports Illustrated employee union and ultimately led to the dismissal of the company’s CEO. It dramatically highlighted the challenges of transparency and ethics brought about by the use of generative AI in the field of mass media.

#### *4.1. Justice, Accessibility and Inequalities*

Accessibility is a key factor. If advanced AI tools that improve training and performance are only available to athletes and organisations with significant financial resources, this creates an uneven playing field. This inequality goes against the principle of fairness and the global dimension of the Olympic Movement.

#### *4.2. AI as “Doping” (?) and Human Oversight*

A particularly intense debate in the world of sport is: “Could AI be considered a form of “doping”? If AI offers a disproportionate technological advantage that exceeds natural ability and human training, then the question arises whether it violates the spirit of fair competition and Excellence.

On the other hand, however, is AI capable of democratising athletes’ access to technology?

Furthermore, it is crucial to ensure human oversight. In sport, decisions made with the help of AI (e.g. in refereeing, injury assessment, etc.) must remain under

the control and final judgement of human factors in order to avoid errors due to algorithmic biases or illusions.

#### *4.3. Athletes' Personal Data and Intellectual Property Rights in Sport*

The use of AI in sport also raises serious concerns regarding athletes' privacy and autonomy. The continuous monitoring of performance, sleep, nutrition and psychological state through sensors and AI systems collects sensitive data. It is essential to ensure that athletes retain full autonomy regarding consent and the use of this data, in accordance with the principle of Respect.

Finally, intellectual property rights in sport relate to the ownership of algorithms created for the analysis of competition strategy or the development of specialised training techniques, as well as the use of athletes' biometric data.

### **5. Conclusions**

Artificial intelligence is transforming our world at every level, from its fundamental operating principles to its modern applications. To ensure that this transformation is beneficial and fair, ethics must be given absolute priority.

Building trust by ensuring accuracy, consistency and explainability, as well as actively addressing bias and hallucinations, are immediate priorities. Furthermore, issues concerning data protection, autonomy and the fight against misinformation require ongoing regulation.

Especially in sport, which is governed by the values of Excellence, Respect and Friendship, the application of AI requires strict ethical frameworks. The debate on accessibility, fairness, intellectual property rights and the autonomy of athletes must guide development policies. Only through the guarantee of human oversight can we ensure that AI serves the Olympic spirit and does not undermine human dignity and the fairness of sport.

## PROTECTING SPORT INTEGRITY IN THE AGE OF AI: RECONSIDERING MATCH-FIXING MONITORING

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### Introduction

Over the past decade, match-fixing monitoring has become an essential component in global efforts to protect the integrity of sport (Forrest & McHale, 2019). A variety of monitoring entities have emerged, including the Global Lottery Monitoring System (GLMS), operated by World Lottery (a coalition of state-sanctioned betting providers) and the International Betting Integrity Association (IBIA), consisting of private betting operators. In parallel, commercial data companies such as Sportradar and Genius Sports offer integrity services, including monitoring, as part of broader commercial data partnership packages with sports organisations (Holden & Schuster, 2019). All of these bodies partner with sports federations, law enforcement agencies and gambling regulators, forming complex transnational networks.

Match-fixing monitoring warrants attention because of its growing influence on how the issue is conceptualised and addressed (Tak, 2022). First, it is a central pillar in the global counter-match-fixing initiative, often serving as the first line of detection (Kerr, 2017). Second, it is a domain that can benefit from technological innovation—particularly artificial intelligence (AI) and data analytics. Third, the monitoring systems do not operate in a vacuum. Behind the

scenes are various stakeholders (bookmakers, data firms, sports organisations, etc.) with their own interests. This raises critical questions: who defines integrity and whose priorities are being served in the fight against match-fixing?

This session aims to briefly (1) unpack the technical architecture of match-fixing monitoring systems, (2) identify the vested interests that influence their operation, and (3) explore how emerging technologies such as AI may bring changes. The focus is not on evaluating the accuracy or efficiency of these systems, but on understanding how these systems function as policy instruments and how they reflect the interests of stakeholders, drawing from a political sociology approach (Lascoumes & Le Galès, 2007).

### **The Technical Make-up of Monitoring Systems**

Match-fixing monitoring systems typically operate through three procedural stages: (1) detecting irregular betting patterns by algorithm-based programmes; (2) reviewing by human experts; and (3) reporting to affiliated sports organisations and law enforcement agencies (Forrest & McHale, 2015). While this section focuses on the first two stages, it is important to note that the final stage—how alerts are used—is also shaped by institutional and political considerations.

#### *Automated Alerts Production*

The first stage is algorithm-based detection of suspicious betting activities. This begins with setting a benchmark: an expected, “normal” progression of betting odds (Tak, 2020). These benchmarks are derived from mathematical models such as a Poisson regression and Elo system which estimate the likelihood of match outcomes based on historical performance data (Forrest & McHale, 2015). However, odds are not purely statistical; they are also adjusted in response to market dynamics, including real-time data feeds, market averages and the influence of mega bookmakers in Southeast Asia, whose odds often serve as global reference points (Tak et al., 2022).

Once the benchmark is set, alerts are triggered when the real-time movement of odds significantly departs from the expected trajectory (Tak, 2020). Configuring these alert parameters requires deciding how sensitive the system should be—whether to cast a “fine-mesh” or “wide-mesh” net (Tak, 2020). For example, lower-tier leagues may trigger alerts with smaller shifts in odds due to

lower liquidity, while top-tier matches require more substantial movement to raise suspicion (Forrest & McHale, 2015).

The detection and alert processes are highly automated, and odds-tracking is made possible by the practice of maintaining a “balanced book” in which bookmakers adjust odds in real time to distribute risk evenly across potential outcomes (Forrest & McHale, 2015). Therefore, odds fluctuate constantly in response to new information, such as team line-ups, goals, red cards or injuries (Feustel & Rodenberg, 2015; Hosmer-Henner, 2010). When odds shift sharply, especially toward unlikely outcomes, this may indicate the presence of privileged or illicit information (Tak et al., 2022). For instance, if bets continue to pour in on a long-shot result until the odds collapse to near certainty (i.e., 1.0), this suggests that bettors may be acting on insider knowledge, potentially linked to match-fixing (Tak, 2020).

### *Human Experts’ Analyses*

Despite the sophistication of automated systems, human intervention remains essential (Tak, 2020). Experts are responsible for setting algorithm thresholds, managing operational protocols and interpreting the flagged data. This introduces a layer of subjectivity into what is often perceived as a purely technical process (Tak, 2020). For example, setting the boundaries of “normal” versus “suspicious” betting is not just a mathematical question but one that is open to interpretation. Once an alert is triggered, analysts review the flagged match to determine whether the odds movement can be explained by legitimate factors. Analysts may conduct online searches, consult betting tip forums and contact local sources to verify whether the odds shift was driven by public information (Tak et al., 2022). Where no such explanations can be found and irrational betting persists, the case is escalated to sport governing bodies or relevant public authorities. This interpretive process is likened to solving a jigsaw puzzle – assembling fragments of information to assess the plausibility of manipulation.

### *Limitations*

Match-fixing monitoring has several limitations. First, alerts per se do not confirm match-fixing; they merely indicate anomalies that warrant further investigation (Tak, 2020). Second, there is no definitive way to test the accuracy of monitoring systems. Because confirmed cases of match-fixing are rare and often rely on

confessions or legal investigations, it is difficult to validate whether alerts correctly identify manipulation (Tak, 2020). Third, while it can track odds across licensed and partnered bookmakers, illegal or underground operators remain off the radar. This means that substantial fixing activity may go undetected, particularly in unregulated markets (Tak et al., 2018).

Finally, external influences can shape how alerts are interpreted and acted upon (Tak, 2020). Once a suspicious match is reported, the decision to act lies with sports governing bodies whose responses may be influenced by internal politics, reputational concerns or long-term organisational interests. In some cases, the risk of political cost or damage to organisational image may outweigh the incentive to pursue disciplinary action. This indicates that monitoring is not a purely scientific process, but one embedded in institutional politics (Tak et al., 2018).

### **Match-fixing Monitoring as an Extension of the Betting Industry's Risk-management?**

While match-fixing monitoring is utilised as a tool to protect sport integrity, its origins and operational logic are rooted in the risk-management practices of the betting industry (Tak et al., 2022). Bookmakers have long employed strategies to minimise losses. From profiling big winners to adjusting odds in real time, the industry has developed sophisticated mechanisms to maintain its “house edge”. In this respect, match-fixing monitoring can be seen as a natural extension of these practices—another way to track and mitigate financial risk (Tak, 2020).

Viewed from this perspective, the betting industry treats sports betting as a rational, probabilistic game between informed punters and odds traders (Tak et al., 2022). Within this tug-of-war, the bookmaker's edge lies in its ability to aggregate data, model outcomes and adjust odds accordingly. Match-fixing is therefore a threat basically because it disrupts this competitive edge. It introduces a form of information asymmetry that cannot be hedged against—insider knowledge that renders standard risk management tactics ineffective and exposes bookmakers to potentially unmanageable losses (Tak et al., 2022).

Accordingly, this perspective defines match-fixing not primarily as an ethical violation, but as a threat to the betting market (Forrest, 2013). From this standpoint, the problem is not that sport itself is corrupted, but that the

probabilistic betting game is rigged (Tak et al., 2023). This contrasts sharply with the ethical framing adopted by sports governing bodies (Moriconi & Almeida, 2019), which emphasises fairness, honesty and the moral value of sport. While both sectors claim to defend “integrity”, they often mean different things by it—sport integrity vs. betting integrity (Tak, 2022). In this regard, the betting industry’s approach has been characterised as an “odds-wise view”—one that frames integrity through the lens of odds distortion (Tak et al., 2022).



*Dr Minhyeok Tak of Loughborough University addressed the challenges surrounding the protection of sports integrity, with particular emphasis on match-fixing cases.*

This raises a critical question: are the monitoring efforts led by betting companies aimed at protecting sport integrity, or are they primarily about safeguarding betting integrity? For many betting operators, participating in integrity programmes brings multiple business interests. For commercial bookmakers, engagement in integrity initiatives offers reputational benefits (Tak et al., 2018). By operating or funding match-fixing monitoring, they can demonstrate responsibility, shielding themselves from public criticism over gambling-related harms such as addiction (McGee, 2020; Sharman, 2020). These efforts function as a form of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR),



allowing companies to market themselves as trustworthy actors in a stigmatised industry.

Moreover, integrity initiatives can help betting firms distinguish themselves from unlicensed competitors (Tak et al., 2022). Membership of monitoring bodies such as the International Betting Integrity Association (IBIA) or the Global Lottery Monitoring System (GLMS) signals a commitment to responsible operation and regulatory cooperation. As one industry insider noted in Tak's (2022) report, "Being a member of [a monitoring body] is a good thing for them to show that they fight match-fixing. It's good to show customers, it's good to show governments, it's good to show gambling authorities in the country" (p. 36).

For data companies, the motivations are slightly different but no less strategic. These firms provide integrity services, including match-fixing monitoring, as part of broader data packages. By offering these services, they can secure exclusive data deals with sports organisations, gaining access to match statistics and live feeds, etc. In this sense, integrity services serve as a gateway to commercial partnerships (Tak et al., 2022).

This business logic helps explain why match-fixing monitoring has become widespread. While the systems may help identify irregularities and deter manipulation, their operation is driven at least in part by the logic of profitability (Tak et al., 2022). Betting companies and data providers use it to build reputational capital, secure regulatory approval and expand their influence within the sport-betting ecosystem. In doing so, they also reshape the very meaning of integrity in sport—aligning it more closely with the needs and norms of the betting industry (Tak, 2022).

In sum, while match-fixing monitoring is often presented as a neutral, technical solution to a shared problem between the sport and betting industries, it is also a political and commercial enterprise. Its logic and implementation reflect the priorities of the betting industry which seeks not only to manage risk but also to legitimise its role. Understanding this "odds-wise" perspective is therefore essential for critically assessing the role of monitoring in the broader discussion on sport integrity.

### **Artificial Intelligence in Match-fixing Monitoring**

Artificial intelligence (AI) is increasingly seen as a promising tool in the fight against match-fixing, particularly in enhancing the detection capabilities of

monitoring systems. By leveraging machine learning (ML) models trained on both “normal” and “fixed” match data, AI might be able to help develop more refined filters that detect anomalies in betting patterns with greater precision and speed (Kim et al., 2024).

One of the key advantages of AI might be its ability to scale and automate anomaly detection. AI-driven systems can instantly respond to market changes, outperforming human analysts in both speed and accuracy. This might be particularly valuable in live betting markets where odds change rapidly and the window for detecting suspicious activity is narrow. AI could also introduce more nuanced classification systems—moving from binary alerts to probabilistic scales (e.g., 0–10 risk scores).

However, the benefits of AI in match-fixing monitoring are likely to be more quantitative than qualitative. While AI can save time, reduce operational costs and improve the consistency of alerts, it might not be able to replace human judgment altogether. In this respect, AI should be seen as a decision-support tool rather than a decision-maker. Just as judicial systems may use AI to assist in sentencing but not to replace judges, match-fixing monitoring might retain human oversight.

Another issue is whether the betting industry is willing to invest in more advanced monitoring systems. Unlike neutral watchdogs such as the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA), betting and data companies are profit-oriented enterprises. Their incentive to detect more fixed matches is arguably limited, especially if doing so risks unsettling the industry’s image or alienating consumers. Excessive exposure of match-fixing cases could be perceived as a threat, particularly in deregulated markets where the legitimacy of sports betting still depends on public trust (Tak et al., 2018).

There are already signs that commercial stakeholders are not prioritising monitoring as a future area of investment. For example, data companies offer monitoring data to partner organisations free of charge, which means that it is not a strong revenue stream (Tak, 2020). Instead, their major investments may focus on profitable opportunities such as fan engagement technologies, predictive analytics for betting markets or tools for customer profiling. AI is far more likely to be deployed in these areas where it helps optimise product development or protect commercial interests than in preventive monitoring where returns are harder to quantify.

In this sense, we might have already reached a form of equilibrium: sufficient

investment in monitoring to satisfy regulatory expectations and manage reputational risk, but not so much as to overwhelm the industry with integrity alerts and disrupt the status quo. AI is more likely to be used to detect arbitrage betting, insider trading or bonus abuse than to uncover match-fixing and reduce customer activity.

Moreover, many of the core limitations of current monitoring systems are unlikely to be resolved by AI alone. These include the inability to track activity in illegal betting markets, ethical concerns around the use of personal data (Chmait & Westerbeek, 2021) and the interpretive nature of alerts (Tak, 2020). Furthermore, the ultimate use of monitoring reports may remain subject to political and organisational considerations (Tak, 2020).

Despite these constraints, AI could open new opportunities, particularly for sport-led monitoring initiatives. As performance analytics becomes more embedded in coaching and athlete development, sports organisations are amassing rich datasets on players' on-field action, match dynamics and tactical patterns (Chmait & Westerbeek, 2021). These data could be repurposed to detect anomalies indicative of manipulation, offering a complementary approach to odds-tracking in betting markets. Such sport-led models could reduce reliance on commercial interests and foster a more autonomous approach to integrity by enabling sports organisations to proactively monitor their own competitions.

## **Concluding Thoughts and Remaining Questions**

Match-fixing monitoring stands at the intersection of technology, policy and commercial interests. Technically, monitoring systems combine algorithmic precision with human judgment. Politically, they operate within multi-stakeholder environments shaped by different interests. Technologically, AI offers new possibilities. Taken together, these dimensions leave us with three fundamental questions to consider.

First, is match-fixing monitoring truly about protecting sport, or is it primarily aimed at safeguarding the betting industry? While advanced as a tool for sport integrity, its design and operation often prioritise the stability and profitability of betting markets—revealing a tilt toward what has been described as an “odds-wise view” (Tak et al., 2022).

Second, how—and to what extent—will AI meaningfully improve match-

fixing monitoring? AI has the potential to enhance the speed, scale and accuracy of anomaly detection. Yet, it cannot address the structural limitations of current systems. Moreover, without stronger incentives, it is unclear whether betting or data companies will invest significantly in AI for integrity purposes, especially when more profitable applications exist elsewhere.

Finally, who should lead the future of the integrity campaign? Currently dominated by private actors, the field could benefit from sport-led initiatives. With growing expertise in data analytics, sports organisations may be better positioned to develop systems that align more closely with their ethical mandates.

These questions remain open for consideration as we navigate the complex battleground of combating match-fixing.

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## EXPLORING THE LINKS BETWEEN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND THE OLYMPIC GAMES FROM THE PERSPECTIVES OF ENERGY, ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY, CLIMATE CHANGE AND METEOROLOGY

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### Introduction

The Olympic Games have long been a stage for human excellence, innovation, and global cooperation. Artificial intelligence (AI) offers powerful tools to address some of the most pressing challenges linked to the Games: energy efficiency, environmental sustainability, climate change, and meteorology. Hosting the Olympics requires vast infrastructure, intensive resource use, and careful planning to minimise environmental impact. AI-driven systems can optimise energy consumption in venues, reduce emissions, and support sustainable urban mobility. In addition, advanced climate and meteorological models powered by AI provide more accurate forecasts, helping organisers safeguard athletes, spectators, and infrastructure against extreme weather. Exploring these intersections highlights not only the potential of AI to enhance the Games, but also its role in shaping a more sustainable and climate-resilient future.

## Some Information on Artificial Intelligence

Artificial intelligence (AI) is the ability of a computer or machine to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence, such as learning, reasoning, problem-solving, understanding language, recognising patterns and detecting trends.

Some examples of AI are:

AI suggests the fastest routes based on traffic data, improves the effectiveness of transportation systems, helps predict extreme weather events like heatwaves or storms, supports the estimation of heat risk at a neighbourhood level and along routes, analyses big data to spot early signs of climate risks (e.g. forest fires, floods), facilitates the construction of carbon neutral venues and supports smart energy grids to balance electricity use, especially in cases of high energy consumption needs.

The main types of AI are:

Generative AI is a type of artificial intelligence that can create new content, such as text, images, music, and videos, based on existing data. It learns patterns from data and then uses those patterns to generate new, unique outputs. This technology has various applications, including chatbots, creative tools, and even scientific research.

Explainable AI refers to methods and techniques that make AI models' decisions transparent and understandable to humans. It helps users understand how AI models generate predictions, build trust, and ensure accountability.

Machine learning (ML) is a branch of AI that focuses on algorithms that can learn from data and make predictions or decisions without being explicitly programmed. These algorithms analyse data, identify patterns, and then use those insights to make informed decisions, improving their performance over time as they are trained on more data.

## AI and the Olympic Games

The integration of artificial intelligence into the Olympic Games represents a transformative approach to addressing operational needs as well as the pressing challenges of energy management, climate change, and environmental sustainability. Beyond immediate operational benefits, AI fosters a broader vision of the Olympics as a model for sustainable mega-events, demonstrating

how cutting-edge technology can reconcile large-scale human activity with environmental and climate responsibility. Next, AI is discussed with respect to specific sections of central interest for the Olympic Games.

### *AI and Environmental Sustainability*

AI can have a significant impact on improving the environmental sustainability of the Olympics in several ways:

**Optimising Resource Management:** AI can help with managing resources like water, energy, and waste during the Games. By using smart systems, AI can track energy consumption in real-time and suggest ways to optimise it, potentially using renewable sources like solar and wind more effectively.

**Sustainable Venue Design:** AI can assist architects and urban planners in designing Olympic venues that minimise environmental impact. It can analyse data to optimise building materials, waste management, and even natural ventilation systems. AI can help model how different design choices affect carbon footprints, water use, and long-term energy consumption.

**Predictive Analytics for Event Planning:** Using historical data and real-time analytics, AI can predict attendance patterns, helping to manage crowd control and reduce congestion. This reduces transportation emissions and energy use, which are some of the biggest environmental concerns at large events like the Olympics.

**Smart Waste Management:** AI systems can optimise waste collection and recycling. For example, AI can analyse waste streams in real-time, categorising and sorting trash automatically, leading to more efficient recycling and less landfill waste.

**Transportation Optimisation:** AI-powered algorithms can improve transportation systems during the Games, reducing congestion and emissions of CO<sub>2</sub> and other gases. It can optimise public transit schedules, direct people to less crowded routes, and manage traffic flow using real-time data. This can significantly cut down on carbon emissions from transportation, which is a major concern during large events.

### *AI and Energy*

Sports stadiums and venues are energy intensive when they are in use for the Olympic Games and associated events. Building management systems are used



to control and monitor various systems and functions of a building and create a lot of data. Implementing AI in smart buildings that have sensors and Internet of Things technology can maximise energy efficiency. In addition, AI algorithms can analyse and interpret building management systems data to make real-time adjustments to heating, cooling and lighting systems. This can optimise energy consumption and reduce overall environmental impact as well as the emission of greenhouse gases.



*Prof. Constantinos Cartalis, former Secretary General at the Greek Ministry of Culture for the Olympic Games 2004, addressed the links between AI and the Olympic Games, highlighting issues related to energy, environmental sustainability, climate change and meteorology.*

### *AI and Climate Change*

The main sources of CO<sub>2</sub> emissions in the Olympic Games are:

Construction of venues and infrastructure: Building stadiums, athlete villages, and transportation systems produces a large amount of embodied carbon.

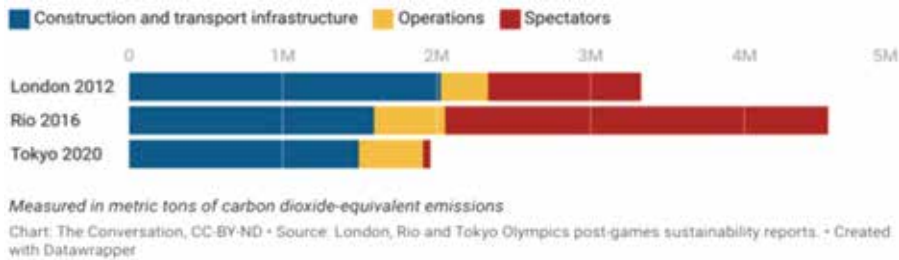
Transportation: Flights and ground travel for athletes, officials, media, and spectators generate substantial emissions.

Energy use during the games: Lighting, broadcasting, heating/cooling, and operations consume significant electricity, often sourced from fossil fuels.

Accommodation and tourism: The influx of visitors increases energy use in hotels, restaurants, and local services.

Waste and materials: Handling and disposal of materials can add to the carbon footprint.

Below, a breakdown of the greenhouse gas emissions for the Summer Games in London, Rio and Tokyo is presented. The analysis shows that construction and spectators' activities are the largest sources.



AI can support carbon offset and sustainability tracking from construction to travel. It can suggest carbon-offset programmes and can analyse the best ways to offset emissions, like planting trees and investing in renewable energy and smart buildings that are energy efficient, ensuring that the Olympic Games are as carbon-neutral as possible.

In addition, AI can analyse vast datasets to predict climate change impacts that may affect the capacity of areas to host the Olympic Games (for instance areas exposed to heat waves of increased frequency, duration and intensity or areas expected to be exposed to reduced snowfall). It can also evaluate the effectiveness of different climate adaptation and risk prevention policies and measures

## AI and Weather

In a world of increasingly extreme weather, fast and accurate forecasts are crucial for an event of the size and complexity of the Olympic Games. Adverse weather can impact open venue sporting events and energy supplies, result in traffic jams, and, overall, disrupt the operations of the OG.

AI can help monitor and predict extreme weather events, thus enhancing

disaster preparedness. The use of AI has made predictions faster and gradually more reliable. This could enable organisers to take the necessary actions to adapt or postpone events to ensure athlete, staff and spectator safety, provide welfare advice earlier to participants, assess damage from natural disasters, and improve resource allocation during emergencies.

## Conclusions

AI is transforming the Olympic Games by enhancing energy efficiency, climate resilience, and environmental sustainability. Through predictive analytics, smart resource management, and accurate weather forecasting, AI helps organisers minimise ecological impact, ensure safety, and optimise operations, demonstrating how technology can support both the spirit of competition and a sustainable, climate-conscious future. However, it is human intelligence—cognition, strategic thinking, problem-solving, and foresight—that ultimately shapes the success, resilience, and evolution of the Games. Human skills underpin not only athletic excellence but also organisational efficiency, cultural insight, and the ability to navigate complex challenges, ensuring that AI's potential is effectively harnessed to create a safer, smarter, and more sustainable Olympic experience.

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## OLYMPIC AI AGENDA

**Julian DADDY (IOC)**

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International Olympic Committee*



I'm here today to talk to you about the exciting initiatives that we have already delivered over the last 12 months. But first of all, I'd like to take you back to 12 months ago, when we launched the Olympic AI Agenda. It has marked a significant point in the moment of what we are planning to do in the future. Over the 12 months, we have made significant progress across the key priorities that were identified in that agenda, not just for the IOC, but for the entire Olympic Movement. Before we dive into what's been done, let's just take a moment to step back. What is the Olympic AI Agenda and why do we need it? While AI is not new—it began in the 1950s—recent developments, such as the generative AI tools like ChatGPT that we've all seen, have significantly accelerated its adoption and visibility. It's important for the IOC to assess both the risks and the opportunities that this technology presents, not only for the IOC but also for the Olympic Movement and sport in general.

We also asked, how can we leverage AI to accelerate the Olympic Agenda 2025? We believe AI has the potential to drive transformation across sport and to advance the Olympic values of fairness, excellence, and solidarity. This is why the IOC, together with key stakeholders and external industry experts, worked on this strategy document which was launched in London last year. If you've not read the AI Agenda yet, I do invite you to go to the [olympics.com](https://olympics.com) website and read it.

To bring this agenda to life, the IOC must embrace three vital roles. Pioneer,

catalyst, and guardian. As a pioneer, the IOC will spearhead the development and management of cutting-edge AI technologies that boost efficiency and open up exciting new possibilities for the IOC and the Olympic Movement and for the world of sports, whether that is streamlining operations or creating unforgettable experiences for fans. As catalysts, the IOC needs to champion AI initiatives by providing essential resources, fostering collaboration among partners, and ensuring that knowledge is shared across the entire Olympic community.

We will see a network where ideas flow freely, partnerships thrive, and everyone benefits from the collective wisdom. As a guardian, the IOC must ensure that AI is developed and utilised responsibly. This involves promoting accessibility, inclusion, and ethical standards so that AI in sports serves everyone everywhere. Think of this as a force for good, making sports more inclusive, fair, and enjoyable for all. By taking on these roles, the IOC can transform the Olympic AI Agenda into reality that enriches the world of sports and beyond. The AI Agenda also sets out five guiding principles. The first is to foster an ethos of integrity. We will champion high standards of transparency, responsibility, and safety. This commitment will help us maintain trust while we harness the transformative power of AI in our quest to improve access and fairness. We will leverage technology to break down barriers to participation and ensure equal access to sports and the benefits of AI.

This approach will enhance fairness and drive positive social and environmental change. Together with our partners, we will scale the creation and distribution of moments that matter. By using AI technologies, we will craft a memorable and inspiring personalised experience for fans and stakeholders across the Olympic Movement, while also honouring our timeless Olympic traditions and values. We will embrace innovation. AI will open up new possibilities for the Olympic Movement, allowing us to stay true to our heritage while exploring new frontiers. Finally, collaboration is key to our success. We will work with stakeholders both inside and outside the Olympic Movement to share knowledge about opportunities and risks. This collective effort will support and sustain future impact.

Good governance has always been a top priority for the IOC, and it's crucial to manage AI risks. Here's how we ensure AI is trustworthy. AI should reflect Olympic values like fairness, sustainability, teamwork, and integrity. It should support the broader goals of the Olympic community in a responsible way. AI must be safe and secure for everyone and everything involved. It should be

protected against misuse and cyber threats. AI should work accurately even when faced with unexpected situations. It should protect against misuse and cyber threats. AI should actually work. Everyone should know their roles and responsibilities. Clear policies and processes help ensure accountability. AI should be accessible to everyone in the Olympic community. It should be fair and free from bias. Users should know how their data is collected and how AI outputs should be used. This transparency will build trust. Data handling should also respect privacy expectations. This means collecting only necessary data and protecting sensitive information. By following these principles, the IOC can build a trustworthy AI governance framework that supports the Olympic Movement and values. The Agenda also sets out four commitments as we pursue the initiatives that I will come to.

In addition to the AI Agenda, which serves as our strategic document, we've developed an IOC AI roadmap. This roadmap is designed to evolve over time, ensuring that we stay ahead of achievements and advancements in the opportunities provided by AI. We've established an internal AI team and governance mechanism to oversee our AI initiatives. Currently, we are developing a trustworthy AI framework for the Olympic Movement. This framework will guide the future application of AI in alignment with Olympic values. Our goal is to provide a simple tool and checklist to help people assess the risks and opportunities of AI.

We've also begun to work with worldwide Olympic partners to support the implementation of our AI ambitions. This collaboration aims to address risk identification and mitigation, ensuring that our AI initiatives are both effective and secure. Through internal consultations and ongoing discussions with stakeholders across the Olympic Movement, we've identified hundreds of potential opportunities for AI. Several initiatives have already been carried out, providing valuable learnings. I will share some of these concrete examples of these initiatives. Together, these commitments will drive innovation and shape the future of sport through AI. In 2024, 13 key AI projects were conducted across five focus areas that we identified. These areas include supporting clean competition and safe sport for athletes, ensuring equal access to the benefits of AI, and optimising the Games' operations with a focus on sustainability, growing engagement with people, and driving efficiency across the management of the IOC and sports.

Here are some examples that we deployed during the Paris 2024 Games

and some deliveries we've planned for this year across these focus areas. During Paris 2024, we hosted an exciting Intel AI platform experienced near the iconic Stade de France. This event was a hit. It drew in over 10,000 participants who were eager to test their physical abilities through a series of interactive activities using cutting-edge AI technology. Participants' speed, strength, and reaction time were assessed, creating unique profiles for each individual. Then the AI system worked its magic, matching those profiles to the Olympic sports that best suited their attributes. It was fascinating to see the results. Decathlon and Heptathlon emerged as the most commonly identified sports among fans, showcasing their diverse skill sets, on the other hand, rowing was the least identified sport. This activation not only provided a fun and engaging experience but also demonstrated the incredible potential of AI in sports. It was a memorable event.

Also, during Paris 2024, the IOC took a significant step to protect athletes by implementing an Athlete Cyber Abuse Protection Service. This pilot initiative was designed to shield athletes from online harassment in real time, ensuring a safer digital environment. The system was impressive for a proof of concept. Monitoring over 20,000 social media accounts across various platforms. It analysed content in more than 35 languages to detect harmful posts. In total, over 2.4 million posts and comments mentioning athletes, teams, or officials were reviewed by the system. Of those, 10,200 were identified as abusive and reported to the platform for removal. The system revealed that 353 athletes and officials were directly targeted by 8,900 unique accounts. This initiative not only highlighted the importance of protecting athletes online but also demonstrated the IOC's commitment to creating a safer and more respectful environment for everyone involved in the Olympic Movement.

The final example in this focus area was our Athlete GPT application, which was actually embedded into the Athlete365 application launched in Paris. This conversational ChatBot was designed to help athletes and their teams access important information during the Olympic Games. This tool provided quick answers to questions about operational procedures, policies, and other Olympic-related knowledge. Athletic GPT handled over 1,000 queries in six different languages, with peaks of 147 queries per hour. This system allowed athletes to answer questions about social media, competition, photos, and getting tickets for family members. The success of Athlete GPT was evident, with over 8,000 press mentions highlighting its positive impact. This innovative tool made it easier for athletes and their teams to navigate the Olympic experience.

Moving on to our second focus area, ensuring equal access to the benefits of AI, in March 2024, we embarked on an exciting journey to Senegal to pilot an AI-based talent identification initiative. Our goal was to support early talent discovery ahead of the Youth Olympics in Dakar 2026.

In just one week, over 1,000 children took part in this exciting initiative that required nothing more than a simple smartphone app to record their basic movements. No expensive equipment was needed, making it accessible to everybody. The AI system analysed 1,000 biometric data points for each child, including speed, acceleration, and agility. This thorough analysis identified forty children with strong athletic potential. This approach not only made the process faster and more objective but also ensured it was accessible even in areas without formal sports infrastructure. It was a fantastic way to discover and nurture young talent.

Also in this focus area, we are looking at delivering an NOC AI Assistant. It is currently in the final testing phase, and it's set to revolutionise how Committees access information. National Olympic Committees typically rely on a platform called NOCnet, which hosts a vast array of documents and operational resources. However, finding specific information, such as how to apply for a grant, can be quite challenging. In collaboration with Alibaba, this new AI assistant aims to make the process much faster and more intuitive, ensuring that NOCs can quickly and easily find the information they need. It's all about making their experience smoother and more efficient.

Moving on to our third focus area, about optimising Olympic and Paralympic Games sessions operations with a focus on sustainability, in the run-up to the Paris Games, we leveraged digital twins to simulate and plan various aspects of the Paris Games. These virtual models allow us to optimise operations and reduce costs through precise and accurate simulations. Additionally, they help reduce environmental impact by minimising the number of on-site visit teams needed. AI plays a crucial role in processing and analysing the data from these systems, predicting outcomes, and enhancing our planning decisions. This combination of digital twins and AI ensures that we can create an efficient and more environmentally friendly experience for everyone involved. We also made groundbreaking achievements by delivering a cloud-based energy platform in partnership with Alibaba. This marks a first for major events as it integrates both live and historical data from multiple sources. For Paris 2024, we installed 100



real-time meters across various venues, allowing operational teams to monitor energy use and detect faults live.

This innovative approach has never been followed at the Games before. The system does not only pull data from Paris, but also incorporates benchmarks from Games in the past like Tokyo, PyeongChang, and London. This platform is a key component of our sustainability goals. It improves energy diagnostics, enables cost savings, and informs smarter design decisions for future host cities. Looking ahead, we plan to expand this initiative to Milan Cortina, and Dakar. We're also in discussion to integrate AI-powered real-time monitoring to further enhance performance and efficiency. This is a significant step towards a more sustainable and efficient future for the Olympic Games.



*Julian Daddy, Head of Enterprise Architecture at the IOC presented the Olympic AI Agenda.*

On to the fourth focus area, which is about growing engagement with people. You may have seen black and white footage turned into colour before, but traditionally this has been a manual or semi-automatic frame-by-frame process with the help of computers. However, in collaboration with Alibaba, we used AI to speed up this colourisation process. This allowed us to take footage from

the Paris 1924 Games and bring it to life in vibrant colour. The outputs from this process were used extensively by broadcasters and drove significant social media engagement by making historical moments more vivid and engaging for today's audiences.

Our colleagues at the Olympic Broadcasting Service have also revolutionised the way video highlights are created and distributed. Using a cutting-edge platform, they can instantly detect, edit, and brand video highlights, making the process automatic and scalable. This innovation has significantly increased engagement with fans. OBS's Automatic Highlights Generation leverages AI to package tailored highlights across more than 30 sporting events at the Games. This approach helped level the playing field for broadcast footage of the Games, ensuring that all sports receive the attention they deserve. The results have been impressive.

OBS distributed more than 11,000 hours of content and produced over 100,000 videos. Fifteen national broadcasters took advantage of these automated highlight clips, with the Philippines using the most. Swimming emerged as the most highlighted sport, closely followed by track and field. This technology has truly transformed the way we generate content, making it more dynamic and engaging for fans worldwide. The Olympics bring an opportunity for fans to find new sports that they may be unfamiliar with. This can also be true of those broadcasters and media covering the Games.

In collaboration with OMEGA and Alibaba, the Olympic GPT platform looks to revolutionise the way sports are reported by providing broadcasters, commentators, and media professionals with in-depth knowledge on the history of each sport, its rules, and potential narratives, even for sports and events that the reporters and broadcasters may well be unfamiliar with. Designed to enhance understanding and storytelling, the platform delivers rich, insightful content through the life cycle of a race or a match, before, during, and after that race or match. The Olympic Sports Performance Analytics Monitor also integrates historical data and real-time insight using advanced live data sets from the field of play. We then leverage AI to transform this complex information into easily digestible summaries and screens so users can get a better understanding of what is happening. The system also allows for the use of an AI prompt engine to help explore the data further. Our vision extends beyond just reporting. Utilising this AI-driven backend and comprehensive data sets, we can serve a wide range of stakeholders' ideas, from delivering enhanced data directly to

athletes, creating engaging fan-facing experiences and providing second-screen insights to generating automatic graphics for broadcasts on social media. The possibilities are endless.

Moving on to our final focus area and the final few initiatives that I'd like to share with you today, over the past century, the Olympic Movement has amassed a treasure trove of media assets, capturing countless memorable moments. In collaboration with Alibaba Cloud, we've developed the Sports AI platform to bring those century-old archives to life with intelligent understanding and recognition. This innovative platform allows us to comprehensively structure the archives, making it easier to search and produce highlight reels with AI-enhanced capabilities. Auto tagging automatically categorises and organises the Olympic media archives while AI-enhanced search facilities quickly and accurately retrieve specific media content. Additionally, auto highlight video production generates highlight reels from these extensive archives. As a result, the visibility and accessibility of Olympic content are significantly improved, allowing the historical materials to exert greater influence and provide greater value. With the sport AI platform, we can ensure that the rich history of the Olympics continues to inspire and engage audiences around the world. This truly does unlock our archives, which span over nine petabytes of content. With over 800,000 photos and 49,000 hours of footage, this is only growing exponentially every Games.

We're placing a strong emphasis on supporting the wider Olympic Movement as it navigates the opportunities and challenges of AI. To help build foundational understanding and confidence, we have made AI training resources available to various stakeholders. Additionally, we're hosting AI Engagement forums with the International Federations, National Olympic Committees, partners, and others, encouraging open dialogue and collaboration. In the coming months, we plan to actively involve more athletes to ensure their voices and needs shape the future of AI in sport. This approach will help us create a more inclusive and effective AI strategy for the Olympic Movement.

Moving on to some of the things that we're doing during 2025, we are currently developing AI-powered assistance in partnership with Alibaba, tailored to serve four key Olympic stakeholders across the National Olympic Committees, fans, Organising Committees, and athletes. The goal is to deliver a ChatGPT-like experience, helping each group quickly find the information they need related to the Olympics in a simple conversational way. As seen earlier, the NSCS and

other AI assistants aim to make this process much faster and more intuitive. All these agents run off the same technology back end, making deployment quicker and more efficient. While these projects are still in development, we have already received very positive early feedback from the National Olympic Committees, especially about how these assistants improve access to resources and simplify their day-to-day operations. You also saw we had an initial agent for athletes, which was deployed during the Paris Games. We're now working to expand and enhance that version further with instant access to Athlete365 resources with personalised insights.

These initiatives are a significant step towards making Olympic-related information more accessible and user-friendly for everyone involved. Looking ahead, our AI roadmap is filled with exciting milestones. We will actively engage with key stakeholders of the Olympic Movement, including the National Olympic Committees, International Federations, athletes, and Olympic partners. Additionally, later in the year we will host a new AI forum to foster collaboration and knowledge sharing across this Olympic Movement. This forum will offer insights into effective AI strategies and promote best practices in this rapidly evolving field. Our commitments to the Olympic AI agenda are clear and ambitious. We will draw lessons from our Paris 2024 deliveries and our 2025 initiatives to continuously identify and develop solutions across the five focus areas that we have identified together. We are committed to driving innovation and shaping the future of sports through AI.

Thank you for listening.

## USING AI TO PROMOTE OLYMPIC VALUES: TOOLS AND STRATEGIES FOR YOUNG AMBASSADORS

**Prof. Emanuele ISIDORI (ITA)**

*Vice-Rector for International Relations,  
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### **Abstract**

In the digital era, promoting Olympic values requires a balance between preservation and innovation. This article explores how artificial intelligence (AI) can serve as a powerful ally for Young Olympic Ambassadors in reimagining the transmission of core Olympic principles—respect, friendship, solidarity, and excellence—in a globally connected world. The study outlines a pedagogical framework integrating AI tools for education, multilingual communication, storytelling, and digital campaign design. This article suggests practical exercises and collaborative reflections to help Young Olympic Ambassadors develop their own “Olympic Digital Action Plans”, leveraging AI to foster inclusive communities rooted in Olympism. The suggestions aim to bridge ancient Olympic ideals with contemporary technological possibilities, empowering youth to become creative and ethically engaged educators for the 21st century.

### **1. Introduction**

The Olympic Movement has long relied on education to sustain and renew its humanistic mission. From Pierre de Coubertin’s early call for a “permanent pedagogy of peace” to contemporary programmes such as the Olympic Values

Education Programme (OVEP), the transmission of respect, friendship, solidarity, and excellence has been regarded as both an ethical imperative and a civic responsibility (International Olympic Committee [IOC], 2020). However, the landscape in which these values are communicated has undergone significant changes. Digital ecosystems governed by algorithms, predictive analytics, and generative models now shape how young people learn, socialise, and construct meaning. Artificial intelligence (AI)—once confined to specialist laboratories—has permeated everyday life, from personalised news feeds to adaptive learning platforms. This technological diffusion presents the Olympic Movement with a double-edged challenge: it threatens to commodify human interaction, but it also offers unprecedented opportunities to revitalise value-based education (Floridi, 2019).

Young Olympic Ambassadors stand at the fulcrum of this transition. As representatives appointed by the National Olympic Committees to inspire their peers, they are custodians of tradition and, simultaneously, architects of future practice. Their credibility depends not only on their understanding of Olympism but also on their fluency in the digital vernacular of their generation. Harnessing AI responsibly, therefore, becomes pivotal: when employed ethically and creatively, AI can personalise learning trajectories, remove linguistic barriers, amplify marginalised voices, and generate immersive narratives that render abstract ideals tangible (UNESCO, 2021). Conversely, unreflective adoption risks reinforcing biases, eroding critical autonomy, and reducing complex moral concepts to algorithmic slogans.

Scholarly discussion has only begun to map this terrain. Research on values education in sports rarely intersects with studies on AI-enhanced pedagogy, and even fewer contributions address how youth themselves might wield these tools. This article seeks to bridge that gap. It proposes a pedagogical framework—grounded in constructivist and humanistic principles—that positions AI as a dialogical partner rather than a didactic substitute. Drawing on concrete examples from generative language models, creative media platforms, and collaborative knowledge graphs, the paper demonstrates how Young Olympic Ambassadors can design, implement, and evaluate digital projects that both embody and disseminate Olympic values.

## 2. Olympic Education in the Digital Age

Since the early work of Pierre de Coubertin, Olympic education has been conceived as a holistic enterprise aimed at cultivating *l'esprit Olympique* through physical practice, intercultural encounters, and reflective dialogue (Coubertin, 1931). Its classic delivery model—face-to-face instruction augmented by experiential activities such as sports festivals, museum visits, or International Olympic Academy Sessions—assumed a relatively stable, place-based learning environment. By contrast, today's youth navigate an epistemic landscape in which knowledge is produced, circulated, and contested within algorithmically curated networks (Selwyn, 2021). The “digital condition” destabilises authority, accelerates the pace of information flow, and privileges multimodal, user-generated content. If Olympic education continues to rely solely on traditional methods, it risks becoming peripheral to the communicative lifeworld of its intended audience.

To remain relevant, educators must shift from a transmissive paradigm—where values are delivered top down—to a participatory paradigm, in which learners co-construct meaning and act as prosumers of Olympic culture. Such a view resonates with sociocultural learning theories, which frame knowledge as emerging from collaborative activity and mediated discourse. Digital platforms, including AI-driven collaborative tools, can operationalise these principles by enabling young people to remix historical narratives, visualise ethical dilemmas, and engage in cross-cultural dialogue that transcends geographic boundaries.

Artificial intelligence does not merely automate existing educational practices; it offers qualitatively new affordances for Olympic pedagogy. Machine-learning models can analyse learners' interactions and interests to tailor content sequencing, formative feedback, and linguistic adaptation (Holmes et al., 2022). For example, a multilingual recommender system can present case studies of Olympic role models that align with a student's cultural background or sporting discipline, thereby reinforcing identification and relevance.

Moreover, AI-facilitated translation and speech-to-text technologies democratise access for participants with diverse linguistic repertoires—an essential feature in a movement founded on intercultural respect. Sentiment analysis engines embedded in discussion forums can prompt moderators when conversations drift into exclusionary or discriminatory language, thereby safeguarding the value of equality (UNESCO, 2021). Predictive analytics can

even help organisers design inclusive events by modelling participation scenarios that optimise gender balance and representation of minority groups.

While AI's potential is significant, its uncritical adoption can compromise the very values Olympic education seeks to uphold. The platformisation of learning—where commercial providers mediate educational experiences—may subordinate pedagogical aims to data-extraction logic (van Dijck et al., 2018). Algorithmic bias can reproduce structural inequities, privileging dominant languages or cultural narratives and thereby undermining the principle of universality. Finally, the seductive efficiency of AI-driven content creation risks reducing ethical deliberation to prefabricated slogans, thereby eroding the depth of critical reflection that Olympic education has traditionally cultivated.

Accordingly, educators must adopt a critical humanistic stance toward AI, foregrounding transparency, accountability, and learner agency (Popenici & Kerr, 2017). Ethical governance frameworks should be integrated into curricular design rather than being treated as peripheral compliance checklists.

To reconcile innovation with tradition, one should consider four key design principles. The first guiding principle is value-embedded design, which requires every learning activity to establish an explicit correspondence between the chosen AI functionality and a specific Olympic value. For example, an adaptive learning pathway can be structured so that the experience of incremental mastery mirrors the pursuit of excellence. Equally important is dialogical mediation: AI should serve as a scaffold for, rather than a substitute for, human dialogue. Chatbots may pose Socratic questions that tutors later unpack with their learners, ensuring technology catalyses inquiry rather than forecloses it. A third principle, cultural co-creation, encourages participants to localise global narratives by producing artefacts—such as videos, podcasts, or data visualisations—that weave regional histories into universal ideals, thereby reinforcing the Movement's commitment to diversity within unity. Finally, reflective data literacy demands that learners critically examine how their data are collected and processed, linking the practice of digital citizenship to the Olympic ethos of responsibility and fair play.

Pilot initiatives illustrate these principles in action. In Europe, for example, the AI & Olympism Hackathon paired Ambassadors with data science mentors to develop chatbots that answer ethics questions derived from historical Olympic controversies, yielding prototypes now used in after-school programmes. We are convinced that artificial intelligence—when harnessed through the above design



principles—can enhance the reach, depth, and inclusivity of Olympic education without compromising its humanistic core.

### 3. The Role of AI in Olympic Value Education

Artificial intelligence transforms traditional, one-size-fits-all instruction into an adaptive, learner-centred process that can honour the diversity of experiences represented within the Olympic Movement. Machine-learning algorithms, drawing on interaction logs and formative assessment data, diagnose each learner's prior knowledge, motivational profile, and preferred modality of engagement (Holmes et al., 2022). These analytics then power dynamic content sequencing: a student who demonstrates curiosity about Olympism's historical roots might receive primary source excerpts from Coubertin, whereas another who excels in visual learning could be guided toward augmented reality reconstructions of ancient Olympia.

Cultural responsiveness is equally important. Recommendation engines can privilege case studies featuring athletes or ethical dilemmas that resonate with the learner's regional sports traditions, gender identity, or socio-economic reality. By aligning instructional trajectories with personal context, AI encourages a deeper internalisation of respect, excellence, friendship, and solidarity because those values are encountered not as abstract slogans but as relevant, lived principles.

The Olympic ethos of *unity in diversity* cannot be fully realised if linguistic and cultural barriers restrict participation. AI-driven natural language processing offers a scalable solution. Neural machine translation models—fine-tuned on sport-specific corpora—provide near real-time subtitles for webinars, generate localised captions for video narratives, and even adapt idiomatic expressions to maintain rhetorical force across languages. Large language models (LLMs) can also recontextualise content: a passage on fair play written initially for European audiences can be reframed with cultural references familiar to learners in West Africa or the Pacific Islands, thereby enhancing relevance without compromising conceptual integrity. Furthermore, sentiment analysis tools can monitor intercultural discussion forums, flagging moments when dialogue drifts toward exclusionary language and prompting mediators to steer the conversation back toward inclusivity. The net result is a digitally mediated agora in which Ambassadors from disparate backgrounds exchange perspectives on Olympic

values in ways that promote empathy, shared understanding, and collective identity.

While personalisation and accessibility address *how* content is delivered, value acquisition ultimately depends on how learners interrogate and apply that content. AI can foster reflective inquiry by presenting simulated ethical dilemmas, generating counter-arguments, and co-authoring narratives that oblige learners to scrutinise their assumptions. In a conversational interface, for instance, an LLM might role-play a controversial figure—such as an athlete facing a doping allegation—thereby challenging learners to balance compassion, justice, and the principle of equality. Because the model can instantaneously switch perspectives, it exposes users to a plurality of moral standpoints, encouraging deliberation rather than dogma. Complementary analytic dashboards can visualise the evolution of argument structures within group debates, highlighting moments of consensus or persistent bias. Tutors can then intervene to deepen the discourse, thus preserving the human interpretive element crucial to Olympic pedagogy.

Collectively, these affordances position AI not as a technological panacea but as a relational catalyst that amplifies the pedagogical reach of Olympic education. When ethically governed and critically employed, AI enables learning experiences that are personalised yet communal, accessible yet rigorous, and technological yet profoundly human—qualities indispensable for cultivating Ambassadors capable of embodying and advancing Olympic values in the twenty-first century.

#### **4. Tools and Platforms for Young Olympic Ambassadors**

Contemporary Olympic education thrives when learners can generate, remix, and circulate content with the same ease that they consume it. The recent proliferation of user-friendly, cloud-based artificial intelligence tools has lowered the technical threshold for digital production, allowing Young Olympic Ambassadors to function simultaneously as learners, creators, and disseminators of values-based media. Below, four clusters of platforms illustrate how distinct AI affordances—text generation, visual design, argumentative mapping, and interactive presentation—can be harnessed to advance Olympism in culturally responsive and pedagogically sound ways.

Generative language models, such as ChatGPT, Microsoft's Copilot, and

Google's Gemini, provide a versatile engine for dialogical learning. By prompting these systems with historical vignettes, ethical dilemmas, or case studies from past Olympic Games, Ambassadors can generate Socratic question sets that scaffold peer discussion on fairness, inclusion, or the meaning of excellence. Fine-tuned conversation templates also enable the creation of lightweight chatbots capable of simulating interviews with iconic athletes or providing real-time, multilingual feedback on reflective journals. Because the underlying models are probabilistic, outputs must be critically reviewed; however, the iterative co-authoring process itself cultivates meta-cognitive awareness, encouraging students to interrogate the provenance of information and the potential for algorithmic bias.

A second cluster—Canva AI and Adobe Firefly—empowers Ambassadors to translate abstract values into compelling visual narratives. Through text-to-image prompts, learners can design posters that juxtapose archival photographs of the 1968 Mexico City podium protest with contemporary depictions of athlete activism, thus linking historical continuities of solidarity. Integrated brand kit features ensure that colour palettes and typography remain accessible across devices and visual impairment profiles, aligning with the Olympic commitment to inclusivity. Moreover, automated localisation modules overlay captions in multiple languages, enabling Ambassadors to deploy social media campaigns simultaneously in Swahili, Arabic, and Portuguese without incurring prohibitive translation costs—an essential capacity for global outreach.

The cultivation of critical discourse is further amplified by argument-mapping environments, such as Kialo and MindMeister, enhanced with AI add-ons. These platforms support structured debates in which propositions, counter-arguments, and evidence are visualised as dynamic node networks, rendering logical relationships transparent. AI-assisted summarisation can highlight rhetorical fallacies or surface underrepresented perspectives, prompting learners to refine their reasoning in line with the Olympic ethos of mutual respect and intellectual honesty. Research on digital deliberation suggests that visual scaffolds significantly enhance the depth and civility of online discussions compared to unmoderated comment threads, making them particularly suitable for emotionally charged topics, such as political expression in sports or gender equity in athletic governance.

Finally, platforms dedicated to interactive storytelling—such as Tome, Gamma, and Microsoft Sway—enable the assembly of multimodal learning modules that converge text, video, quizzes, and live data feeds. An Ambassador

might, for example, construct a “Solidarity Journey” presentation in Tome, beginning with an AI-generated 3D reconstruction of ancient Greek relay races. The narrative would then transition to user-submitted testimonies from refugee athletes, concluding with an embedded poll that captures audience pledges for community service. Automated analytics track engagement patterns, offering educators a dashboard through which they can iteratively refine narrative pacing and cognitive load. Crucially, these platforms require no advanced coding skills; drag-and-drop interfaces democratise authorship, allowing participants from resource-constrained contexts to contribute artefacts of equal technical sophistication to those produced in digitally privileged settings.



*Prof. Emanuele Isidori, Vice-Rector of the University of Rome “Foro Italico”, explored how AI can be utilised to promote Olympic values in his lecture.*

The confluence of these toolsets facilitates a pedagogy of production that aligns with constructivist principles and the Olympic commitment to universality. Text-based AI cultivates dialogue; visual AI galvanises emotional resonance; argument mapping AI sharpens critical thinking; and presentation AI orchestrates holistic narrative experiences. Nevertheless, the very accessibility that empowers Ambassadors also imposes an ethical imperative: Educators must guide learners

in responsible prompt engineering, intellectual property stewardship, and data privacy management. When such safeguards are embedded in instructional design, these platforms extend the arena of Olympic education from the physical gymnasium to a participatory digital commons—one in which every Ambassador can script, design, debate, and broadcast the timeless values of Olympism for a twenty-first-century audience.

## **5. AI-Based Olympic Learning Projects**

A project-based learning (PBL) approach situates knowledge acquisition within authentic, goal-oriented activities that require sustained inquiry, collaboration, and public dissemination of results (Blumenfeld et al., 1991). When PBL is augmented by artificial intelligence, learners gain access to computational partners that can scaffold creativity, automate routine production tasks, and expand the reach of their outputs. The following four modalities exemplify how Young Olympic Ambassadors can employ AI to design projects that embody and transmit the Olympic values of respect, friendship, solidarity, and excellence.

### *5.1 Digital Storytelling*

Narrative is a powerful conduit for value education because it aligns factual information with emotional resonance and moral meaning (Bruner, 1996). AI-assisted digital storytelling platforms—combining generative language models with text-to-image engines—allow Ambassadors to craft illustrated tales of athletes whose careers exemplify perseverance or fair play. A typical workflow begins with a prompt to an LLM requesting a culturally situated vignette about a little-known Paralympian; the generated outline is then refined through iterative questioning that probes ethical nuance. Visual elements are created in Canva AI or Adobe Firefly to match the narrative tone, while automated narration tools convert the final script into audio for accessibility. The resulting multimedia artefact can be hosted on interactive platforms where analytics capture user engagement, enabling educators to evaluate both cognitive and affective learning outcomes.

### *5.2 Chatbot Creation*

Conversational agents provide learners with a low-stakes environment in which to question, rehearse, and internalise complex concepts (Winkler & Söllner, 2018). Using no-code frameworks such as Landbot or Dialogflow, Ambassadors can fine-tune large language models (LLMs) to simulate Socratic dialogue on topics like gender equity in sports or the ethical limits of performance enhancement. The design process involves curating a knowledge base grounded in authoritative sources—such as Olympic Charters, athletes' biographies, and scholarly articles—and engineering prompts that elicit reflective rather than prescriptive responses. Piloting with peer groups helps calibrate linguistic register and cultural sensitivity. Beyond disseminating information, chatbots cultivate digital citizenship; learners must negotiate issues of data privacy, bias mitigation, and intellectual property attribution, thereby linking technical proficiency to ethical responsibility.

### *5.3 Micro Documentaries*

Short-form video is now a lingua franca of global youth culture. AI video synthesis platforms, such as Runway ML or Synthesia, combine script generation, voice cloning, and stock footage retrieval to streamline the production of documentaries. Ambassadors might script a three-minute feature on solidarity by tracing the journey of the Refugee Olympic Team, interlacing archival footage with AI-generated animated infographics visualising displacement statistics. Captioning is auto-translated into multiple languages, while sentiment analysis of viewer comments provides real-time feedback on affective impact. From a pedagogical standpoint, micro-documentaries integrate media literacy competencies—such as storyboarding, fact-checking, and visual rhetoric—with the critical examination of historical and sociopolitical contexts that shape Olympic narratives.

### *5.4 Multilingual AI-Driven Campaigns*

The principle of universality demands that Olympic values resonate across linguistic and cultural boundaries. Neural machine translation APIs (e.g., DeepL, Google Translate Advanced) and tone transfer algorithms enable Ambassadors to launch synchronised social media campaigns that adapt idiomatic nuances

while preserving thematic coherence. For instance, a Twitter thread on friendship can be auto-localised into Arabic, Japanese, and Swahili, each version embedding culturally salient metaphors and athlete role models. Generative content schedulers like Buffer AI optimise posting times for regional peak engagement, whereas dashboard analytics disaggregate reach by demographic variables, allowing for iterative refinement. Such campaigns not only broaden the audience base but also model intercultural dialogue, a cornerstone of the Olympic Movement's peace-building mission.

### *5.5 Pedagogical Payoffs*

Across these modalities, AI functions as an enabler rather than a determinant of learning. Digital storytelling nurtures empathy and moral imagination; chatbots scaffold dialogical reasoning; micro-documentaries develop critical media literacy; and multilingual campaigns cultivate global citizenship. Each project type demands teamwork, with roles allocated in research, design, production, and dissemination, thereby fostering leadership and collaborative competence. Crucially, the public-facing nature of the artefacts encourages accountability: Ambassadors must ensure factual accuracy, ethical representation, and respectful engagement with audiences. In doing so, they enact the Olympic values they seek to teach, transforming AI from a technological novelty into a catalyst of character formation and community building.

## **6. Conclusion: Building Communities of Olympic Values with AI**

The Olympic Movement has always envisaged itself as more than a series of quadrennial spectacles; from Coubertin's earliest writings it has aspired to function as a transnational community bound by shared ideals of dialogue and peace. Artificial intelligence now offers a technological substrate capable of extending that community beyond the physical confines of Olympic venues or academy seminars, knitting together dispersed Ambassadors into a sustained, interactive network of practice.

At the most immediate level, advances in neural machine translation and speech-to-text recognition enable real-time, high-fidelity communication across more than 100 languages, effectively lowering the linguistic thresholds that have historically limited intercultural exchange. A synchronous webinar

on gender equity, for example, can now display rolling subtitles that preserve idiomatic nuance. At the same time, an AI-driven sentiment analysis layer alerts moderators to potential misunderstandings rooted in cultural semantics, ensuring that conversational threads remain respectful and inclusive. By rendering dialogue frictionless, AI does not merely facilitate information transfer; it creates the conditions for *reciprocal recognition*, a foundational prerequisite for any cosmopolitan learning community.

Beyond conversation, AI-enhanced collaborative workspaces, such as Notion AI, Miro with generative ideation features, or Google Workspace's Gemini integration, allow Ambassadors from different continents to co-author curricula, plan service projects, and iterate on media campaigns in real-time. Generative meeting summarisation tools automatically distil discussion outcomes, allocate tasks, and set milestones, thereby preserving collective memory and accelerating project momentum, as shown in Wenger's (1998) concept of "communities of practice", in which knowledge is co-constructed through sustained mutual engagement rather than disseminated unidirectionally.

Artificial intelligence also expands the reach and durability of Olympic pedagogy by streamlining the creation and dissemination of open educational resources. Large language models can auto-generate learning objectives aligned with Bloom's taxonomy, recommend multimedia assets licensed under Creative Commons, and apply semantic web metadata that enhances discoverability across institutional repositories. Image captioning and speech synthesis algorithms ensure that resources are accessible to users with visual or auditory impairments, thereby fulfilling the Olympic commitment to equality and inclusion. Once published, these resources populate an ever-growing commons that Ambassadors can remix to suit local contexts—an iterative process that both decentralises instructional authority and enriches the collective knowledge base (UNESCO, 2019).

Taken together, these affordances enable the emergence of a *Virtual Olympic Academy*: a distributed, AI-enabled ecosystem in which Ambassadors engage in ongoing dialogue, co-create culturally situated learning materials, and collectively refine best practices for value education. However, the promise of such an ecosystem is inseparable from questions of governance and ethics. Algorithmic curation must be transparent, data ownership clearly stipulated, and infrastructural access equitably distributed to avoid reproducing the digital divides that the Movement seeks to bridge. When these safeguards



are incorporated, AI becomes not merely a toolset but a connective tissue that sustains the Olympic ethos across time zones, languages, and cultural imaginaries, transforming episodic encounters in Ancient Olympia into a continuous, border-spanning educational endeavour.

This paper argues that artificial intelligence when aligned with humanistic intent, can renew the pedagogical mission of the Olympic Movement for a generation steeped in digital culture. Beginning with the premise that value education must resonate with learners' lived realities, we have demonstrated how AI-driven personalisation, multilingual access, and dialogical simulation convert abstract principles—such as respect, friendship, solidarity, and excellence—into experiences that are adaptive, inclusive, and intellectually demanding. A survey of accessible tools and platforms demonstrated that young Ambassadors can now become producers of text, images, argument maps, and interactive narratives without specialised coding knowledge. At the same time, project-based exemplars illustrated the creative breadth of digital storytelling, chatbot design, micro-documentary filmmaking, and multilingual campaigning. Finally, by examining AI-enabled collaboration environments, we outlined how dispersed participants can coalesce into a virtual extension of the Olympic Academy, sustaining intercultural dialogue and co-creating open educational resources that outlive any single Session in Ancient Olympia.

The logical culmination of these insights is the “Olympic Digital Action Plan”—a personalised roadmap in which each Ambassador specifies the AI tools, pedagogical strategies, and community partnerships they will mobilise on return to their local contexts. Such plans transform learning outcomes into commitments, pairing concrete deliverables (for example, a bilingual chatbot deployed in a national youth sports programme or a data-driven campaign on gender equity) with measurable indicators of reach and impact. They also embed ethical governance: every action item must articulate data-privacy safeguards, transparency mechanisms, and strategies for mitigating algorithmic bias, ensuring that the technological means remain subordinate to the moral ends of Olympism.

In practical terms, these action plans herald three strategic gains for the Movement. First, they decentralise innovation, allowing culturally situated experiments to flourish in parallel and contribute to a global repository of best practices. Second, they cultivate a cadre of digitally fluent educators whose credibility rests on demonstrated expertise rather than mere rhetorical

commitment. Third, they establish a feedback loop in which learner analytics and community metrics inform continuous improvement, anchoring Olympic education in evidence rather than tradition alone.

Thus, the integration of AI does not merely modernise Coubertin's original vision; it re-animates it. By equipping young Ambassadors with intelligent tools and a critical approach to their use, we extend the Games' promise of peaceful encounters into the everyday spaces of social media feeds, collaborative dashboards, and augmented learning environments. The challenge now passes to these Ambassadors—and to the institutions that support them—to translate blueprints into practice, weaving a digitally mediated yet deeply human fabric of Olympism whose threads link playgrounds in Nairobi, classrooms in Lima, and community centres in Warsaw. If realised with vigilance and imagination, the Olympic Digital Action Plan will stand as proof that the spirit of Olympia can traverse algorithms as surely as it once crossed continents, inspiring a new era of global citizenship grounded in sport, education, and shared humanity.

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## EXPANSION AND INTEGRATION OF THE OLYMPIC VALUES EDUCATION PROGRAMME<sup>1</sup>

**Xenia KOURGOUZOVA (IOC)**

*Lead of the Olympic Values Education  
Programme (OVEP), IOC Olympic Foundation  
for Culture and Heritage*



It is always a pleasure to present to young people during these Sessions, especially because, as experience shows, many of the participants whom I lecture every year end up working with us, their National Olympic Committees or their National Olympic Academies on the implementation of the Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) during different times in their career or at various times during the work of their National Olympic Committees and Academies.

I will talk about the Olympic Values Education Programme. Best practices always tell me I have to start with some sort of a hook and engagement because I'm not in the room, so I can't directly transmit my vibes to you. Let's do a little exercise. Okay, I'm going to ask you to take your phones out or open your PCs, and we'll do a little exercise. I usually ask you not to take your phones out or browse your PCs, but this is the only exception we're going to make during this lecture. So, I'm going to ask you to Google or use any other search engine.

I'm going to give you some time to do an image search on Early Classroom Bologna. And if you do an image search on Early Classroom Bologna, one of the first images that pops up, originates from the 13th century. More than 700 years ago. Just for context, Bologna was one of the first European universities

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<sup>1</sup> This text is the transcript of the lecture delivered by Ms Kourgouzova remotely during the Session.

and was founded, as its name indicates, in Bologna, Italy. So, what we see in this image is a traditional classroom, as used to be in the University of Bologna.

I find this image quite funny because 700 plus years have passed, but when I look at the screen it's exactly the same image that I see in your classroom. Well, we have a professor on a pedestal there giving a lecture, and I see all the students in the auditorium, which very much looks like yours. The students are very much like the students today. There are a couple of students in the back chatting and not listening to the professor. There is a student who is asleep because the lecture is probably not very interesting. There are a couple of students in the front row who are very eager and are looking at the professor with admiration because they are the keen students who consistently achieve the best grades and excel in everything. But what I find striking about this picture is how little has changed in so many classrooms around the world. And I think my message to you here, when you look at this image, is to think about the classrooms to which you went when you were a child, and the classrooms in which you would have liked to have pursued your studies when you were a child as well. Because, as we know, school and education are evolving rapidly. They change so fast that, in many countries, the Ministry of Education not only has a say but also designs the strategies for education to correspond to these rapid changes in technology.

I know this year it's all about artificial intelligence. So, what I will try to do is explain how OVEP, the key flagship education programme of the International Olympic Committee, is trying to tackle the challenges of the very quickly changing education landscape. Then, at the end, I will give you a couple of examples of how we are trying to use technology to our advantage and how, in some cases, we fail to quickly respond to the changes in technology.

I will start with a presentation of what the Olympic Values Education Programme is, and how it fits into today's educational realities. If you have never heard about the Olympic Values Education Programme, that is unfortunate, but it's okay because this is what I'm here to talk to you about, to explain what the Programme is, how it functions within this whole universe of the Olympic Movement, how you can become part of it, and how it's using artificial intelligence through two examples.

I will give you my example of how I'm trying to use AI as a very low-cost solution for monitoring, evaluation and reporting what's happening with the Programme. I will give you another example of how the National Olympic Committees can use AI as a very low-cost solution for e-learning. I will also show

you an example of the digital efforts we launched over a year ago, and which I'll say sort of failed in a way because we couldn't keep up with how quickly the technology had been developing. Now we're trying to steer in the direction of using a more AI-centred solution. I think it is not only relevant for your learning about the Programme but also fits it into the overall AI discussion that you've been having in Olympia so far.

So, what is the Olympic Values Education Programme if you haven't heard about it? Well, it's a key flagship education programme of the International Olympic Committee. It's not a new programme. It has existed since 2005. So, we can celebrate its anniversary this year, but we can also celebrate its anniversary next year, because 2006 is when the first OVEP toolkit was published, and the objective was to really try and build a programme that spread Olympism. It talks about all the different Olympic symbols, Olympic heritage, Olympic history, and Olympic values above all. It has evolved quite a lot in the past 20 years. Of course, it's not the same programme as it was in 2005, and today it combines different methodologies, tools, and activities that facilitate the promotion and implementation of values through sport, especially Olympic values. Oftentimes, when we talk to National Olympic Committees which have this big mission of promoting Olympic values and disseminating Olympic education at large, the question is, "How do we do this?", "What are the tools?"

Well, this is the tool, right? This is one of the main tools that over 60 NOCs use to spread Olympic values. And it's really not only a tool; it's a platform for values-based learning or the development of various skills, and for responding to the challenges of different National Olympic Committees and various National Olympic Academies on the ground. I mentioned it's implemented in over 60 countries. We are actually in the process of doing our study of how the Programme is used in the world. Every two years we create what we call an Olympics OVEP Snapshot. OVEP Snapshot is a quick shot of how the Programme performs in the world in different countries, how NOCs are using the Programme, how NOAs are using the Programme and how independent foundations or implementers, IOC young leaders, and NGOs are using the Programme.

So, from a couple of weeks ago, the latest results were that over 67 NOCs are using it to some extent. Some are using it quite a lot, while others are just using it on a basic level. But the good news is that they're using it. And our objective, of course, at the Culture and Heritage Department of the IOC is to make sure that more and more countries are using it.

I mentioned that the Programme has changed quite a bit since 2005 and 2006. This was thanks to the big study and thorough analysis that we conducted in 2021-2022. Please keep in mind that monitoring and evaluation is quite complex. To do the snapshot or a thorough analysis of the Programme, we use over seven sources of data. This is not because we like it this way. It's because of how the Olympic Movement functions. So, to analyse the performance of the Programme, we have to look at the relay reports.

I don't know if someone has explained to you in the previous lectures, but Olympic Solidarity, our main funding body, makes sure that we give back to all the members of the Olympic Movement all the funding necessary to promote Olympic values. Olympic Solidarity has a dedicated portfolio for funding the Olympic Values Education Programme. Through this portfolio, we receive data on how different National Olympic Committees, sometimes through National Olympic Academies, implement the OVEP. So, this is our first source of data. Our second source of data is our connection to the National Olympic Committees' education champions. We keep a database of all the key players in education from each National Olympic Committee, and we ask them to report on their activities. Our third source of data is the report that the International Olympic Academy publishes every year on education, on what different National Olympic Academies do on the education front every year. Our fourth source of data is surveys that we send for this snapshot of content analysis.

Our fifth source of data is social media, because a lot of National Olympic Committees do a lot of educational activities, a lot of things related to spreading Olympic values, but they don't use Olympic Solidarity funding, nor do they report it to anyone. However, they do publish it on their websites or their social media accounts. We have a team member who is tasked with going to each of the National Olympic Committee's websites, Google translating these websites, and getting all the data on their educational activities. That's a lot of work. Then finally, social media is a big one. Some NOCs or NOAs use Facebook, some use Instagram, and some use LinkedIn. Again, we have to crawl all these accounts manually and try to find as much information as possible.

Each snapshot, each monitoring activity takes us, I would say, a solid six months to produce. It's quite a lot of work. But I ask you to keep this number in mind because the solution, the AI GPT that I developed, actually allows us to capitalise very quickly on this data. I will give it to you as an example after the presentation on the web itself. What this allowed us to do is the store analysis

that we did in 2021-2022, and the one that we're conducting right now, that allow us to see the sort of black areas on the map, the areas where there are no Olympic Values Education Programme activities or any Olympic education activities at all.

That's where we try to concentrate our efforts in terms of programme delivery. Thanks to this, the Programme has seen a lot of developments in the past couple of years, including expansion in key regions. The regions that we've designed following the analysis, such as India, China, or the MENA region, and some African countries, allow us to sort of focus our capacity building efforts. To give an example, last year in February, we held a major international training session in Lausanne, inviting representatives from 27 NOCs to participate. The selection process was highly competitive, as we received over 80 applications for just 25 available slots. The decisions regarding which countries and participants were chosen were based on insights gained from the analysis of the Programme.

The Programme also provides information on how we update our educational resources. For example, we developed the first digital toolkit following this analysis, as well as the new partnerships. Beyond all of this, what it allows us to do is to also analyse how OVEP fits into global educational trends. Remember this Bologna classroom? Ideally, this is not the way an OVEP classroom should look. The OVEP classroom is all about experiential learning. It's all about learning by doing, and it's all about experiencing values and not just learning about them in theory. So, we wanted to make sure that, following this analysis we did in 2022 and the analysis we're doing right now, we also fit into global educational trends.

So let me quickly show you what it looks like today. There is no surprise here, especially considering the rapid development of technology; it's less and less about hard knowledge and more and more about how to apply knowledge—competency-based education. The focus of education is shifting more to the development of specific skills rather than just acquiring and hoarding knowledge. Before, you had to have some hard knowledge because going to the library to find the date or to find a fact took a lot of time. So, it was easier to sometimes just learn by heart. Today, you have your phones, and you can just Google or search for anything in seconds. This changes the whole paradigm of what skills will be necessary tomorrow. We are shifting from this knowledge-based economy to more of a practical, real-world skills economy. What becomes even more and more important is social emotional learning. I'm sure you talked about



this whole sort of digital dependency, how much time we're spending online and how difficult it becomes to develop a real lasting true relationship. This is why I find this Session in Olympia for Young Ambassadors amazing because you're spending so much time together; you're creating these true bonds, the bonds that will last a lifetime. I'm not saying this just to say it, because I know for a fact a couple of people who met in Olympia and are still friends today. Even though they're 40+ and they have their own family lives and live in their different countries, they are still friends who work together and do amazing things together. I even know a couple of couples that met in Olympia, got married, and have kids. Not that I'm encouraging you to do this, but this is very important, right?

Social emotional learning is something that you cannot develop and foster just in theory. You have to be together, you have to spend time together, you have to know how to do this, how to create these personal links, and how to work together in groups or in teams, or create friendships. And mental health and well-being are huge topics. There's a whole department of the IOC now, the medical department, that is taking care of the subject. There is a working group on mental health within the Athletes' Commission. There is a course on safeguarding. So, mental health and well-being have grown as a huge topic in the past couple of years, not only at the IOC, but, as you can see, in the educational system worldwide.

STEM is nothing surprising. It's been a trend for many years, but lately, over a couple of years, it's now developed to become STEAM to include arts integration. The arts are becoming more important. Why? Again, this is a sort of counterweight to the rapid development of artificial intelligence. You know how well AI can perform in the front of knowledge generation and how poorly I still find it performs on everything that is audio, visual arts. If you ask it to generate a picture, it will never generate a picture as it is in your head. So, the arts are becoming more and more important. It's a counterweight to technology development. It's something unique, it's something human, and it's something that, for a very long time, we will dominate in the field of production versus what AI can do.

Project-based learning is again a huge priority in education. It has been in private schools for a long time, and it's now getting into public schools. It has to be done right to reinforce the competency-based education, but it's also something that allows us to see tangible outcomes of the work. It allows one to

very quickly acquire knowledge, and it allows one to very quickly understand what kind of knowledge is necessary for specific skills and real-world applications.

Then something again that IOA is doing right is having you all in the classroom where you all united from different countries and where it's not a Eurocentric narrative or Western centric narrative, it's a divergence of different views and different cultures, allowing you to connect with global universal issues and to learn from your peers and how things work in their countries. If we look at these global educational trends, these were the priorities of how, but now let's look at how it is changing. Practically, we have the priorities in education, but the how has to support these priorities in education.

The rise of digital learning is not a surprise. It's been there for a couple of years. Please keep in mind that classrooms around the world are very different. We have classrooms where there's a lot of digital learning. We have AI integrated as a sort of copilot for education. You have a virtual reality learning experience. You have blended hybrid learning. Then we have classrooms where there's nothing, still in a state where there are desks and a blackboard. So, it's not one size fits all, but when schools can allow themselves to integrate digital learning, they do it, and then we have continuous and lifelong learning that takes over. I don't know if it's good news for you or not, but if you like to study, it's good news. If you don't like to study, it's going to be a little bit difficult.

I think one thing I have to tell you is that for you, young people, young leaders, learning will never stop. It will never end. It's not like it used to be. In the time of our parents, when they would get their degree, they would get their diploma, and that was it for life, right? They were set for life. Your engineer, your doctor, your banker. These days, everything changes so quickly that you will have to keep on learning until the end of your life. You will have to keep reinventing yourself, keep learning new things, getting new programmes, getting new degrees, and doing micro learning. It will never stop. But that means that if it will never stop, it has to be fun, right? So the good news, yes, you will have to learn your whole life. The people who are crafting education, who design education courses, know this. They know they have to compete for your attention. So, they gamify education more and more. There are a lot more quizzes, and there are a lot more games. When I show you the example of how NOCs use AI, this is a perfect example of how they innovate in the forefront of education to compete with all the digital noise that you have these days. We have more and more data-driven decision-making, and online learning allows

us to make these decisions as well, especially in terms of education. You can quickly get the stats, which content is more interesting, which is less interesting, who is using your e-learning, and how you can adjust it. Then, more and more we're using new teaching methodologies. I mean, flipped, classroom-guided discovery. All of this is not new to educators, but educators are now realising we need to get out of the Bologna classroom. It cannot be like this these days. Kids don't have the same attention span and adults don't have the same attention span. You have to make it fun, engaging, and experiential. It has to drive attention and interest.



*Xenia Kourgouzova presented the evolution of the Olympic Values Education Programme of the IOC.*

But how does OVEP fit in all of this? First of all, OVEP is meant to be a fun, interactive, and experiential way to acquire knowledge. Yes, it is all about Olympic values. It's all about excellence, respect, and friendship, and the examples that stem from it. But it's also promoting holistic development beyond traditional education. In education in particular, it addresses the lack of methodologies for values-based education. Remember I told you that many governments in many countries, many ministries of education, do realise that

Bologna Classroom is no longer something that will make their kids competitive, their countries competitive. They look for interactive programmes, and they incorporate them into their educational strategies: values-based education approaches, OVEP in particular, in addition to talking about Olympic values, in addition to talking about fit lifestyle, sport for life, engagement in community, also develops 21st century skills such as critical thinking, the ability to say no, the ability to make independent decisions, the ability to work in a team, the ability to innovate, all of this using sports examples or examples of athletes, or examples of Olympians. I mean, for life and in sport, the way you win, the way you excel, OVEP is offering all these different strategies. It also gives a support system for educators, especially to work around all these topics that different governments want them to promote, such as wellness, physical activity, mental resilience, conflict resolution in classrooms, and the discharge of emotion and stress.

Also, OVEP works in social development a lot with the UN agencies. We have specific programmes at this point with the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime for working with youth at risk, but we also work with different projects and programmes to address topics such as climate change, human rights, and social justice. In many countries, OVEP is coupled with other projects such as the Olympic Forest Project, Refugee Teams, or any other initiatives that the IOC is trying to champion. I talked to you about arts integration. There are several things we're trying to do with OVEP, but one of the most important ones is intercultural knowledge transfer. We try to encourage different NOCs in different countries to make sure that they use their traditions in storytelling, in traditional games that they use in classrooms, traditional sports and arts that they exhibit during the Olympic Games or Olympic cycles, and in their teaching methodologies. We also use an art integration approach by linking OVEP with Olympian artists.

Again, I can talk for hours about this. An Olympian artist is another topic that can be presented by some of my colleagues. This is another example of how Olympians use art for their everyday life to either manage mental stress, to take the mental load off, or to do educational activities and share this with kids. A workshop that we conducted remotely for Beijing during COVID-19 had to do with two Olympian artists directly communicating with children on the power of sports, but also on the power of arts, in building personal resilience, in building personal interest, and a life path in the future. This is just a couple of examples, but there are many other ways to do this.

What makes OVEP so different is that we learned from other programmes that could be similar, could be trying to do the same thing. First of all, we do a lot of training now. I know the question often comes: “How do we participate in OVEP training?” Well, some of the NOCs or NOAs train locally for some areas that are high priority. Remember, I talked about these black areas on the map. In some of the areas where there was no Olympic values education or Olympic education at large, we try to make an additional effort. We go into the field and we train them personally.

For example, India was one of the priority territories where we managed to go from zero school participation in OVEP to 12 million kids participating yearly. And if you followed the Olympism 365 summit two weeks ago, a new commitment was made to bring this number up to 70 million children yearly participating in OVEP. So, what we did in particular for India was that we went into the field a couple of times and trained implementers and local trainers to run the Programme. We ensure values match. It’s a very important distinction between us and other programmes. We always want to make sure that OVEP fits into the local context and not the other way around. We don’t want it to be a Eurocentric, Western-centric narrative. We work with local teams to make sure that OVEP is something that fits into their realities. And the values matching exercise is very important. We work together to make sure that Olympic values, which are already very neutral and very universal, make sense for their communities. We do this through several exercises and through several activities. We have a lot of unique activities. We produce content, a lot of content, and a lot of this content also comes from NOCs. We ask NOCs to share the activities and Olympic Values Education Programme activities they conduct in their countries. We rework them into very standard templates and then we centralise all this knowledge to decentralise all this knowledge.

A very important part of OVEP is that it always follows the triangulation of experience, right? There is always a theory that is delivered to participants. Then we always go into practice. Remember this is experiential learning, never learning behind the desk. Then we go into reflection. Reflection is even more than theory and practice because the only way to learn something new is to reflect on what you’ve experienced. So, we pay a lot of attention to this. Plus, we always have new implementation models. It’s not one size fits all countries. A lot of NOCs develop their unique approaches, and we really encourage this. This is the impact. Someone like, let’s say, Hungary, decided to activate it last year

around the Olympic Qualifier series events. So, it's an events-based approach, which is now integrated by other countries.

In other countries, they choose to go for national rollouts. If you look at Oman, Montenegro, or Qatar, it's a partnership approach with different organisations. In Ireland, it's a very digital programme with a primary school curriculum update, which was run last year. We can just humbly help all these different NOCs to run this Programme with translations or new content production, applying our expertise and training. OVEP is already available in 12 languages and more translations are to be released. I see here on the list that Arabic was published last month, but there are around a dozen still in progress and still in process. So, I'm pretty sure it should cover your local language, but in case it does not, it might be coming soon.

Let's go back to our Bologna classroom. If you haven't heard this yet, but I'm sure you have, you're probably well aware you can create your GPTs, right? You can create your own ChatGPT. What I've done, because, remember, my personal use case was that I've been struggling with all these immense amounts of data that had to be analysed. Well, it's one thing to develop a sort of analysis of this data in an Excel spreadsheet, but in another way, now with all these results, you have to pull up learnings from it. So, I developed the OVEP Insights Hub with the purpose of using data from our OVEP research and analysis to quickly generate valuable insights. I often get requests from the IOC President's cabinet saying, "the President is going to South America. Can you tell us what's happening with OVEP in South America?"

Well, in the past, I would have had to browse through Excel spreadsheets—I'm not a fan—but now I can just ask ChatGPT. I can say, "What's up with OVEP in South America?" And it will generate it. Well, it's not rocket science. It's not very complicated. First of all, if I were to do this on my own, without our vast knowledge that we produce during analysis, I wouldn't get the full picture. Second, if it were to do a web search, it wouldn't get the full information. Third, as you probably know since you've been in these sessions for quite some time, ChatGPT hallucinates. It can sometimes give you results that are not accurate. It just thinks, "Oh, if I give her an additional country, she's going to be happy." But I don't want an additional country. I don't want it to generate anything. I want it to provide me with real results based on the knowledge that I have.

The ChatGPT that I have, the GPT that I developed, was not only fed by using the knowledge that I've put in it—you saw when I started the research—it

functioned by searching the knowledge and not searching the web. So, I had to train it. I've trained it for several months not to hallucinate, to only use the right data, and to only use the spreadsheets. So, it was a long process. You might think it's quick to create a GPT, but it takes a lot of time to actually train it and to explain to it what you want, and it's still a work in progress. It also has several prompts. If we go back to the OVEP Insights hub, as I called it, it has a bunch of prompts that we can also use. All of this, of course, you can configure from the Edit GPT section, including what it's going to look like, what the prompts are, and what documents it's using. It uses all my knowledge base, and I asked it not to use, hallucinate, or generate anything additional. So, that's my humble tool. It's extremely useful when you have half an hour to deliver a brief to a President or Director on what's happening in different countries, and we're going to be updating it following the research that we're doing right now.

Next, I would like to show you a GPT which was developed by the Argentinian Olympic Committee—a very simple, no-cost solution that only requires time—called the “Fair Play Simulator”. They've developed this to teach their audiences about fair play. One of the values is that it's user-friendly. It's you who use the prompts, so they've pre-built the prompts; you choose the language in which you can use the simulator. Let's choose English. And then it guides you through different questions and different roles. So first it asks you to choose a role; let's say I want to be a parent. Based on this, it gives you case studies and sort of teaches you and guides you through different processes.

However, let's say I want to say I don't know Number 2. It sort of guides you through and suggests what's right, what's wrong, what's the best solution, etc. I find it's a nice low-cost solution for any NOC to build. Remember how it used to be in the previous E-learning platforms. You needed the platform, you needed the login, and you needed a lot of people collaborating on all of this. Today, you don't need the platform, you don't need to ask for people's login and at the same time you're gathering all the data and you deliver on your mission. A very quick and free way to deliver e-learning.

And finally, the third case study that I wanted to show you is a bit of a fail. I'm not going to say it's a fail, because it was a nice learning process. We wanted to work on a solution for our quick scaling up in India. Remember, I told you we went from 0 to 12 million kids participating, and now we're aiming for 70 million kids participating in OVEP in India. So, we needed some sort of digital tool for teachers to help them deliver the Programme. We started working with

the agency on what this tool could look like. We thought, well, why not make an app for teachers and help them deliver the sessions? The idea was that the teachers would have the app, and they wouldn't have to take too long to prepare the session with the kids. They could just log into the app. They could just choose the class details, the number of students, girls, boys, the grade, and how much time they have. Then the app would suggest activities to conduct with kids' equipment, and what sort of values to reinforce. You could choose what sort of themes you want to use, etc. We worked on this app for a solid, I would say, six months. We got the results, and then we started analysing how we could deliver this app. It was an extremely expensive solution because you had to manage translations and personal data.

Today, in the meantime, of course, AI is developing very quickly. Well, we had to drop the previous approach to how we imagined this app and we're going to try to go with a more AI-centric solution where the translation will be delivered by AI. Analytics for recommendations of activities will also be managed by AI, and the tool itself will become more and more AI-centric.

So, again, thank you for listening to me. This was a lot of information. I'm easily reachable via [ovep.olympic.org](http://ovep.olympic.org), or you can find us on the Olympics website if you just Google OVEP or Olympic Values Education Programme. That concludes my presentation. I now welcome your questions.



## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN SPORTS AND HEALTH: APPLICATIONS, PRACTICES, AND CHALLENGES

**Dr Lei PANG (CHN)**

*Lecturer, Institute of Artificial Intelligence in Sports,  
Capital University of Physical  
Education and Sports, China*



Good morning, Experts and Friends.

It is a great honour to have the opportunity to make a report on the application and practice of artificial intelligence in sports and health.

First of all, allow me to introduce myself. I come from China, Capital University of Physical Education and Sports (Beijing Institute for International Olympic Studies). In 2021, I received my PhD degree in engineering, mainly focusing on the application of artificial intelligence in sports biomechanical analysis. At present, I preside over a project funded by the National Natural Science Foundation of China and I have published more than 10 SCI papers.

Today, my report consists of three parts: AI technologies in sports and health, its typical application cases, and summary and outlook.

The first part, through investigation, gives a broad definition of sports AI.

For human sports activities, based on artificial intelligence technology, it realises human movement monitoring and perception, establishes data analysis theory and method, reveals the law of human movement, evaluates movement performance, forms scientific movement schemes, and develops auxiliary training equipment in order to improve performance in competitive sports and achieve scientific sports and active health for all people. Of course, this

may not be the most accurate description. I hope to have more exchanges and discussions with you.

From the 1950s to the present, sports AI has developed through the budding stage, the formation stage and the full integration stage. It has gone from the sports activities represented by chess to comprehensive development in the fields of competitive sports, school sports and mass fitness.

Among these, sensor monitoring equipment plays a great role. For example, optical sensors, visual sensors, IMU, physiological signal sensors represented by EMG, pressure sensors and temperature sensors. These provide effective data support for health monitoring and training tracking.

The second part is typical applications.

In order to improve athletes' performance, develop injury rehabilitation technology and develop the sports engineering industry, we put forward the concept of a sports, medicine and industry integration development.

First of all, the improvement of performance in competitive sports. This is divided into two parts: posture acquisition and aerodynamics analysis, and physiological parameters monitoring and biomechanical analysis.

Secondly, in winter events such as skeleton and sledge, the posture of athletes at the time of departure can be analysed based on non-contact motion capture. The speed and acceleration at departure can be monitored based on IMU and UWB.

In addition, in martial arts, football and other projects, the positioning and recognition of movements in sports can be realised based on an artificial intelligence algorithm, which provides reference for tactical decision-making.

In data-driven public health, we can use the deep learning algorithm, combined with the evaluation of motor function and biomechanical analysis, to build a multimodal data fusion of sports fatigue and injury risk prediction.

We can use artificial intelligence technology when we are monitoring and promoting adolescent health. We can build an intelligent sports system, form an intelligent sports big data cloud platform for primary and secondary school students, and a dynamic health database, so as to form a closed loop that can be fed back to parents and schools.

Here, low-power wearable devices, Internet of things and cloud computing technology are used to realise the monitoring and management of the whole teaching process and a new teaching closed loop is created through AI technology.

In line with the previous introduction, we believe that the field of sports AI is ushering in the best development period in history.

There is an urgent need for the interdisciplinary integration of sports, artificial intelligence, computers, electronic information, automation, machinery, mechanics, life sciences, biology and other disciplines in a multi-dimensional, deep-seated and three-dimensional way.



*Dr Lei Pang from the Capital University of Physical Education and Sports, Beijing, made a brief presentation on the use of AI in sports and health.*

We need to jointly improve human sports performance, explore the limits of human sports, and promote scientific sports and active health.

Finally, I would like to introduce to you our English periodical, Intelligent Sports and Health. It is the first journal to specifically focus on the integration of artificial intelligence technology into the areas of sports, engineering and medicine, aiming at promoting cross-innovations in the areas of intelligent sports and health, benefiting both elite athletes and the broader public. We welcome paper submissions and look forward to collaborating on relevant research.

This is all the content of my report. Thank you for listening.



*Session participant Estelle Chaillan from the IOC made a presentation on Olympism365.*



*Three interesting workshops were conducted during the Session, one on Olympic Media by Prof. Emilio Fernández Peña, one on AI in Sport, Development and Peace by Prof. Marion Keim, and one on Olympic education by Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis.*







*Following each lecture, the young delegates posed questions to the lecturers.*











## OLYMPIC EXPERIENCES BY OLYMPIANS





*Olympians presented their moving Olympic experiences to their fellow participants.*

## FROM FIRST SHOT TO OLYMPIC STAGE: THE JOURNEY OF MD ROBIUL ISLAM

**Md Robiul Islam (BAN)**

*Bangladesh Shooter Olympian*



My name is Md Robiul Islam, and I am proud to represent Bangladesh as a shooting athlete on the Olympic stage. My journey in sports has been shaped by persistence, resilience, and the belief that dreams can be realised through dedication and hard work.

I began my career in shooting in 2010, when I entered my very first competition. At that time, I could not have imagined how far this path would take me. In 2013, I won my first gold medal, a moment that gave me the confidence and conviction to pursue shooting more seriously. That achievement marked the beginning of a dream—to one day compete in the Olympic Games and make my country proud.

However, the life of an athlete is not without challenges. There was a day in 2024, during competition in Indonesia, when I felt

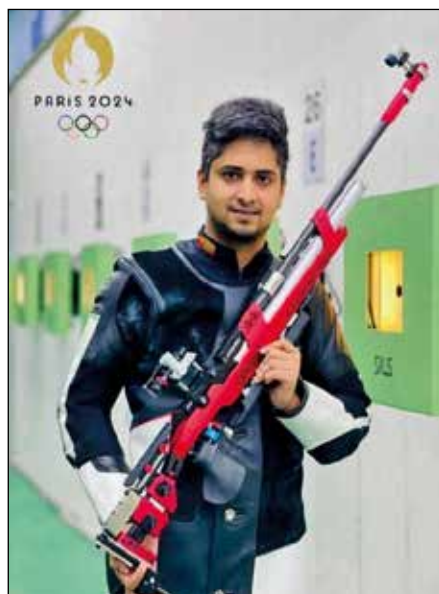


completely shattered. The experience tested my strength, both mentally and emotionally, but it also taught me that setbacks are part of the journey. Every athlete faces moments of struggle, yet these are the very moments that shape our resilience and character.

The most meaningful milestone in my journey has been my selection as an athlete for the Paris Olympic Games in 2024. Representing Bangladesh on the Olympic stage is not just a personal achievement, but also an opportunity to inspire young athletes in my country who aspire to excel in sports.

My story is a reflection of Olympic values: striving for excellence, showing respect, and demonstrating friendship through sport. I believe that success is defined not only by medals, but also by the courage to pursue one's passion, the ability to rise after setbacks, and the determination to keep moving forward.

As an Olympian, I hope to inspire future generations in Bangladesh and beyond to believe in themselves, to work hard for their dreams, and to embrace the values of sport as a way of life.



## MY OLYMPIC EXPERIENCE

Valerie TARAZI (PLE)



Good morning, everyone. My name is Valerie Tarazi, and I'm a Paris 2024 Olympic swimmer representing Palestine. A year ago, I was sitting in the audience at the International Olympic Academy, hoping I'd qualify for the Games. I remember thinking, "If I ever come back, I want to be up there sharing my story". Today, I'm honoured to do just that.

I was born and raised in Crystal Lake, Illinois. I grew up playing sports and became a three-sport state champion, but swimming stood out because it challenged me the most. I swam for Auburn University for five years and now continue to train there professionally.

Two years ago, I began representing Palestine. That decision changed my life. At the 2023 Arab Games, I won two gold, three silver, and one bronze medals, becoming the most decorated athlete at the competition. I now hold two Arab records and 13 national records, and was awarded the Presidential Medal of Honor and Freedom.







But the Olympics were about more than performance. In Paris, I was honoured to be Palestine's flagbearer. That moment, walking into the opening ceremony, was when everything clicked for me. I raced the 200 IM and became the fastest Arab swimmer in history. I also wore an opening ceremony dress made from fabric from Gaza, which made me feel like I was carrying home with me.

Throughout my journey, I've embraced the message we heard last year at the IOA: "The day your job as an Olympian begins is the day after you're done competing". That line changed my outlook. Since the Games, I've spoken at Harvard, Northwestern, and the United Nations about using sport for peace. I now serve on the Executive Board of the Olympic Council of Asia as Chair of the Gender Equity Committee and co-founded Fair Play Asia to promote inclusion through sport.

I'm still competing, with the World Championships just weeks away. And this August, I'll begin my PhD at Auburn.

Thank you for allowing me to share this with you. The IOA shaped my journey in a powerful way. Inshallah, LA28.



## MY OLYMPIC JOURNEY

**Silina PHA APHAY (LAO)**



I was born and raised in the southern part of Laos in a family that faced many financial hardships. My two older brothers could not finish high school, and seeing these difficult life struggles made me determined to work harder and build a better future. From a young age, I promised myself that one day I would provide my parents a better life.

When I was in secondary school, I participated in the election of the district athletics team. Unbelievably, I won the district team event. I had never trained before, and I was selected for district athletics. I was so excited and could not wait to share with my family. So, I went back home and I asked my father for permission to train, but he refused. For three days I kept asking, until finally he told me, “If you want to go, pack your things and leave this house”. His words hurt deeply because I had always obeyed my parents. But my passion for sport was stronger. I continued training and came back home a little late but still kept doing housework, and after a week he began speaking to me





again. I believe it's because he saw my passion, determination and attention, and the inspiration inside me.

That day, at my very first provincial competition, I won two gold medals. I brought them home, and my parents said, "You did a good thing". I knew they were so proud of me. From then on, they supported me and kept reminding me to balance training with school and family.

Step by step, I competed at the University Games, SEA Games, Asian Games, and finally the Olympic Games. From a poor village girl to representing my country on the world stage, sport changed my life. I hope my story inspires others to keep fighting for their dreams, no matter the obstacles.



## MY OLYMPIC EXPERIENCE

Ankhtsetseg MUNKHJANTSAN (MGL)



### 1. Me Today

This was me, six months ago at the World Championships. My last competition as a professional athlete. Most people start their stories from the beginning. I'm starting from the end. Because anyone can start something, but not everyone has the strength to finish. That long road—that's what professional sport truly is.



### 2. Destiny

When I lifted, I felt like I was in another world—like in the movie *Soul*. Eighteen years ago, I was 10 when I first lifted weights in a school hallway in a developing country. Raising something heavy above my head felt like magic. When I told my parents,

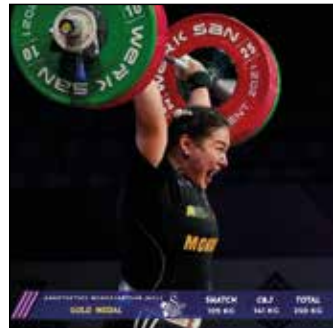
they were shocked. “Girls shouldn’t lift heavy things”, they said, and tried to stop me. But I couldn’t let it go. I trained in secret, telling lies about “extra classes”. When my parents found out, they didn’t get angry. They said, “If this is what you truly want, go for it”. From that moment on, they became my biggest supporters.

### 3. The Little Star

My success kept growing. At 14, I was winning medals in youth and junior Asian categories. I even set a new youth Asian record. Each medal made history for my country. People started calling me the “Golden Girl”. Inside that small girl was a heart full of courage. At 16, I competed at my first Olympics, the Nanjing Youth Games. I missed the podium by one kilo, winning fourth place. But I was lifting world-record weights in training. My coach and I were still new, but already respected worldwide. Fuelled by ambition, I went to the Rio Olympics. Chasing gold, I dropped to a lower weight class against my coach’s advice. I finished eighth. That little star, burning with Olympic gold, was brought back down to earth.

### 4. Mother or Athlete

Since childhood, I have had back pain. After my first world medal, it became unbearable. Still, I pushed through with painkillers. Then, something beautiful happened. I fell in love with someone, who radiated light, just like in the love stories you see in films. But my doctor warned me: “If this continues, you might never lift again. You might not even walk”. After many talks with family and coaches, we decided—I would have a child. When the news spread and a media storm followed, I was judged harshly. But just two months after giving birth, I returned to training. I barely ate, pumped breastmilk in saunas to make weight. At six months postpartum I medalled at the Asian. At 10 months I medalled at the World Championships. My husband, a national theatre actor, was incredibly busy. But when he could, he came to training, cooked, cleaned—supported me fully. I breastfed for nine months. Trained twice a day. Slept little. Finally, I left my son with my parents. From that moment,





I stopped being a mother. He often got sick—laryngitis, colds. Sometimes he was hospitalised. I trained by day, stayed at the hospital by night. When competitions neared, my parents, uncles, aunts, even extended family took time off work to help us stay in the hospital. Everyone around me worked so hard—for my dream. The hardest part? Training while my child lay sick in a hospital bed. Sport demanded I stay strong. But alone—I broke down and cried. The pandemic postponed the Olympics—a hidden blessing. It was a hard time for everyone, but for me, it gave something precious: more time to prepare. At Tokyo, if I lifted my final attempt, I'd win bronze. But I missed it. Again—fourth place.

## 5. A Fulfilled Ending

At the Tokyo Olympics, I stood crying—apologising to all Mongolians. But just four months later, I became World Champion. My fire returned stronger. I added two more World medals to my collection. Then—I fell again. A serious hip injury. I couldn't even sit. Still, I registered for Olympic qualifiers. By some miracle, I made it to the Olympics again. Two months before, I flew abroad—spent my final weeks healing. In Paris, I finished 10th. But this time, being there felt like victory. If I had medalled in Rio or Tokyo, maybe I'd never have come this far. The girl who once dreamed of Olympic gold had become one of Mongolia's most decorated athletes. The only Mongolian in any Olympic sport with five World Championship medals. At my final Olympics, I slowed down. Took it all in. Proud to have lived this world—three times. After it all, my husband said, "Give it one last try. You don't want to live with regret". Though my body was worn, I listened. Three months later—I earned my final medal. The Olympics gave me everything—except the medal. Most retire when results fade. I retired with success. On my own terms. Now, I'm ready to live for myself—for the first time. A new life begins, and everything I once dreamed of is finally within reach. Whatever happens next, I'll carry one title forever—with deep joy and pride: Olympian.

## MY JOURNEY TO THE OLYMPIC GAMES

**Marcela CUASPUD (ECU)**



Hello everyone, I'm Marcela Cuaspu. I'm from Ecuador, and today I want to share with you a journey that has transformed my life: my path to the Olympic Games.

I live in Quito, and my story in sports began at the age of six, when my brothers, who were swimmers, taught me how to swim. From that moment, my journey as an athlete began, though I never imagined just how far it would take me. I've always loved sports. I practiced both swimming and figure skating throughout my life, until one day I discovered Modern Pentathlon.

I was introduced to this sport 10 years ago. Fortunately, I didn't have to start completely from scratch. I was already an elite swimmer and had experience in equestrian sports. But Pentathlon is a complex and demanding discipline. It combines five events: swimming, fencing, running, shooting, and, until Paris 2024, equestrian, now replaced with obstacle course racing (OCR).

In 2018, I competed in the South American Games in Cochabamba, Bolivia, where I won my first international medal for Ecuador. That success marked the beginning of my preparation for the Pan American Games in Lima. However, that year was mentally challenging. I seriously considered retiring from elite sport to focus on my professional career and pursue a master's degree.

But Lima, which I thought would be my last competition, turned out to be the most important of my life. Against all odds, I secured the Olympic qualifica-

tion spot for South America, making the first Ecuadorian pentathlete in history to qualify for the Olympic Games.

From that moment on, the journey was not only filled with joy, but it also brought setbacks and serious mental challenges. I experienced pressure, criticism, and envy from people who made me question whether I truly deserved the dream I had fought for.

Then the pandemic hit. Everything was uncertain. We were in lockdown for two months without access to training. I also contracted COVID just two months before the Games. But with the support of my family, I got through it. One day at a time. Despite the difficulties, I had incredible experiences. I travelled the world preparing for the Games, met amazing people, and learned from each one of them.

When the big day finally arrived, stepping into the Olympic Village was a dream come true. Representing Ecuador at the most important sporting event in the world was the fulfilment of a childhood dream, the dream of a 6-year-old girl who used to play with an Olympic Barbie and imagined being like her one day.

At Tokyo, I learned something important: while winning is admirable, just getting there is already a victory. Even though it took me only five years in pentathlon to reach the Olympics, I had actually been preparing for nearly twenty years.

The experience was tough. I made mistakes during the competition—but I chose to enjoy every moment, to thank God, and to honour everyone who supported me. I crossed the finish line with a heart full of gratitude and pride.





Every training session, every sacrifice was worth it. For me, being an Olympian means discipline, commitment, and above all, resilience.

After Tokyo, I took time to focus on my mental health. I continued competing and won more medals for Ecuador. I qualified for the 2023 Pan American Games in Santiago. But on the day of the event, I suffered an injury that prevented me from qualifying for Paris.

Even so, I felt proud. My teammates, including my boyfriend, qualified, and I was able to support them, just as they supported me in Tokyo. Truthfully, that period was incredibly hard. I faced dark moments and battled depression. But I made a decision: to be strong for myself and for the people I love. I chose to fight, to heal, and ultimately, to save my own life.

Today, I'm in a much better place. I've learned that when one door closes, others open often in unexpected and beautiful ways. I was awarded a scholarship to pursue my master's degree, which changed everything for me. Now, I serve as President of the Athletes' Commission at the Ecuadorian Olympic Committee. In this role, I'm deeply committed to supporting and protecting athletes, ensuring they feel safe, heard, and empowered to chase their dreams.

And now, I have the honour of representing my country once again, here at this important and enriching event. It's a new way to contribute to the development of sport in Ecuador. Sports have taught me that limits do not exist—and that every defeat may be a hidden opportunity. You just have to trust the process.

No matter where you come from or what obstacles you face, if you have passion and the courage to work for it, you can go further than you ever imagined. Believe in yourself! Surround yourself with people who will stand by



you, even during the hardest moments. Fight for your dreams. And when you fall, get up, smile, and keep going.

Thank you for allowing me to share my story. I hope, in some small way, it inspires you to follow your own path with courage, resilience, and hope.

And remember, dreams do come true.

## MY OLYMPIC EXPERIENCE

Aishath SAJINA (MDV)



Hi everyone, my name is Sajina, and I represented the Maldives in the Tokyo 2020 Olympics in the 100m breaststroke event. I started swimming at the age of 8, simply to earn a swimming badge. Little did I know that this small step would set me on a journey that shaped my life.

One of the biggest challenges I faced was the lack of proper swimming facilities. Though we are surrounded by water, it did not meet the right conditions for training. There was no standard pool, and that made training difficult.

With scholarships from the Maldives Olympic Committee and FINA, I first started my training abroad in Sri Lanka, and then moved to Thailand to train for Rio 2016, and lastly to Malaysia under an Olympic Solidarity scholarship for Tokyo 2021.

Living abroad had its perks and challenges, too. The good thing was making lifelong friends all over the world and learning about different cultures.

Though it was challenging to be away from my family for most of the year, I had another family: coaches who were like parents, and friends who became family.

My parents always stood by me and encouraged me. They took me back and forth to practices and sat under the hot sun until the practice sessions were done. My sister, who was an Olympian as well, is my biggest inspiration and my biggest competitor. She is my role model.



A key moment early in my career was competing at the Youth Olympic Games in 2014 Nanjing, China. That experience made the Olympic dream feel real and deeply personal. It was then that I committed myself fully to making it to the Olympics. Along the way, I broke multiple national records in the 50m, 100m and 200m breaststroke and won medals at international platforms that symbolised years of hard work and sacrifice.

Representing the Maldives at the Olympics will always be my greatest achievement. Tokyo 2020 was especially challenging—the pandemic disrupted everything: training, competitions, and even the event itself was delayed. Yet, stepping into the Olympic swimming arena in Tokyo, after all the obstacles, was an overwhelming and unforgettable moment.

What Being an Olympian Means to Me. Being an Olympian is more than just competing. It's a symbol of dreams pursued with relentless determination.

Standing on the Olympic stage in Tokyo, I didn't just carry my swim cap, I carried the hopes of a nation, the pride of my family, and the dreams of every young Maldivian athlete watching.

It meant becoming the representation of possibility, especially for those from small nations who are told their dreams are too big.

Being an Olympian is not just a title. It's a responsibility to inspire, to lead, and to show that with enough heart, even the smallest waves can reach the world's biggest ocean.



Swimming has taught me invaluable lessons:

- Discipline—waking up when the world is still asleep, being in a healthy routine, pushing through pain and doubt.
- Respect—for the sport, competitors, and myself
- Friendship—building a family with teammates across countries
- Resilience—learning to come back stronger after setbacks, whether I win or lose

You are your biggest supporter and your biggest challenger. There will be days when you want to quit, when obstacles seem impossible, and when the path feels too hard. But believe in yourself. Work hard, push through, and never give up. What matters is your determination.



## THE JOURNEY OF A FIGHTER FROM THE MAT TO MEDICINE

Abdelrahman ALMASATFA (JOR)



### To the future Ambassadors of the International Olympic Academy

I am Abdelrahman Almasatfa, Olympic bronze medallist at Tokyo 2020, World No. 1 in the global ranking, Best Athlete in the World in 2023, and a proud 4-times Asian Champion. I share my story with you not to celebrate titles, but to show what is possible when you live by the values of sport and refuse to surrender to limits.

On the tatami, I learned that greatness is not given; it is earned through years of sacrifice, relentless training, and the courage to rise every time life knocks you down. Every medal I won, every championship I claimed, came from moments when I could have quit but chose to fight instead. The Olympic podium



taught me one powerful truth: true champions are not made in comfort, but in struggle.

Yet my journey did not stop at sport. I pursued medicine with the same passion, becoming a doctor while competing at the highest level of karate. Balancing these two worlds—saving lives and chasing Olympic dreams—was never easy. But sport had already forged my mindset: no challenge is too big when your heart is committed.

To you, the next Ambassadors, I say this:

You are not just athletes; you are voices of hope and examples of what humanity can achieve through discipline and unity. Carry the Olympic spirit like a torch, lighting the path for others. Your victories will be remembered, but the values you embody will inspire generations.





*Olympians Dwayne Didon, Hoi Shun Stephanie Au and Nicholas Edward Choi also presented their Olympic experiences.*





A grayscale photograph of a large, multi-story building with a prominent central staircase and palm trees in the foreground. The building has a long, symmetrical facade with many windows and a central entrance. The staircase is wide and leads up to the entrance. There are palm trees in the foreground and along the sides of the building. The overall scene is brightly lit, possibly by sunlight or strong artificial lights.

# EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITY REPORTS





## SPORTS ACTIVITIES

### Track and Field

The Track and Field event of the 65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors took place on 17 June. There were six different disciplines on the programme, with females and males competing separately.

- 1200m (5 laps) run
- 250m (1 lap) run
- 100m sprint
- Standing long jump
- Shot put
- 3x80m mixed relay

The list of participants was drawn up based on the representatives of each working group. To maintain equality between the disciplines, participants were asked to register for only one event (the only exception to the rule was if there was a lack of participation in all disciplines).

The competition began with the coordinators entering the stadium dressed in traditional Greek attire (chiton) and carrying olive branch wreaths. They performed a short opening ceremony in English.





The event began with a 1200m run for women, while the men competed in the standing long jump and shot put. Then came the 1200m long-distance run for men, while the women's standing long jump and shot-put competitions took place simultaneously. This was followed by the 250m run, which was organised for the first time.

Next came the 3x80m mixed relay. Each venue gathered a large crowd of fans who cheered on the competitors.

The final event was the 100m sprint for male and female athletes. Both male and female athletes ran two semi-finals, with the first two finishers qualifying for the final. After the competition, all the winners of each event were honoured with olive wreaths.

Despite the intense heat and sunshine, the crowd remained enthusiastic, cheering on all the competitors and creating a great atmosphere.



## **Basketball**

The programme was both engaging and impactful for all involved.

We had approximately 25 to 30 participants actively taking part in the basketball activities throughout the week, including both male and female participants. Most of the female participants were beginners, so we focused on teaching them the basics, such as how to hold the ball, shoot properly, and understand the flow of the game. To help build confidence and teamwork, we organised friendly 3-on-3 and 4-on-4 matches on a half court, which the participants thoroughly enjoyed.

On the other hand, most of the male participants were already quite experienced, with some even being elite-level players. They took the initiative to organise their own daily matches, which ran smoothly and showed great competitiveness and sportsmanship.

What stood out the most was the consistent enthusiasm, almost everyone turned up to play every single day from the 11th to the 17th. It was wonderful to see participants not only learning and enjoying the sport but also building new friendships and showing respect and excellence, aligning with Olympic values.

Overall, the basketball activities were a great success and added tremendous value to the YOA experience.



## Football

From 10 to 16 June, football activities were organised as part of the 65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors. Unlike previous years, there were no formal teams, no structured tournament and no team names. Instead, the focus of the event was entirely on inclusivity, fun and friendly matches.

With over 30 participants expressing interest in joining the football games, a dynamic and flexible environment was created where players could rotate freely between matches. The absence of fixed teams meant that everyone, regardless of their skill level or previous experience, could participate at their own pace and level of comfort.

While the coordinators were present to facilitate the start of the games, help organise warm-ups and ensure fair play, after the first couple of days they stepped back from active play to focus solely on managing the sessions. This

relaxed structure allowed players to organise themselves, mix with different groups and enjoy football without pressure or competition.

Participants were encouraged to bring light and dark shirts to distinguish the teams, which were formed on the spot before each match. This approach allowed for continuous reshuffling, giving everyone the opportunity to play with new people each day. The focus was not on winning, but on having fun, being active and building community spirit.

Despite the informal setting, the matches were lively and well attended. Players demonstrated great enthusiasm, mutual support, and sportsmanship. By the end of the week, the football sessions had created a space for connection, movement and joy that was perfectly aligned with the Olympic values of friendship, respect and excellence.



### **Volleyball**

One of the available sports activities was Volleyball, which attracted approximately 8 to 14 participants during the scheduled hours. Players of varying skill levels came together, demonstrating true sportsmanship and a shared enthusiasm for the

game. The atmosphere was inclusive and enjoyable, with everyone actively participating and having a good time.

### **Morning Workout Sessions: An Energetic Start to the Day**

Each morning, from 7:00 to 7:30 am, an invigorating workout session was held on the track, providing a consistent and energetic start to the day.

Participants gathered as a group, and a unique rotating leadership model was implemented: each day, one individual from among the participants was selected in advance to lead the workout. This approach not only fostered active engagement but also provided a platform for individuals to showcase their skills and share their preferred exercises or warm-up routines, contributing to a diverse and collective experience.



## Swimming Gala

The Swimming Gala was held on the morning of June 17 as part of the broader programme of activities for the Young Olympic Ambassadors. The event aimed to celebrate and showcase aquatic talent and to create an inclusive environment

where participants of all levels could engage with swimming in a meaningful and enjoyable way. To facilitate the programme and enhance the atmosphere, a speaker system with a microphone was used to provide clear instructions and to play music throughout the event.

### *1. Synchronised Swimming Performance*

The gala commenced with a performance by three synchronised swimmers who choreographed and presented a routine for the participants. Earlier in the week, these athletes had voluntarily led a synchronised swimming workshop during one of the designated sports afternoons, teaching a group of approximately 30 participants the basics of synchronised movement in the water.

### *2. Group Performance by Workshop Participants*

Following the initial performance, the 30 workshop participants showcased the routine they had learned. Their group performance demonstrated not only the skills acquired but also the spirit of collaboration and confidence fostered through the workshop.

### *3. 4x25m Freestyle Relay*

Next, two mixed-gender teams composed of Olympians, national team members, and competitive swimmers took part in a 4x25 meter freestyle relay. The race featured advanced swimming techniques such as relay exchange dives, underwater dolphin kicks, and high-speed freestyle, serving as an inspiring exhibition for all attendees.

#### *4. Participant Relay Race*

Building on the energy of the competitive relay, participants were invited to form their own teams and take part in a swimming relay of their own. Approximately 30 participants took part in this event, engaging in friendly competition and teamwork alongside experienced swimmers.

#### *5. Olympic Rings in the Pool*

As a closing symbolic gesture, coordinators and participants who felt comfortable with the idea entered the pool to form five interconnected circles representing the Olympic rings. This act of unity was captured by a drone photograph, serving as a visual celebration of inclusivity, international friendship, and the shared Olympic spirit.

#### *Closing Atmosphere*

Throughout the gala, participants were encouraged to remain by the poolside, engage with those who performed or competed, swim freely, and enjoy the music. The relaxed and celebratory environment allowed for meaningful exchanges between participants and athletes, reinforcing community through sport.









*Torch relay in the Academy.*





*Olympic Day Run in Ancient Olympia.*

## ARTISTIC ACTIVITIES

### Fine Arts Workshop

The Fine Arts workshop was designed to encourage creativity by integrating art with Olympism. During the 65th YOA Session, coordinators structured the workshop around combining traditional and ethnic patterns with Olympic or sport symbols to explore the main Session topic, “The Future and Challenges of the Olympic Movement”.



Across five workshops, there were 20 Ambassadors who each produced one or more pieces of art. Initial ideas emerged from group discussions and exchanges on traditions, knowledge, and cultures. Participants selected themes for expression and employed traditional ethnic patterns—either from their

own backgrounds or others—to represent these themes visually.

The group collaborated on a collective artwork that allowed all participants to contribute at the session’s conclusion. This piece featured the International Olympic Academy logo at the centre of four transparent panels, incorporating the concept of AI with a half-erased background.

Ambassadors displayed their individual projects during the Arts Happening Night, explaining the origins and significance of their concepts. The group

project was also presented, with an invitation for everyone to write something or add their names to it.

Here are some examples of the presentations:

### **1. Guerline GUERRIER (Haiti)**

She selected one of Haiti's main monuments, Neg Mawon, which represents Haiti's liberation from French rule and slavery. Through this drawing, she aimed to illustrate how sport and Olympism have the potential to bring freedom to people globally.



### **2. Mohamed Tariq ALSALEEM (Saudi Arabia)**

The drawing aims to combine Olympic values; symbolised by the coloured rings; humanity, depicted by the hands, and the concept of purchasing goods, represented by the apple.



### 3. Hala AMRO (Palestine)

Her piece conveys her perspective on global hope. The Flame symbolises the spread of hope and values internationally. Incorporating her country's flag is intended to help prevent future conflicts and encourage unity.



### 4. Valentine WOLFGANG (Germany)

Valentine discovered traditional patterns from her community, commonly drawn on dishes as wedding or family gifts. She incorporated the Olympic value of respect, which she experienced during the YOA Session, and used a letter frame originally designed by Mainz native Johannes Gutenberg, inventor of the printer.



### 5. Anais Ines Toyin PIERRESS (Benin)

Anais and Guerline discussed their ideas and decided to use a similar pattern: combining national symbolism with the Olympic rings. Anais selected the Statue

of the Amazon to represent women, including athletes from the country who strive for excellence. She also chose the Academy's logo, noting that the statue serves as a symbol of strength for future generations, and that the IOA aims to inspire and support the next generation of the Olympic Movement.



## 6. Group project





## Dance Workshop

The dance workshop attracted around 10 to 15 participants during the allocated hours. The initial sessions focused on exploring a variety of dance styles from different cultures, including traditional Greek dances, Latin American rhythms, a South African dance, and Zumba. These sessions provided an opportunity for participants to discover diverse cultural expressions through movement and simply enjoy dancing together.

As the group prepared for the Arts Happening event, they decided to learn and perform two dances: a traditional Greek dance set to the songs *To Mantili* and *Margoudi*, and a lively line dance to *Footloose*. The workshop was filled with energy, creativity, and collaboration. Overall, it was a fun and enjoyable experience for everyone involved.







DR





### Poetry Workshop: The Poets of Olympia

The “Poets of Olympia” workshop once again provided participants with a creative outlet to express their experiences at the International Olympic Academy. The workshop aimed to connect attendees with the art of poetry writing, echoing Pierre de Coubertin’s own passion for the written word.

The first workshop, held in the Library, welcomed 18 participants and introduced them to Dada Poetry. Attendees were asked to share a single word that captured their initial feelings upon arriving at the Academy. These words were then randomised, and participants used them, in the given order, to craft their poems. This method offered a structured approach, particularly beneficial for those new to poetry writing.

The second workshop took place under the stars at the Pierre de Coubertin Grove, drawing a record 31 participants. Gazing at the night sky, they found inspiration in the thought that they were beneath the same stars seen by the ancient Greeks and Coubertin himself. This session, themed “Why Olympia Matters”, encouraged participants to write heartfelt poems without any format restrictions.

Both workshops resulted in beautiful and deeply emotional poems, reflecting the participants’ experiences at the Academy and their affection for the Olympic Movement.

### WORKSHOP 1 - “DADA POETRY”

#### FEEL THAT

*Poet Miyoba Nchimunya Mudenda (ZAM)*

I got off the bus and I couldn’t help but be amazed at this sensational Wonder that I was looking at.

I felt so privileged to among the not so few people who were able to take part in Another historical event.

I must say I am so grateful to be part of this exciting journey and the euphoric sense of freedom and peace I’m experiencing makes me feel at home.

## **IT'S ALWAYS INTERNAL**

*Poet Lee Yan Ying (SGP)*

Home, truly where my senses whisper: this is it  
Where waves of euphoric gratefulness rush in and take over  
How rare, how privileged,  
to pause life's motion  
and let awe and wonder  
flood the heart, soul, and mind.  
There is peace – undeniable.  
It stills me.  
Amazes me.  
Excites me.  
Yet it startles and haunts those untouched by the lessons of history.

## **JOURNEY HOME**

*Poet Fred Quek (SGP)*

Home is where I yearn to be,  
Feeling euphoric when I knew I would soon return  
Grateful for the chance to once again leave my mark in the academy  
Determined I was, to do a sensational job  
For I knew how privileged I was to lead  
When we arrived in Olympia, wonder filled my mind  
An overwhelming sense of peace filled me  
I was amazed, just how excited I was  
Knowing full well we would create history here

## **WHERE HISTORY LIVES IN FLAME**

*Poet Boitshoko Nchoe (RSA)*

It felt like home where skies are blue.  
A place where dreams feel euphoric and hearts beat of passion.  
So sensational, where hopes collides.  
I felt privileged as we walked through the halls of light and rich memory.

As our faces wonder bright like the stars.  
Peace brought by the olive tree, a path beyond any comparison.  
I will forever be amazed and excited about the stories.  
The IOA, a village that holds so much history and legacy, year after year.

## **HOME AT LAST**

*Poet Nick Forrester (NZL)*

Everything new, yet warmly familiar,  
A quiet joy becomes a radiant euphoria.  
Humble and grateful,  
A unique sensation starts to stir.  
To learn is our privilege—in this special place.  
A Grecian paradise, steeped in wonder,  
Peace aplenty in these ancient grounds.  
We come amazed and excited,  
Leave connected and inspired.  
Celebrating our history,  
Focused on the future,  
Embracing the present.  
Home at Last.

## **COMMON GROUND**

*Poet Gabrielle Cairns (NZL)*

Home is not a place, but a feeling.  
Euphoric moments rise  
when laughter crosses language.  
Grateful for the effort,  
a seat saved, a story offered.  
Something sensational happens  
when differences find rhythm.  
Privileged to hear truths  
shaped by people across the globe.

Wonder stays with us.  
Peace doesn't need to be perfect,  
just intentional.  
I am amazed by sport's power  
to bring people together.  
We are excited for what's next.  
History is shared,  
written side by side.

## UNTITLED

*Poet Pedro Ramos (POR)*

Home is not just walls and a place to stay,  
It is where the soul can rest and fly away.  
Kinda like an euphoric breath at end of day,  
When troubles slowly start to fade away.  
I feel grateful for the morning light,  
For the laughs that echo through the night.  
Each moment, small yet sensational,  
Makes everyday feels inspirational.  
I'm privileged just to be present  
With open eyes and a steady hand,  
The world still living with resent,  
Like a bunch of rocks that just turn into sand.  
In silent woods I wonder if that's peace,  
Or maybe just the absence of noise,  
The weight of doubt begins to cease,  
And it truly amazed me to see that wasn't our choice.  
I'm excited for the paths ahead,  
For words not spoken, books not read,  
They carry dreams, we carry history,  
So maybe we shape tomorrow with our mystery.

## COMING TOGETHER IN PEACE

*Poet Rafa Mendoza (MEX)*

Eight years ago, I came to the academy very young.  
Since then I call it my home.  
Now, a little older I still feel euphoric just as the first time I step into the academy.  
How grateful I am, to be sharing with you guys this sensational place.  
How privileged we are to be sharing our cultures and breaking prejudices altogether.  
Olympia, a place for Wonder, where more than 2000 years ago the Greeks joined in the celebration of Agon.  
Today, in a hectic world we merge together looking for peace.  
I am amazed to see that the cultures of the world can live harmoniously together.  
I am excited to know what's coming ahead.  
Our history is yet to be heard.

## MY OLYMPIC AWAKENING

*Poet A'janae King Fraser (TTO)*

Home.  
What do I call home?  
Sixteen hours across skies and seas to the cradle of the Olympic spirit.  
The land where legends rose and races began.  
In five days I found more than just ruins.  
I found peace beneath the picturesque views and luscious greenery.  
Love and appreciation in shared cultures and languages.  
Unity in every voice raised with purpose,  
and sanctity in the footsteps we retraced.  
This is what I now call home.  
Euphoric.  
From watching the Games as a patriot and dreamer, to standing where they were born,  
my heart caught the wind and soared.

The campus around me, bloomed with statues that breathe rich legacy and  
hills whispering the names of those who paved this sacred path.

I was no longer a spectator. Now, I have stepped into the story.

Grateful.

To my National Olympic Committee, thank you!

For choosing me to carry the flame of this mission.

For giving me a seat at this global table of tomorrow's leaders.

My life has lifted with each conversation and each shared dream spoken  
beneath the blazing sun.

Sensational.

Have you ever felt a shiver of pride rush through your veins?

That shiver of pride when we passed through the IOA gates;

the artifacts pulsed and

the air itself declared: "You belong here".

Privileged.

To walk where the first Olympians once stood, to sit where philosophy met sport  
and to know that I too am part of that conversation now.

This opportunity and experience is not just a gift  
but a responsibility I hold close to my heart.

Wonder.

Every moment sparkled like dew on the morning grass.

The friendships blooming in hours,

the curiosity in every question,

the laughter echoing off ancient stone.

This place breathes magic.

Peace.

Found not just in stillness

but in the harmony of cultures, stories and hopes woven into the world.

I found peace in diversity and calm in knowing that we are not so different  
after all.

Amazed.

At how five days can reshape a life.

At how strangers become family.

At how standing in the stadium on holy ground makes you feel so grateful for  
those that went before you.

Excited.

For the journey ahead.  
To take this energy back to Trinidad and Tobago and carry forward the  
mission we've begun.  
To spark flames of Olympic spirit in others as it has sparked in me.  
History.  
It isn't just behind us; it's within us.  
Alive in every step across Olympia's soil,  
every word spoken in this sanctuary.  
The past is not a story to be told but a baton passed through our hands.

### **HOME WHERE DREAM BEGINS**

*Poet Hadas Mugisha (RWA)*

Home is where the dream begins,  
Where practice starts and the heart wins.  
Euphoric cheers when we break the line,  
A moment shared, pure and divine.  
Grateful for the chance to play,  
To push our limits every day.  
A sensational feeling when we run,  
Under the bright and blazing sun.  
Privileged to compete, side by side,  
With friends from far and wide.  
In wonder, we see the world come near,  
Different but the same, no fear.  
Peace in each step, each game we play,  
Learning to respect, win or stray.  
Amazed by the strength we find,  
In the body, the heart, the mind.  
Excited for the race to start,  
For every challenge, for every part.  
History is made, no matter the place,  
In the spirit of the human race.

## **A LONG JOURNEY, A DREAM COME TRUE**

*Poet Agustina Modernell (URU)*

A long trip alone, my home is now really far.  
The bus arrived to Olympia. I felt euphoric.  
The suitcase was heavy, but not because the things I carry on.  
A dream come true, without words, sensational  
Sports always means privilege. The world came wonderfully, when we can  
learn with other cultures, other languages, other realities.  
Here we are in peace, here we can be who we are, and not who we should be.  
Now the Young Ambassadors have grown up, we are part of this big history,  
with the motivation and the obligation to bring the legacy to our countries.

## **THE FLAME WE CARRY FORWARD**

*Poet Brúnó Negyeliczky (HUN)*

The home I found in Greece so far,  
under clear skies and rising stars.  
Euphoric days with heartfelt vibes,  
where dreams, nations, and Ambassadors  
walked side by side.  
Grateful I stood where Coubertin spoke,  
his words still warm, where Olympism woke.  
Sensational days with stories and song,  
where every voice could always belong.  
Privileged to learn, to laugh, to share,  
to feel The Movement everywhere.  
Wonder danced in every flame,  
in every smile and every name.  
Peace was not just a whispered word,  
but lived in all we felt and heard.  
Amazed, I watched the world as one,  
beneath Olympia's golden sun.  
Excited now, I hold it dear,  
that Olympic spirit, strong and clear.  
History is not just old and done,  
it's us, it's now, and we've just begun.



**UNTITLED***Poet Sofia Menjívar (GUA)*

Each time I'm far from home,  
I leave the place I've always known.  
Though nerves may rise, I still move on  
This feeling hits: euphoric, strong.  
With every step on the beautiful Greece, I grow more bold,  
And in my heart, I'm grateful, whole.  
The Olympic Academy is sensational  
An honor that feels so inspirational.  
Not everyone gets this time,  
So I feel privileged deep inside.  
If I wonder, "Do I deserve this place?"  
The peace within me sets the pace.  
Their people, culture  
I'm amazed,  
By every word, on every place.  
In every moment, I'm excited,  
We are a world united.  
Because I've learned, through every story,  
That we all carry living history.

**MY SECOND HOME***Poet Hadas Mugisha (RWA)*

Home is a place of Identity, belonging, comfort, safety and Love  
The Most Euphoric moments happen there  
I am Grateful to Find myself a second home.  
How sensational it is to walk down the marble stairs surrounded by beautiful  
greenery,  
what a privilege it is to walk through the ruins of the temple of Zeus and  
running across the ancient stadium.  
what a wonder to see a gathering of people from all walks of life  
With Peace abounding,  
Everyone Amazed at the Legacy of the ancient Greeks that stands to this day.

Excited for what's to come of the 65th International session for YOA  
I am super proud to partake in the History making for the future of sports in  
my second Home.

## WORKSHOP 2 - "WHY OLYMPIA MATTERS"

### UNTITLED

*Poet Shapath Bharadwaj (IND)*

It might not be for the history or for the tradition,  
It might not be the stadium or the natural heritage,  
It might not even be the skies or the stars,  
It might not even be a story of heroes or Olympians,  
But at the end of it all it is the people that you meet everyone united by the  
history to create the present walking along the stadium uniting not just the  
present but eons of the world bringing us all together a family united and  
coming home as one under the heritage of Olympia.

### UNTITLED

*Poet Arman Avetisyan (ARM)*

I have been to some truly beautiful places and met some really good people, but  
in Olympia, I truly felt at home. Not the home I live in, but the home where my  
heart and spirit belong. Olympia, you have my heart. You stole it and kept it in  
the air of this magnificent place where excellence meets respect and friendship  
and where values matter more than anything else in the universe.

### THIS IS WHY OLYMPIA MATTERS

*Poet Fred Quek (SGP)*

In a world that changes constantly  
In a world that moves ever forward

Olympia remains, steadfast  
What a sight it is  
The trees, the hills, the rivers  
Serves to inspire, allows me to aspire  
Consider this my ode to Olympia  
Thank you for all you have given us  
Thank you for all you will give us  
Thank you for allowing us to dream  
This is why Olympia matters

### **WHY OLYMPIA MATTERS**

*Poet Krizelle Polvoriza (PHI)*

More than a hundred countries  
where different cultures meet  
a place where we can be anyone we want to be  
under the twinkling stars  
united by dreams that stretch far  
strength in every step we take  
a world where boundaries break

### **WHY OLYMPIA MATTERS TO THE WORLD?**

*Poet Tony Alvarado (GUA)*

Olympia matters because was, is and will be a place where every culture of the world can merge.

It's a place where no matter what conflict is going on among 1, 2 or more nations, excuses end when you enter the gate because you are not your whole country then it's just you and what actions you will be remembered for.

### **UNTITLED**

*Poet Pitsiava Catherine (GRE)*

In the shade of the olive, a light was born,

where people left behind the “I” they wore.  
No swords, no rage just common ground,  
they ran as one, where peace was found.  
A humble place, with a mighty heart  
Olympia still brings us together, not apart.

### **WHY OLYMPIA? WHY THIS PLACE?**

*Poet Magali Fernandez de Landa (Maggie) (ARG)*

It holds the soul of the beginning.  
How lucky I am to walk where legends shaped the soul,  
An IOA Ambassador,  
A guardian of what came before.  
I carry now the torch unseen,  
In every word, in every action  
In the sport that makes the world a friend.  
Here I stand, where all begins, writing my own history.

### **UNTITLED**

*Poet Pedro Ramos (POR)*

I’m going to run the risk of being self-centred, but with all the importance that Olympia had and has in sport as we know it, I’ve chosen to write about what it means to me.

It’s dream that has become a necessity. I never thought I would need these much to be in this paradise with so much history.

Hundreds of people from a hundred different countries, all together, moments of sharing, without judgement, without war. Maybe this is the peace we need.

I’m leaving with the certainty that I’ll carry Olympia in my heart, that I’ll carry lessons I’ll never forget and that, if it’s up to me, I’ll be back to this place where I was happy.

**THE RING BENEATH ANCIENT SKY***Poets Villő Pokornyi & Brúnó Negyeliczky (HUN)*

Under the stars, we sit in a ring,  
No need for words, just everything.  
Next to Coubertin, we feel the past,  
A quiet moment made to last.  
Hungarian hearts among new friends,  
In Olympia, where the journey bends.  
Not just Ambassadors, but a big family now,  
With hearts united, and this is how.  
In this circle, we start to grow.  
From this night, we'll always carry  
The spirit of sport  
strong, proud, and merry.  
The flame of Olympia guides us now,  
With Coubertin's dream that we all allow.  
Olympism lives in what we do:  
Respect, friendship, and courage too.

**UNTITLED***Poet Sofia Menjivar (GUA)*

Olympia is a heartbeat of emotions, where sport weaves strangers into lifelong souls. Greek golden sunsets kiss the sky and my skin with shivers, and the nights glow with a culture so alive, it pulls you in. In that shared fire, we are no longer many, just one.

**WHY OLYMPIA MATTERS?***Poet Lara Hofman (SRB)*

Under the sky full of stars,  
we sit in a circle together,  
thinking about ancient times  
and tradition that lasts forever.

Different cultures, nations, backgrounds,  
but all connected with the same goal  
to keep the spirit and message of Olympism  
alive as time goes on.  
It's not just the history  
or the nature of this place  
that gives it its magic,  
but also all the people  
who have been here  
and those who are yet to come.  
Now, we are part of that magic,  
and Olympia will be a part of us.  
The friendships, the knowledge,  
the Olympic spirit and memories  
they will shape who we are  
and where we go next.

## **WHY ANCIENT OLYMPIA MATTERS**

*Poet Hadas Mugisha (RWA)*

Olympia matters because it is the birth place of the Olympic games.  
Olympia matters because it is the iconic symbol of global togetherness, peace  
and unity.  
Olympia matters because out of it sprang the Greek legacy that would last  
centuries and centuries afterwards.  
Olympia matters because it still instils the spirit of Olympism to this day.  
Olympia matters because somehow visitors get a lively feel of ancient  
Olympism.  
Olympia matters because it matters indeed.

## **OLYMPIA**

*Poet Anna Wheeler (GBR)*

The alpha, the omega,  
The beginning and end,

Where strangers meet on common ground,  
By olive branches crowned,  
The flames still burn, the values stay:  
Excellence in every day,  
Respect that lifts, not pulls apart,  
And friendship born from an open heart.  
Under the same star spangled sky,  
We reach beyond, yet start within.  
Olympia  
Not just then, but always now.  
A home for those who dare to dream,  
Who run, who leap, who vow  
All nations reach for the same goals,  
To rise, to fail, and rise again  
Together, not as foes, but kin.  
Shown by the exchanged pins,  
Olympia, the alpha, the omega,  
Our journey's end, our place to begin.

### **WHY OLYMPIA MATTERS?**

*Poet Dwayne Didon (SEY)*

Men withers,  
As time flickers,  
One philosopher said,  
Perfection of a body is not born but made,  
Olympia, Oh Olympia, I embrace your existence,  
Thank you for your persistence,  
Thought to be lost in the abyss,  
How our ignorance was bliss,  
Your resurrection,  
Has been our unforeseen resolution,  
The world meeting in one place,  
Everyone in one united pace,  
Forgetting our punitive thoughts,

Displacing our inner doubts,  
Humanity, we are one,  
Under the stars shone,  
Each individual unique,  
Nothing too oblique,  
We now remember,  
We all matter,  
One World,  
One Earth,  
Olympia, the Olympics,  
We embrace you.

## Arts Happening

This year, Arts Happening took place on 17 June on the traditional marble stairs. The event began with an unconventional opening speech generated by Google Translate's AI. The event served as the final opportunity for participants to present their work from the art workshops: Dance, Poetry, and Fine Arts.

Ambassadors, IOA staff, and professors were seated on the marble stairs to observe the showcase. The hosts organised the programme to alternate between different types of performances, including both ambiance-focused presentations and performances related to Olympism.

The dance workshop featured three distinct performances. One was a dance reflecting the culture of the host country, Greece. The second performance was a line dance to "*Footloose*", inviting audience participation. The third dance integrated gymnasts and artistic dancers in an acrobatic routine. The poetry workshop included four segments that alternated between long and short poems, delivered in English, French, and Arabic, allowing participants to express personal experiences and reflections on their time at the International Olympic Academy. The fine arts workshop gave each participant time to present their individual pieces before collectively sharing a group project and a final collaborative piece involving all attendees.

For this event, coordinators included two additional performances: a game designed to illustrate coordinator roles and a rendition of John Lennon's song



*Imagine.* Two special projects were added to demonstrate the intersection of sport and art. Ruba Aldaoud (Jordan) presented a floor exercise from artistic gymnastics, while Abdel Rahman Almasatfa (Jordan) and Anna Sophia Wheeler (Austria) performed a piece that combined elements of dance and karate.

The evening concluded with a traditional *Sirtaki* dance featuring all participants. Appreciation is extended to all who participated in the art workshops and to the coordinators for leading the sessions.

## SOCIAL EVENINGS

### Participation Overview

- No flag representation was allowed during performances.
- Delegations were encouraged to present their culture, dance, food, and history. Formal presentations were not included.
- No political messaging or sensitive topics were permitted.
- Individual delegations were given a maximum time limit of 7 minutes.
- Group delegations had a time limit of 10 minutes.
- Music was to be submitted in Spotify link or MP3 format.
- For food tasting, trays were provided by the cafeteria, and delegations were requested to bring their own plates, glasses, and spoons from the supermarket.
- A total of 31 delegations signed up, including 6 group delegations (with a few additions and subtractions made closer to the event).

### Suggestions for Future Social Evenings

- It might be helpful to continue encouraging no flag representation, as it supports a neutral and inclusive atmosphere.
- Considering participant energy levels, perhaps limiting the number of Social Evenings to two could help maintain enthusiasm and engagement throughout.
- Sharing guidelines and expectations well in advance may allow delegations more time to prepare and plan meaningful contributions.
- To ensure smoother coordination, we could consider limiting participation to around 15 delegations across the two evenings.

- Reducing the performance time to 5 minutes for individual delegations and 10 minutes for group delegations might help with time management and overall flow.
- Encouraging delegations to represent their region or continent as group or thematic presentations could further promote unity and the spirit of Olympism.
- A wider variety of performance formats such as dance, fun elements, quizzes, songs, games, alongside food tasting—could help make the evenings even more engaging and dynamic. We should not allow food tasting as a separate category as it is time consuming.
- To keep things fair and focused, each delegation might be encouraged to perform only once, either individually or as part of a group delegation.
- Continuing with a first-come, first-served system for performance slots has worked well and could be maintained.
- Preparing a shared music playlist (after party) in advance would help ensure smooth transitions and keep the energy up during the evening.
- If possible, inviting a DJ for the final evening could add a celebratory touch and enhance the atmosphere.
- Lastly, to help participants remain refreshed and focused for the next day's sessions, it might be helpful to avoid serving drinks after 12:00 AM, particularly during mid-session evenings.

### **Key Highlights of Social Evening 2025**

- A total of six group delegations participated across the Social Evenings.
- The Latino Group was formed and performed for the first time, showcasing vibrant cultural unity.
- All delegations respectfully followed the assigned time limits, contributing to a well-managed and smooth flow of performances.



# CONCLUSIONS OF THE WORKING GROUPS





## CYCLE A

### FRENCH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 1

**Question 1: Should the development and use of artificial intelligence (AI) constitute a strategic priority for all National Olympic Committees (NOCs)?**

The Olympic Movement is organised around 206 NOCs with different aspirations and objectives depending on the financial, material, and human resources at their disposal. At the same time, humanity is living through a major revolution with the sudden rise of a disruptive technology which is hard to control and costly but yet transferable to all sectors, including that of sport.

At first glance, the core business of the NOCs seems far removed from the technological field. AI should not overshadow their fundamental missions: the promotion of the Olympic values, the development of physical activity and the support of athletes, as well as ethics and sporting fairness. Aligning AI with these priorities must be a prerequisite for its use.

Making AI a priority would risk exacerbating inequalities between NOCs to the detriment of the principle of universality of the Olympic Movement. The limited resources of some NOCs could be better devoted to local development, access to sport for all, and infrastructure support, rather than costly investments in AI.

Furthermore, the excessive use of personal data raises issues of security, confidentiality and respect for private life.

Nevertheless, in a world where innovation enhances prestige and influence, NOCs have an existential obligation to invest in AI in order to remain at the

forefront of global sport. This will enable sports organisations to remain attractive and address major societal and sustainable development challenges.

A real lever of efficiency for NOCs with few staff, AI makes it possible to optimise management, logistics and communication with interested parties, while anticipating human and material resource needs.

One of the main missions of NOCs is to develop the performance of athletes – and here AI offers strategic advantages: talent detection, training optimisation via biometric data and anticipation of risks of injury can help optimise sporting performance and strengthen national competitiveness.

Therefore, AI poses a challenge for the Olympic Movement, raising issues of alignment with values and fairness between NOCs. It nevertheless remains a disruptive technology that NOCs cannot avoid if their governance wishes to remain innovative and autonomous from private and public actors. The responsibility of the IOC in supporting all NOCs is essential here so as not to widen existing inequalities, as is increased solidarity between developed NOCs and those with fewer resources.

### **Question 2: How can artificial intelligence and human intelligence for the identification of talent be combined for countries that lack access to the latest technologies?**

During a lecture, Ms Agni Orfanoudaki discussed an initiative of the International Olympic Committee in Senegal aimed at identifying new sporting talent using artificial intelligence. While such a project could be generalised in favour of the universality of sport, its implementation raises concerns related to the lack of resources and training in the countries concerned.

Faced with the problems of access to artificial intelligence tools in developing countries, the establishment of mutual aid programmes between NOCs seems appropriate to remedy this. Designed to leverage AI in the detection of sporting talent, these programmes would allow the most advanced NOCs to share their tools, methods, and knowledge with those in developing countries. The IOC could support these efforts with a financial aid programme. Equally linked to this is the problem of the lack of education among these populations regarding the possibilities in the world of sport.

In the meantime, while AI opens up new perspectives, its growing use in



talent detection does not come without raising certain questions, most notably regarding the long-term effects it may have on professional practices and human skills. Indeed, if recruiters come to rely excessively on AI, they risk neglecting the essential groundwork in clubs. Moreover, blind trust in algorithmic tools can lead to a loss of transparency in selection criteria. Finally, there is also a risk that some profiles will not be detected if they do not meet the standards established by the algorithm, which could reinforce certain existing biases. It is therefore important to keep the objective of increasing efficiency while not replacing humans.

This is why AI only seems appropriate when its use can be supervised by the staff of the NOCs concerned to increase their capacities, and thus compensate for the lack of human resources in these organisations. Following the example of the Canadian detection programme “Recruit Camp”, it is possible to optimise the analysis of raw performance data by AI to offer personalised profile recommendations to NOC supervisors, focusing on efficiency.

This approach should be accompanied by early awareness of sport, starting in schools and supported by International Federations and NOCs. This favours an environment conducive to the emergence of talent, thus reducing dependence on AI.

In conclusion, a balanced collaboration between humans and AI can make talent detection more effective on the condition that it is adapted to local realities. It is also equally crucial to guarantee protection of athletes’ personal data, especially when they are minors.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 2

### **Question 1: How does esports affect the attention span of Generation Alpha?**

The Olympic Movement has long represented a vision of the future. Generation Alpha is the generation carrying the future more than anyone else. They have the potential to shape the world ahead. Traditional sports continue to face challenges in engaging today's youth. A possible solution repeatedly brought up is esports. However, the integration of esports is accompanied by concerns about its effects, especially on the attention span of youth. This may be influenced by interactions with other forms of modern media, since it is clear that younger people's attention spans and focus are decreasing.

First, there are several important perspectives to consider. Many esports games are fast-paced, requiring players to make quick decisions and to identify key visual and auditory cues. This is expected to steadily increase people's cognitive demands, including selective attention, reaction time, and the ability to process and prioritise multiple sources of information. Furthermore, most games are built with different layers and involve monitoring several elements at once. It may provide advantages that foster improved multitasking and task prioritisation. For instance, many online multiplayer games require players to simultaneously monitor maps, equipment, surroundings, teammates, and opponents. In this way, esports can enhance selective attention and improve multitasking skills for the younger generation.

Alternatively, a few negative points have to be taken into consideration. Most video games are built to offer instant rewards. After the completion of tasks, there is instant gratification and minimal downtime before the next task begins. This leads to a constant cycle of stimulation, where participants become

absorbed and dependent on these experiences. In addition, they are normally built to be highly visually stimulating. As a result, individuals may struggle to maintain sustained attention in contexts that demand patience, deep focus, and delayed rewards. Moreover, the continuous exposure to shifting stimuli and multiple layered scenarios can make it more difficult to single out an individual task, as frequent exposure to fragmented attention may impair the ability to concentrate on a single and sustained task.

In conclusion, it can be ascertained that while esports may enhance certain cognitive abilities, particularly those related to rapid information processing and multitasking, they may simultaneously undermine the development of sustained, focused attention. Further empirical research is needed to fully understand the long-term cognitive implications of esports engagement among youth.

### **Question 2: To what extent is artificial intelligence necessary for enhancing performance in sports?**

Artificial intelligence (AI) is becoming increasingly central to many aspects of modern life, including the realm of sports. This essay explores how performance enhancement through AI can align with the Olympic values of fair play, equality, and human dignity. In addition, significant advantages can be realised with optimal integration and careful human oversight.

Athlete performance is multifaceted, encompassing technique, nutrition, recovery, and psychology. AI plays a significant role in refining athletic techniques across various sports, such as basketball and tennis. AI-powered analytics provide real-time data on shot mechanics, tactics, strategies, speed, and time performance, enabling precise adjustments for improvement.

Moreover, AI is crucial for injury prevention. Utilising machine learning on biometric and motion data, systems like Kitman Labs and Zone7 detect subtle movement deviations and training loads, alerting coaches to injury risks. NBA teams also leverage AI to analyse training data, preventing overtraining and stress injuries.

Although it has its advantages, the integration of AI into sports performance raises important concerns. In physiotherapy, AI systems analyse extensive injury data, assessing the extent and nature, and identifying patterns or risk factors potentially missed by humans. They are capable of suggesting personalised

rehabilitation plans and predicting future injuries. Yet, despite AI's analytical power, human specialists remain solely responsible for evaluating AI-generated information and delivering accurate diagnoses.

Another concern is AI's reliance on human input and its potential impact on creativity. AI formulates recommendations based on existing, human-collected data. While AI-generated recommendations are accurate, an overreliance might suppress human creativity. The drive to develop novel techniques and explore unconventional approaches could diminish if adherence to data-driven "excellence" overshadows human intuition and innovation.

In conclusion, the expanding use of AI in sports demands a nuanced understanding. While AI offers substantial benefits in performance enhancement through data analysis (e.g., technique refinement, injury prevention), it also introduces valid concerns. These include the indispensable role of human judgment in critical areas like diagnosis and AI's potential to stifle human creativity. Ultimately, the optimal integration of AI in sports requires a balanced approach that harnesses its analytical power while safeguarding human creativity, intuition, and ethical responsibility.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 3

### **Question 1: How can AI be used to reduce socioeconomic disparities within the Olympic Movement?**

Artificial intelligence (AI) in the world of sports is bringing an era-defining change, accelerating the improvement and development of sports. The creation of software that facilitates AI and data analytics can contribute to the development of sport, enhance athlete performance, and increase participation in traditional sports. This technology will be groundbreaking, as it helps countries maximise their performances and ensures all have access to the same materials. Unfortunately, different countries in the world do not have the same access to this technology. This difference could cause the widening of the already existing gaps in sport performance, skewing the participation to a handful of countries.

In order to assess this problem, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) needs to create and develop an open-access AI-powered tool that will work as an assistant to the coaches in order to improve performance. In partnership with the Olympic Solidarity (OS) and The Olympic Partner Programme (TOP), NOCs will have the opportunity to apply for and receive software powered by AI, and the devices needed to run them. This will allow all countries, no matter their size, socioeconomic status, or lack of resources, to access a global movement to support the equitable development of the Olympic Movement.

AI applications to improve sport performance and talent identification have already been used. For instance, talent identification technology was used to assist Senegal in identifying potential athletes not currently involved in sports to compete in the next Youth Olympic Games. The idea is to further improve this initiative, promoting not only the use of video analysis to identify talents but also the use of data analysis tools to manage and predict future performance.

Imagine every country having access to that technology and being able to have nearly equal representation at future games, which would increase competitiveness. This technology can also assist coaches in analysing athletes' movements to help maximise performance. This programme can be offered to all age ranges, from grassroots participation to elite performers. As technology evolves, we should explore collaboration opportunities between the IOC, its members, and tech developers to create a more enjoyable, competitive, and fair experience.

Furthermore, to assess cultural differences and knowledge, the IOC will provide free online courses to teach about AI and its applications. The idea is to reduce not only the accessibility gap but also the gap in the technology know-how needed to follow the AI change. It will not fully bridge the gap between countries and the imbalance of resources; however, it can help begin shifting disparities and support the Olympic Movement's core values of excellence, respect, and friendship.

### **Question 2: To what extent should AI be utilised by judges in sports?**

Artificial intelligence (AI) is an inescapable concept in our lives today, which needs to be harnessed to ensure the Olympic Movement is not left in the past. The use of AI in sports judging is not a question of if; it is a question of to what extent. Whilst we acknowledge the benefits of AI, caution needs to be taken in its implementation, depending on the degree of objectivity inherent in the sport. The goal is to explore the deployment or usage of AI in judging in order to achieve the most accurate and fair result for the athlete.

**Full utilisation of AI:** AI technology should be fully utilised by judges in purely objective sports. The sports of swimming and athletics, where the sole metric of success is the end time, are the sports where AI technology needs to be leveraged to remove the human error involved in their judging. Human judgment in this context is constrained by the limitations of our senses. In contrast, AI is equipped with precise sensors, high-speed cameras, and high-speed computation, at a rate that is not within the realm of human possibility. It also doesn't depend on any kind of conditions.

**Moderate utilisation of AI:** In sports that involve an equal combination of objectivity and subjectivity, such as football and handball, AI must be used

in a manner that allows human judgment to be the ultimate authority. This is exemplified by the Video Assistant Referee system (VAR), where the main referee plays a supervisory role. The VAR system provides a platform whereby the referee can rewind the play in granular detail and even review AI-generated metrics to more accurately evaluate the athlete's intent in a contentious handball or illegal tackle situation. It is of critical importance that the final judgment remains with the human referee, who must interpret the action within the broader context of the game. This balance ensures that technology improves accuracy by making critical information visible, while leaving complex and interpretive decisions to human judgment.

**Sports with minimum AI utilisation:** It is understandable that certain sports could potentially only use AI for judging and do not need a human eye opinion. On the other hand, there are some sports that include not only numbers and statistics while judging, but also emotional sensitivity and subjective judgment, for example, rhythmic gymnastics, figure skating, and artistic swimming. Regarding information about artistic sports, it is argued that AI should not be involved in judging the artistic performance of these sports. This is so because this requires personal interpretations based on human emotions; that is, a subjective standpoint should be an important factor when it comes to judging the artistic component of these sports. For instance, in figure skating, two skaters do not necessarily get the same points for the same technically identical jump, because human bodily expressions are also considered when assessing the performance. If AI were used while judging these sports, it might not understand the human, emotional, and artistic component behind each performance, as AI does not have human emotions.

In summation, it is clear that in order to achieve the most accurate and fair result for the athlete, the level of involvement of AI when judging will depend on the degree of objectivity involved in the sport. It must be acknowledged that AI is a rapidly evolving technology, and although at this time we have argued for the relative use of AI in certain sports, the spectrum of its involvement must be constantly reviewed to achieve the optimal balance between efficiency and accuracy.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 4

**Question 1: How can the IOC monitor the use of AI effectively to keep athletes at the centre of the Movement in a fan-engagement-driven industry?**

The IOC's Olympic AI Agenda promotes ethical use of AI in sport, focusing on athlete support, event efficiency, fair play, and equal access to technology for all nations, while ensuring Olympic values are upheld. While AI offers immense opportunities for enhancing fan engagement, it's crucial to ensure that it does not lose sight of Olympic values, shifting focus away from the very individuals who make the Games possible: the athletes.

Despite the benefits AI offers, like improved fan engagement, enabling interactive tools, and providing insights into fan behaviour, AI makes sports increasingly fan-centric, with cash flow directed toward technology rather than athlete development. Valued at \$518.8 million in 2022, the global AI sports market is projected to reach \$4.3 billion by 2028, driven by fan engagement tools, predictive analytics, automated ticketing, and sponsorship systems. This might lead to a shift in the Olympic Movement's priorities towards profit over ethics. Moreover, decision-making is often led by technology professionals, sidelining athletes and sport-specific experts who understand the spirit of Olympism. AI in sport must be evaluated for its psychological, reputational, and privacy impacts on athletes in order to protect their well-being. Its development should include meaningful input from athletes and International Federations to reflect each sport's values. Fan engagement technologies must promote equitable access across diverse contexts, while commercial uses of AI should uphold, not undermine, Olympism's human-centred values. Transparent



governance through regular audits and public reporting is essential to ensure ethical accountability.

To uphold the values of the Games, the IOC must adopt a clear, ethical, and transparent framework for AI use centred on athlete well-being, especially in fan engagement. Involving athletes and IOC experts in the development and oversight of AI tools will help ensure that innovation supports, rather than overshadows, the Olympic spirit. This includes promoting equitable fan access and safeguarding against commercial uses of AI that could undermine the principles of Olympism.

**Question 2: How can we ensure technological advancements in sports remain ethical?**

The Ancient Olympic Games could be considered the purest form of sport. Citizens from across Greece came together to compete barefoot and without a kit, pushing themselves to their physical limits for the glory of the competition rather than for a prize. Doping regulations have since come into effect over time to prevent an unfair human advantage, but with the trajectory of rapid advancements in technology, for example, tech suits in swimming or AI talent recruitment software in athletics, a level playing field needs to be maintained.

In competitive swimming, Speedo revolutionised the sport with its sharkskin-inspired Fastskin suits, designed to reduce drag and boost performance. These high-tech suits, made with advanced compression and hydrodynamic materials, helped athletes break numerous world records. However, concerns arose that the suits shifted focus from athletic ability to technological advantage, especially given their high cost. To preserve fairness and the spirit of the sport, World Aquatics banned certain versions, highlighting how innovation can sometimes outpace regulation and threaten a level playing field.

Artificial intelligence (AI) is poised to have a major impact on sport, much like the Fastskin swimsuit did. In particular, AI can assist the Olympic community across key areas such as 1) performance, training and injury prevention, 2) strategic data-driven games strategy, and 3) talent identification. However, to ensure that these advancements uphold fair play and advance the Olympic values of fairness and integrity, it is essential to establish strong controls, operational frameworks, and proactive education.

In order to prevent further disparity between nations and to avoid applying reactionary rules and regulations, we advocate for proactive regulatory sandboxes, offering the testing of rule changes in a controlled environment. We also advocate for an open-access model which makes the same performance data, digital products and advanced equipment available to all nations competing in the Olympic Games.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 5

### **Question 1: How could the IOC mentor potential host cities of Olympic events with the use of predictive AI?**

Submitting a bid to host the Olympic Games or any other Olympic event is not always a clear or attractive decision for many cities. Often, potential host cities lack complete awareness of their capabilities and the strategic advantages or long-term development potential associated with hosting such events. Uncertainty around political support, cost, infrastructure, or public perception can further discourage bids.

Predictive artificial intelligence (AI) refers to the use of advanced data models and machine learning to forecast future capabilities, opportunities, and risks. The International Olympic Committee (IOC) could apply it to assess strategic and political readiness (e.g., geographical and political stability over the past few years, financial consistency, public opinion, bureaucratic efficiency, and NOC-government relations), infrastructure and operational capacity (e.g., existing facilities—sport, medical and housing; transportation—accessibility and cost-efficiency), sustainability and legacy impact (e.g., environmental footprint, social development, and long-term urban benefit). The information that the IOC could get from AI would generate a shortlist of cities and or countries with either current readiness or long-term potential.

Every four years, a new assessment cycle would begin to identify the top three most capable candidates per event category—Olympic Games or Youth Olympic Games—forming an evolving 16-year hosting roadmap. The IOC would then contact these selected cities or countries to gauge willingness, align expectations, and tailor specific hosting plans to local needs (e.g., multi-city or even national approaches). Once the interest is confirmed, the 16-year plan

mentorship begins, supported by annual coordination, and if needed, with half-yearly updates, in addition to a comprehensive final reassessment at year 12. This structure allows enough time for development and correction in key areas while maintaining high readiness standards.

Therefore, the IOC should invest and use predictive AI as a mentoring and long-term strategic tool to identify, guide, and empower a more diverse pool of future hosts, ultimately ensuring that Olympic events are not only successfully delivered but also leave lasting, sustainable, inclusive, and impactful legacies.

### **Question 2: How can AI enhance athletic training while preserving the integrity of fair play and human effort in the Olympic Games?**

AI is changing the way athletes train. With the help of data and technology, it is now possible to track performance in real time, prevent injuries, and build personalised training plans that match each athlete's needs, helping athletes train smarter and stay healthier, assisting them to truly reach the Olympic motto of Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together.

The problem is that not all athletes have equal access. Many from developing countries lack the infrastructure or resources to use AI, while those from more developed countries train with advanced technology. This creates a gap not in talent, but in opportunity, and if we don't act, AI could make that gap even wider.

An idea could be to create regional AI hubs and centres where athletes, coaches, and multidisciplinary teams from developing countries can go to access the same tools and guidance as others. These hubs could be supported by the IOC and located across all continents so that all hubs are equally accessible.

The IOC set up an AI Working Group in 2023, formed by experts drawn from around the world, including AI pioneers, academics, athletes, and technology companies. A suggestion would be to continue with the AI Working Group, but to enhance its mandate to allow it to conduct educational activities, webinars and workshops focusing on sharing the knowledge from the AI Working Group with athletes, International Federations (IFs), National Olympic Committees (NOCs), Olympic partners, the International Paralympic Committee (IPC) and other organisations. With this, we can ensure equal access to the benefits of AI. The IOC can then lead the digital transformation of sports around the world.

Secondly, once education about AI in the Olympic Movement has reached critical mass, the IOC should create a permanent commission named the “Technology, Digital Transformation and AI Commission” to support the work of promoting AI in sports and solidifying the IOC’s position as a catalyst in AI as envisioned in the Olympic AI Agenda.

The Olympic Games are more than just medals; they are about effort, unity, fair play, and respect. Fair play means every athlete should have the same chance to succeed, no matter where they come from. AI can be a great resource for everyone in sport, but only if we use it in a way that aligns with Olympic values. If we make it fair, inclusive, and human-oriented, AI can help athletes around the world reach new levels without losing what makes sport so powerful in the first place.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 6

### **Question 1: What role can AI play in bridging the gap between rehabilitation and return to competition for injured athletes?**

Sports injuries lead up to 24% of athletes to retire early, highlighting how common and impactful they are in the world of sports. The rehabilitation process following injury can be complex and demanding, often requiring individualised programmes, ongoing monitoring, and consistent support. In this context, artificial intelligence (AI) presents a promising opportunity to transform how injuries are managed and treated.

AI can draw upon extensive databases of medical research and clinical data to design effective rehabilitation programmes. These personalised programmes can more accurately target specific injuries, taking into consideration not only the individual's unique condition but also patterns found in similar cases. Moreover, by incorporating the physical demands and recovery profiles of different sports, AI can help athletes return to peak performance and potentially extend their careers. Wearable technologies integrated with AI allow for the collection of real-time workload data. In addition to physical metrics, AI systems can incorporate psychological assessments, such as questionnaires, to monitor an athlete's mental well-being during recovery. This information is not only valuable for the athlete but also for the broader support team.

Injuries can also take a toll on an athlete's mental health. Concerns about incomplete recovery and loss of competitive form can create significant psychological stress. A structured, step-by-step AI rehabilitation programme can offer a sense of stability and direction during such uncertain times. Recreational athletes can also benefit from these technologies. Extending access to data-informed rehabilitation approaches empowers a wider population to recover

safely and efficiently. Nevertheless, AI is not without limitations. One of the main challenges lies in the subjective nature of injuries. Athletes may have difficulty articulating their symptoms in a way that an AI system can fully interpret. While AI can enhance the rehabilitation process, it cannot and should not replace human medical expertise. Doctors and healthcare professionals are essential for interpreting AI-generated insights and making final decisions about care. Additionally, the presence of medical professionals provides emotional support and psychological reassurance, something AI cannot replicate.

AI holds significant promise in transforming sports injury rehabilitation by offering data-driven and personalised solutions. It can enhance physical and mental recovery through structured programmes and real-time feedback, while also democratising access to quality rehabilitation for athletes at all levels. However, the integration of AI should complement and not replace the role of human healthcare providers. The most effective path forward is a hybrid approach, where AI supports clinical decision-making and doctors provide the critical human elements of care and motivation.

### **Question 2: How can the Olympic Movement make AI and sport technologies more accessible and relevant for under-resourced regions?**

The rapid growth of artificial intelligence (AI) is transforming sports—enhancing performance, governance, and fan engagement. However, its uneven adoption is widening global inequalities, especially in under-resourced regions like small island developing states and low-income countries. These gaps contradict the Olympic values of universality, fair play, and equal opportunity. In response, the IOC launched the Olympic AI Agenda on April 19 2024, to explore AI's potential while addressing its risks. But without inclusive, proactive strategies, the AI revolution could deepen existing disparities. The Olympic Movement must therefore lead in making AI and sport technologies accessible, relevant, and ethically grounded for all.

Several practical steps can help close this gap, considering the challenges and specific needs of under-resourced regions.

- Raising awareness and education: training coaches, athletes, and other stakeholders on AI's benefits through IOC-supported workshops and webinars via Athletes 365, Olympic Solidarity, or continental bodies.

Developing multilingual, mobile-friendly platforms and apps focused on sport data literacy and responsible AI use.

- Using a needs-based approach: The Olympic Movement should begin with independent assessments to understand local realities and identify gaps in access and knowledge. Based on this, it can build a roadmap to reduce inequalities and provide equal opportunities, including the distribution of appropriate technologies and digital tools adapted to regional contexts.
- Establishing equitable policies and legal frameworks: Countries should develop unbiased national standards for AI applications, including clear principles for AI use in training and competitions and strong data protection measures based on the recommendations of the IOC. The IOC should provide model policies and flexible guidelines that NOCs can adapt.
- Expanding partnerships to improve infrastructure: Collaboration with technology firms, universities, sports federations, NGOs, and private sector actors to bridge the access gap. Public-private partnerships with local organisations will ensure cultural relevance.

To ensure AI and sport technologies benefit all athletes regardless of geography or income, the Olympic Movement should act now. Through education, a needs-based approach, equitable partnerships, legal frameworks, and infrastructure investment, the IOC can lead a responsible and inclusive digital transformation. It will take time and coordinated effort, but the goal is clear: to make AI tools relevant and accessible for every region, in line with the Olympic values of equality, respect, and solidarity.



## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 7

### **Question 1: How can artificial intelligence be utilised to engage non-sport individuals with sports activities and communities?**

The Olympic Movement aims to unite the world through sport, but many people are not interested in sport. AI can be used in simple, engaging ways to attract non-sport people into the Olympic Movement.

AI can share Olympic highlights, athlete stories, and health tips on social media and official channels by analysing trends to post vibrant content that grabs attention across cities and villages. AI can inspire newcomers by crafting stories of athletes' triumphs, using data to highlight relatable struggles, and motivating those unfamiliar with sports. By applying privacy-safe facial recognition, AI can create custom fan experiences, like personalised videos, fostering emotional connections that make sports feel real.

AI can suggest Olympic content that clicks by studying people's interests, like music or tech. For cooking fans, for example, AI can link fitness to meal prep; for tech lovers, it can showcase data-driven training and can enhance their curiosity because it feels personal. AI can build habits by setting small goals, like short walks, using algorithms to adjust them, and sending timely reminders, effective since small steps keep people motivated.

AI can teach Olympic history and rules through tools like ChatGPT, creating interactive lessons to simplify niche sports like judo for beginners, especially where sports knowledge is limited, making learning easy. AI can promote inclusivity by recommending adaptive activities for people with disabilities or using VR for private workouts to empower women in strict settings. By powering social media with influencer challenges, AI can reach inactive audiences, spreading Olympic joy through trendy, inviting posts.

Therefore, by using AI for storytelling, personalisation, habit-building, education, and inclusivity, the Olympic Movement can attract non-sport people and align with their own goals. In this way, AI can connect and bring more people into sports, fostering healthier lives and global unity for all.

**Question 2: How can the Olympic Movement help bridge the gap between developed and developing nations in sport by using AI?**

The vast majority of nations participate in the Olympic Games, and this applies to both developed and developing nations. Yet, in the field of play, athletes display varying performance levels due to resource disparities. To ensure the Olympic Games promote equality and reduce imbalances, nations should share expertise and leverage AI-driven research to enhance athletes' performance, fostering a more equitable global stage.

It is recommended that developed nations conduct research and design programmes tailored to the specific needs and conditions of developing countries, resulting in improvements in their athletic performance. For instance, during the Paris Olympic Games 2024, the Chinese AI company SenseTime collaborated with China's national basketball team, using AI-driven sports data analysis to provide real-time feedback on athletes' movements and basketball trajectories. By constructing 3D models and employing motion capture algorithms, the platform offered immediate coaching insights, enhancing training efficiency and competitive performance. Certainly, training programmes from developed nations cannot be directly applied to athletes in developing nations due to differences in sports facilities and resources. However, customising programmes to suit their unique contexts by using AI platforms can improve the performance of athletes from developing nations.

The Olympic Solidarity programme supports National Olympic Committees (NOCs) in developing their structures through targeted initiatives, strengthening their role within the Olympic Movement and their national frameworks while increasing autonomy and independence. In developed countries, this programme provides access to advanced training facilities, enabling athletes, including refugees, to compete on an equal footing. Developing nations can adopt similar strategies to enhance their training infrastructure, ensuring fairer opportunities.

In conclusion, AI accelerates opportunities for developing countries to achieve equitable training conditions and compete internationally. This also benefits refugees needing specialised facilities. By fostering collaboration and tailored AI-driven solutions, these programmes unite nations, providing inclusive opportunities for all athletes to thrive in the Olympic Movement.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 8

### **Question 1: Can the Olympic spirit endure in an AI-driven world?**

In a constantly changing world, the Olympic Movement endures through emotion, human connection, and unforgettable moments—what remains timeless. Its purpose goes far beyond medals and records; it acts as both a technical and emotional force that shapes individuals and societies.

Through a technical lens, the Olympic Movement promotes values like inclusion, friendship, and excellence through effort, beginning at the grassroots level. By encouraging youth participation, sports could strengthen sporting culture and open opportunities for education and personal development. The values and principles that define the Olympic Movement must serve as core data guiding AI, enabling it to support and amplify the Olympic spirit. This foundation supports the growth of more inclusive, forward-thinking societies.

Emotionally, the Olympic Movement unites people and brings communities together. The Games create unforgettable moments—both deeply personal and widely shared—a powerful blend of triumph and emotion that often transcends words. In this collective experience, the Olympic spirit comes alive: a celebration of diversity, perseverance, and the many forms of human happiness.

The Olympic Movement thrives on the fusion of tradition and emotion, creating a lasting impact across generations. It is more than a celebration of athletic excellence—it serves as a catalyst for global unity and progress. By fostering inclusivity, empowering youth, and using tools like AI to promote the Olympic spirit, we can amplify its emotional impact—something only human connection can truly generate. While rooted in human values, AI can support its growth by expanding reach, enhancing storytelling, and deepening engagement.

Rather than replacing emotion, AI can help share it more effectively across cultures and generations.

The relationship between AI and the Olympic spirit is not contradictory—it is synergistic. With thoughtful integration, AI can communicate the meaning of the Games to new audiences, preserve historical moments, and personalise experiences for millions. It can support inclusive outreach, ensure ethical practices, and help protect athletes from online harm—all while respecting the human heart at the centre of sport.

In this way, the Olympic spirit and AI can work in harmony. Far from threatening its existence, AI can be a powerful tool to make the Olympic spirit bigger, stronger, and more accessible—ensuring it does not fade in a digital age, but thrives.

### **Question 2: How can the IOC improve good governance in AI usage while safeguarding athletes?**

Identifying the limits of AI usage in the Olympic Movement is essential to safeguarding athletes and ensuring ethical practices. Setting clear boundaries for when and how AI is used helps preserve the integrity of sport. It also allows for better protection of athletes from harmful content such as hateful messages on social media. To achieve these goals and guide responsible AI implementation, a dedicated oversight organisation should partner with the International Olympic Committee (IOC).

The core concept behind establishing a safeguarding mechanism for AI in sports and the Olympic Movement revolves around the creation of an independent external body, akin to WADA. This proposed organisation—potentially called the Artificial Intelligence Safeguarding Body (AISB)—would collaborate with international sports federations to develop a universal framework providing all the NOCs with information regarding AI development while creating a central Generative Pre-trained Transformer (GPT) adapted to the specific needs of each sport and creating rulings in the official rule books of each sport to properly govern the use of AI in sports. Just as WADA sets anti-doping standards, the AISB would define clear parameters and guidelines governing AI usage in sports—highlighting both acceptable and prohibited applications. It would promote global cooperation and transparency, allowing nations to support one

another in utilising AI responsibly within established boundaries while avoiding misuse. The scope could cover athlete protection against issues like cyberbullying, AI-assisted training, tailored technical and nutritional programmes. Crucially, all AI integration would be subject to human oversight, ensuring that decisions consider emotional and contextual nuances, and that human dignity remains central in AI development and deployment in sport, keeping humans at the centre of the loop of sports.

In conclusion, setting clear limits on AI in the Olympic Movement is vital to protect athletes and uphold ethical standards. The proposed AISB, modelled after WADA, would establish a universal framework for AI use in sports. By learning from WADA's past challenges, the AISB can take a proactive approach to emerging issues, given that we are still in the early stages of AI development. Working with ISF, the AISB would ensure innovation is balanced with athlete protection, with all AI tools subject to human oversight. This will help preserve the integrity of sport and create a safer, fairer environment for athletes worldwide.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 9

### **Question 1: How can AI support coaches in assisting the development and performance of athletes with psychological disabilities?**

According to Paralympic Sport, there has been an increase in the number of individuals with physical and psychological disabilities in recent decades. In response to these challenges, organisations such as the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the International Paralympic Committee (IPC) have initiated programmes to support the participation, development and performance of athletes with physical or psychological disabilities. However, limited attention has been given to how artificial intelligence (AI) could enhance these initiatives for athletes facing psychological challenges.

One proposal is to develop a chatbot that can detect mental health trends, offer initial support and provide basic strategies, based on input from psychologists and psychiatrists. Aimed at coaches, athletes, and parents, the chatbot would require a computer science expert to build it, and it could be hosted on the IOC's website. It would be particularly beneficial in regions with limited access to mental health professionals and for individuals who prefer to remain anonymous. Although it would not be a treatment tool, it could act as a resource for the first step, offering early guidance and helping to assess the need for further professional support.

Another idea involves the use of immersive AI technologies like virtual reality (VR) to create low-pressure, distraction-free training spaces. This is especially helpful for athletes with autism spectrum disorder (ASD), who may experience sensory overload in traditional settings. VR can boost confidence and support skill learning through visual tools like holograms or videos, especially when verbal coaching is overwhelming. For dyslexic athletes, text-to-speech features

would help them understand written workout instructions. Athletes with ADHD would benefit from focused environments that reduce distractions and improve learning.

AI can also serve as a personalised assistant for coaches by using data from wearable devices to tailor training based on each athlete's cognitive and emotional needs. It can track stress, fatigue, and sleep to adjust workloads. ADHD athletes, for instance, would benefit from AI-guided rest structures. This support isn't limited to athletes with wearables; AI can draw from large datasets to offer personalised recommendations based on similar profiles. This makes data-driven coaching more inclusive and accessible to this population.

In order to support the growth, development and performance of athletes with psychological disabilities, it is necessary to continue to explore and expand AI technologies that offer personalised, inclusive and scalable support, thereby shaping a more equitable future in sport.

### **Question 2: How can scouts use AI to improve and optimise their system to find talent?**

The integration of artificial intelligence (AI) into talent identification marks a significant transformation in the way human potential is understood. While human thinking generally follows linear heuristics based on fixed, observable facts, AI operates through nonlinear, complex models such as deep neural networks. These models can reveal patterns and potential in athletes that might otherwise be overlooked. This technological capability offers a significant opportunity to make talent scouting fairer, more efficient and more objective.

AI-based systems can compare athletes from different age groups, mitigating the well-known issue of relative age effects. For instance, children born in the first quarter of the year are more likely to be selected for youth teams due to the physical and emotional maturity these extra months tend to confer. This creates an advantage that can exclude younger, late-developing talents with long-term potential in their formative years, which in many cases can impact an athlete's entire career. Using AI in this context allows us to neutralise biases by focusing on the physical and cognitive attributes specific to the discipline, rather than on static demographic data.

In developing countries, AI offers great potential but also poses significant



practical challenges. Limitations in terms of the economy and infrastructure often restrict access to advanced technologies. However, scalable, low-cost solutions such as mobile tools and cloud analytics have the potential to democratise talent identification. For instance, athletes can be filmed on smartphones during local competitions, and the footage can be uploaded to cloud platforms where AI can evaluate their performance. This approach allows talent from remote or under-resourced areas to benefit from visibility, supporting meritocracy and decentralisation. Strategic partnerships with non-governmental organisations (NGOs) and sports federations can promote open access platforms for talent scouting at regional and national levels. Additionally, AI can recommend suitable sports for young athletes by combining their performance data with the requirements of different sports, thus facilitating more strategic development.

In conclusion, although AI cannot entirely replace human observation, it is a highly valuable complementary tool that must be explored and applied in an ethical manner. When used correctly, it can increase efficiency and fairness. As sports systems evolve, integrating AI into talent identification can help ensure that potential is recognised based not on social or socio-demographic circumstances, but on performance, growth, and true ability, in a meritocratic system. To use AI to its fullest potential, we must recognise its limitations. While it can measure performance and predict physical development, it cannot fully capture an athlete's work ethic, resilience or behaviour outside the training environment. The human intuition of the scout remains crucial for identifying psychological readiness, motivation and discipline—characteristics that are vital for long-term success, but which algorithms cannot detect.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 10

### **Question 1: How can AI assist referees in regulating fair play in sports?**

A few years ago, no one could imagine that AI would play such a crucial role in our everyday lives, and the world of sports is no exception. The adoption of technological innovations has become essential to ensure fairness and integrity. Thus, the usage of artificial intelligence is consolidating itself as a powerful ally to the fundamental value of fair play. With the addition of technology such as AI to sports, we can create more efficient ways of regulating fair play by assisting referees and judges to ensure critical incidents and biases are not overlooked.

Referees in all kinds of sports cannot see or hear everything to ensure fair play. But what if AI could monitor something like aggressive behaviour and language during games via audio and video analysis? For example, in soccer and basketball, incidents happen behind the back of the referees and are therefore ignored, which does not contribute to fair play. A possible AI tool to assist officials in regulating fair play during the game could be a system where the players are being tracked. The officials will receive a kind of alarm, which can track the aggressive behaviour and alert them. In that way, the officials can handle the situation most efficiently, without even seeing it.

Another way AI can be used to enhance fair play is by implementing a review system for referee calls during games. In this way, the technology can detect any biases a referee may have regarding certain calls, players or teams. If bias is detected, intervention can be made to ensure that fair play is maintained at all times.

AI has the potential to be a tool of regulation for fair play in sports by providing advanced monitoring and decision-making support. Through tools like real-time behaviour tracking and bias detection in referee calls, AI can help

ensure transparency and integrity in sports. By assisting judges and referees, AI not only minimises human mistakes but also promotes a healthier and more equitable sporting environment.

### **Question 2: What are the pros and cons of using AI for coaching?**

The use of artificial intelligence (AI) is significantly transforming the world as we know it. In sports, it has a notable impact on coaching, altering methods of training, performance analysis, and injury prevention. While the implementation of AI presents substantial opportunities, it also introduces various challenges.

Beginning with the advantages of using AI in coaching, it is widely acknowledged that AI offers a broad range of benefits that are reshaping the field of personal and professional development. One of the key advantages provided by AI is its accessibility at any time of the day. Unlike human coaches, who operate within defined working hours, AI systems are available whenever the athlete requires assistance. This constant availability enhances flexibility and convenience in comparison to human coaching.

Another significant benefit is AI's consistency and objectivity. Human coaches may differ in their feedback and can be influenced by personal biases, emotions, or subjective interpretations. In contrast, AI, when correctly designed and monitored, delivers standardised responses and eliminates emotional interference, thereby ensuring a consistent coaching experience for all users. This can promote a sense of fairness, particularly in professional contexts. Furthermore, it is important to note that AI supports data-driven personalisation. By analysing user inputs, behavioural patterns, performance metrics, and progress over time, AI can tailor its guidance to the unique needs and goals of each individual. It can identify trends that a human coach might overlook and provide real-time insights to support development. This analytical capability enables users to track measurable improvements and receive actionable, evidence-based feedback.

However, there are also disadvantages and challenges associated with the use of AI platforms in coaching, especially concerning interpersonal relationships. Primarily, excessive reliance on AI may undermine the relationship between coach and athlete. It is unable to interpret nuances, understand, or analyse an athlete's emotional state. Athletes may begin to place more trust in AI platforms

than in their human coaches. Similarly, coaches might over-rely on AI-generated instructions and fail to recognise the specific needs of their athletes. Additionally, AI systems are dependent on the data they receive, which may result in flawed recommendations that negatively impact athletic performance, a concept often summarised by the phrase “garbage in, garbage out”. Moreover, ethical and privacy concerns related to AI use in sports must be addressed. Governments and organisations must develop appropriate regulations to manage the growing presence of these platforms.

In conclusion, the use of AI in coaching presents both advantages and disadvantages. It offers continuous support, objective feedback, and personalised training solutions. It can also aid in injury prevention and performance enhancement. On the other hand, AI lacks emotional intelligence and raises significant privacy concerns. Ultimately, coaches should view AI as a tool to enhance their work rather than as a threat. While AI manages the technical aspects of coaching, human coaches can concentrate on building trust and understanding athletes’ emotional needs. When applied appropriately, AI has the potential to improve the overall quality of coaching for everyone involved.

## CYCLE B

### FRENCH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 1

#### **Question 1: To what extent will education for sustainable development among young athletes impact the international sporting landscape?**

Athlete education is a key issue in contemporary sport. First, the triple project (associative, educational, and sporting) gives them the opportunity for a career change or a smooth transition at the end of their career. The educational aspect also allows them to interact with populations outside the world of sport, and therefore to integrate socially and professionally within society. Thus, today, young athletes increasingly gain training and certifications alongside their careers.

From this viewpoint, sustainable development is the preferred development model for international organisations, including the IOC. It is taught and disseminated worldwide, but in an uneven manner: fairly early in schools in Western countries, through local or university projects in countries of the Global South. It is a concept that aims to meet the needs of present generations without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs. It is a balance between economic, social, and environmental aspects, seeking to improve living conditions while preserving resources for the future.

In this respect, the fight against global warming, which constitutes the United Nations Sustainable Development Goal Number 13, is particularly strategic. It is a major issue for humanity because it is existential. Education and awareness-raising in the face of the climate emergency are essential to preserve our planet and ensure a peaceful future between nations. Moreover, as was presented to us during this Session, it is important to remember that AI can be used to overcome

climate issues in specific frameworks, most notably during the organisation of major sporting competitions. Today, although the fight against global warming is not taught and perceived in the same way in all regions of the world, it is seriously taken into account by athletes of all nationalities and integrated into their lives.

Thus, educating young athletes about sustainable development can transform international sport in several ways. Athletes can promote the adoption of new competition organisation models that limit travel and carbon emissions while favouring innovation in the design of eco-responsible sports infrastructure. Their personal commitment can inspire their communities to take action, amplify local dynamics, and contribute to changing mentalities while encouraging the emergence of new, more responsible international standards.

### **Question 2: To what extent can the use of artificial intelligence promote Olympic education among young people?**

Launched by the IOC in October 2008, the Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) embodies the notion of Olympic education, aiming to transmit to young people the fundamental values of Olympism: respect, excellence and friendship, as well as inclusion, equality and intercultural dialogue. At a time when artificial intelligence is profoundly transforming learning methods, a question arises: to what extent can AI strengthen the dissemination of Olympic values among younger generations? To answer this question, we will analyse the potential educational benefits of AI and the risks linked to its uncontrolled use, and propose concrete solutions for developing ethical and adapted digital educational tools and adaptations.

As stated by lecturer Kourgouzova, “People who create educational tools must make them fun.” In this regard, AI is a new tool capable of adapting educational content to the needs, levels and main interests of each student. More broadly, it can support sport in transmitting the universal values it conveys by offering tools for analysis, exploration, interaction, and simulation. Thus, AI can strengthen the reach of Olympic messages and encourage their appropriation by young people in various contexts, including outside of schools or clubs.

However, the use of AI has limitations. If poorly supervised, it can reduce the scope for human interaction or discourage reflection and creativity. The opacity

of algorithms requires vigilance regarding potential response biases. Thus, it is essential that the exponential importance of AI in educational methods does not come at the expense of intellectual stimulation. Its integration into Olympic values awareness programmes must therefore promote the principles of justice, dialogue, and responsibility.

In order to strengthen the dissemination of Olympic values, multilingual AI platforms, such as an “Olympic GPT” assistant, could facilitate intercultural exchanges between young people. Interactive educational games could concretely illustrate concepts such as respect and inclusion. It would be essential to incorporate ethical moderation to avoid bias and ensure a safe environment. Finally, these tools should always complement the work of educators, supporting learning that is both fun and accessible.

Used well, artificial intelligence can therefore strengthen Olympic education by making its values more accessible and vivid for young people. However, it must remain a support, not a substitute, for human guidance.

From this perspective, the future challenge will consist of training NOCs and educators themselves in the informed use of these technologies, so that they can use them as levers of engagement and Olympic citizenship in a constantly evolving digital world.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 2

### **Question 1: What ethical dilemmas arise from AI decision-making in refereeing in the Olympic Games?**

As technology continues to reshape various aspects of society, the field of sport is no exception. Artificial intelligence (AI) has brought greater precision and efficiency to refereeing in the Olympic Games. While these innovations reduce human error and improve consistency, they also raise new ethical concerns. In this essay, we will examine some ethical dilemmas related to AI decision-making in Olympic refereeing and offer future recommendations.

AI systems are inherently dependent on the composition of the data on which they are trained. Such data originates from human decision-making processes that have historically been influenced by both implicit and explicit biases and discrimination. Therefore, the significant risk exists that AI will not only replicate but potentially amplify these biases. This is particularly concerning in judged sports such as figure skating or diving, where scoring criteria are shaped by social and cultural norms. AI used in refereeing may reflect and perpetuate cultural biases and forms of discrimination embedded in historical data. As a result, the Olympic values of fairness and non-discrimination could be compromised. During the Tokyo 2020 Summer Olympics, 3D body scan technology was used to measure movement in real time in gymnastics and track and field. This resulted in more objective assessments of technical elements. Such data is necessary to ensure fair and accurate judging with AI. However, it is often unclear how and what athletes are actually consenting to when their data is collected and how their data is stored, shared or reused. A 2021 survey by the World Players Association showed that many athletes were unaware of how training and health data was used by federations and third parties. In some



cases, data was shared with commercial partners without transparent informed consent from the athletes involved. In the Olympic Games, referees' decisions require contextual flexibility, a human trait that AI lacks. Ethical concerns arise when AI automates decisions based solely on metrics, ignoring empathy, cultural understanding and Olympic values like inclusion and resilience. AI may fail to account for symbolic gestures, such as the recognition of athletes from conflict-affected regions, resulting in rigid decisions that overlook the broader context of inclusion and resilience. Delegating such decisions to AI without human input risks undermining the Olympic spirit and its core values.

While AI offers promising advantages in sports refereeing, relying on it entirely comes with significant risks, including data inaccuracies and unresolved questions around responsibility and accountability. Without clear, standardised regulations governing AI use in sports, it cannot replace human referees. Still, AI can act as a helpful tool. A hybrid model, where AI supports rather than replaces human officials remains the most effective and ethically sound approach to ensure fair and responsible refereeing.

## **Question 2: What role does the AI have in helping the International Olympic Committee address climate change?**

In recent years, climate change has received significant attention due to its widespread and increasingly evident impacts on both global and national levels. This paper explores the multifaceted role that AI can play in supporting the International Olympic Committee (IOC), as the latter addresses the challenge of climate change while upholding Olympic values such as sustainability and global responsibility.

AI technologies can greatly assist the IOC to tackle the overwhelming task of dealing with a rapidly changing climate. AI technologies can aid in climate-conscious planning by analysing historical weather patterns and real-time forecasts to determine the best timing for events. Furthermore, AI can improve energy efficiency in event venues by optimising systems like lighting, cooling, and digital displays, benefiting both the organising committee and the spectator experience. Additionally, AI-powered weather forecasts and early warnings ensure safety. Green-certified hotels and smart energy tracking help cut waste,

and tools like personal carbon footprint tracking and AI-enhanced streaming make the experience more sustainable and engaging.

Furthermore, AI plays a key role in the planning and decision-making of sporting events, especially by improving weather forecasting. Accurate predictions help manage risks from increasingly extreme weather, which can disrupt open-air venues and energy supplies. Through the integration of AI, accurate simulations and environmental monitoring can assist the IOC organisers in anticipating disruptions and reducing the likelihood of event disruptions. Such data further assists the IOC's commitment in offering transparent and measurable progress indicators in their goal of upholding sustainability levels at events, ultimately safeguarding the success of the event. Collecting and analysing huge amounts of data, from carbon emissions to air and water quality, strengthens the IOC's climate action efforts.

Additionally, the IOC can utilise AI in modelling future environmental risks. For example, when the bidding countries begin to build new venues for upcoming IOC activities, AI can also be used as a model to predict and assist with long-term environmental risks. This includes the impact on the local ecosystems and increased carbon emissions resulting from infrastructure projects. This kind of insight helps the IOC and future host cities plan smarter. Furthermore, AI tools can also track public sentiment and media coverage, giving the IOC a clearer understanding of how communities perceive post-Games sustainability efforts. This helps hold host cities accountable, not just in official reports, but in the eyes of the public. AI provides the IOC the tools to measure real impact, not just good intentions. It helps ensure the Olympic Games leave behind a legacy of sustainability, not environmental damage.

To conclude, this paper emphasises the need for the IOC to continue recognising and implementing AI tools that can help address the opportunities and challenges that climate change presents.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 3

### **Question 1: Should the Paralympic and Olympic Games be one, and how can AI be used to assist?**

Under Article 1 of the Olympic Charter, the aim of the Olympic Movement is to bring together the athletes of the world in the great four-yearly sports festival. This essay discusses whether the Paralympic and Olympic Games should be one and, eventually, how AI can be used to assist the unification process. It should be noted that this essay focuses on the philosophical argument and does not address the logistical challenges.

On the face of it, the Olympic and Paralympic Movements share the common values of inclusion, sporting excellence, respect, and friendship. By separating the Games, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the International Paralympic Committee (IPC) are fundamentally deviating from their core values. We argue that combining the two Games will encourage the fulfilment of each Game's values, where all athletes compete at a four-yearly sports festival. The advantages of combining the Games would include providing para-athletes with a larger platform and audience, and increased status, media exposure, and sponsorship opportunities. These are aspects of sport that are largely only enjoyed by Olympic athletes. The significant difference in audience attendance for the Paris 2024 Games is a great example of that. The Olympic Games sold 9.5m tickets and the Paralympic Games only sold 2m tickets. The advances in predictive AI can be used by the IOC and IPC to display real-time statistics during the viewer experience. For example, AI can generate informative metrics about para-athletes in real-time, including total power output, peak force, and top velocity. These metrics can be compared against other common measures; for example the top speed of 80km/h for a track cyclist is comparable to a car's

speed on a highway. This will educate and engage a new audience that may not be familiar with certain Paralympic sports and the skills required to perform at the highest levels

The word Paralympic derives from the Greek word *para*, which means beside or alongside. This illustrates the significance from the outset of having both Games held separately. The Paralympic Games offer a unique sense of identity to people who have had to overcome physical impairments. We argue that combining the performance of the best athletes in the world would diminish the importance and achievements of the Paralympic athletes. For example, in London 2012, Usain Bolt set an Olympic record with a time of 9.63, whereas the para T44 category was won in 10.90, a time that would not even qualify an athlete for the Olympics. This significant time gap may undervalue the para-athletes' performances. Consequently, unification could potentially reverse the progress made by the IPC over several decades in enhancing the well-being and recognition of para-athletes' identities.

In conclusion, from a philosophical perspective, it is not clear whether the Paralympic and Olympic Games should be one. However, it is evident that if the Games are ever combined, AI could serve as an effective tool to improve the experience for the audience, athletes, and key stakeholders in both Games to enhance the future of the sport.

Question 2: How can athletes use artificial intelligence and brand partnerships to boost their media exposure and commercial opportunities?

In today's digital age, athletes are recognised not only for their athletic performance but also for their media presence and their ability to generate commercial value. In this context, artificial intelligence (AI) and strategic brand partnerships have become key tools for maximising visibility and monetisation opportunities for athletes.

Athletes can use AI and brand partnerships to enhance their media exposure and commercial opportunities by utilising data-driven insights for personalised content and targeted marketing, while also creating fan engagement through AI-powered platforms. Athletes can use AI to assist them in monitoring, producing, and enhancing their social media profiles by partnering with a chatbot—similar to ChatGPT—which can analyse their social media engagement and suggest ways to improve their profiles to boost their NIL. This chatbot would operate as a social media manager, allowing athletes to dedicate more time to their athletic training. This also allows athletes to draw attention to different brands,

as the tool would be able to communicate with the athlete, explaining exactly what these brands require. This includes using AI to optimise social media strategies, identify suitable brand partnerships, and deliver personalised content to fans—ultimately boosting their influence and commercial value. It is important to note that brand partnerships are not one-way relationships, but are mutually beneficial as they can support athletes economically and raise awareness of brands, leading to profit and positive brand images. Having access to affordable AI tools to manage social media and promote talent-building partnerships with regional brands can create mutual growth opportunities for all.

Furthermore, AI can not only ensure that athletes receive adequate exposure, but also that it is done safely. A relevant example is the abuse post flagging during the Paris Olympics 2024. AI has the ability to detect harmful posts and comments and to protect athletes. This is crucial, as an athlete's main focus should always be their sporting life, not their access to sponsorship or media influence. By filtering out harmful posts that could damage athletes' mental health, AI can help athletes stay focused on their sports careers while maintaining their commercial opportunities.

In conclusion, by integrating AI and strategic partnerships, athletes not only expand their media impact but also create a more professional and secure environment for their development on and off the field. In overcoming social and economic barriers using data-driven visibility and fan engagement strategies, AI has become a key tool for managing social media in the sports world, as an athlete's primary role is not a content creator. Having visibility on digital platforms not only strengthens an athlete's personal brand but also increases their chances of attracting sponsors. That's why leveraging AI to optimise posts, analyse audiences, and automate processes can help athletes achieve their main goal: securing more resources to advance their careers and reach their sporting objectives.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 4

### **Question 1: How do we improve the acquisition and retention of young athletes via performance pathways in youth sport?**

Performance pathways are the journey of an athlete from grassroots, to athlete development, to elite competitions. The systems in place to facilitate these journeys are particularly pivotal to young athletes' progress, but getting youth into sport is becoming harder, and in many parts of the world, keeping them in sport is also difficult. The approaches to improving athlete performance differ greatly from country to country due to resource disparity, but there is often the same negative outcome. It can be said that this is due to the over-professionalisation of youth sport, and equally, the under-utilisation of performance pathway strategies.

Recruitment problems vary by nation but are typically rooted in accessibility. In Sweden the cost of youth participating in sport has doubled in twenty years. Elsewhere, in Papua New Guinea, the prioritisation of traditionally popular sports and the absence of long-term planning has created a culture of stagnation and a barrier to entry for those interested in developing sports. So, the costly implementation of Sweden's performance strategy has impacted young athletes negatively due to the trickle-down cost of facilities and coaches. In Papua New Guinea, the lack of a holistic performance strategy discouraging reactionary practices has had a similar effect in stopping young people from realising their potential as athletes. This contrast suggests change is needed outside of funding.

Keeping those promising athletes has become a delicate balance, where attempts to create pipelines to elite sport have widened the gap between grassroots sport and elite development programmes. Ultimately, the gap exacerbates burnout, concern from parents, and the alienation of athletes from

their sport, all contributing to drop-off from established performance pathways. Grassroot athletes therefore find it harder to break through, and those in a performance pathway become easily disillusioned.

A standardised approach to performance pathways will better ensure the wellbeing and fulfilled potential of young athletes. An adaptable framework helping nations' responsible entities implement a cost-effective strategy could reduce the gap between grassroots and elite development programmes. In countries without the resources to operate a performance strategy, we advocate for an action plan which steadily expands participation opportunities, making sports more inclusive and the progression to elite sport smoother. In countries that currently operate effective performance pathways, costs need to be lower, awareness of grassroots clubs needs to be higher and elite development programmes need to be less exclusionary.

## **Question 2: Will it be sustainable to continue separating Summer and Winter Olympic Games in the future?**

As climate change continues to become a bigger issue and the global temperature increases on a yearly basis, there are concerns about the future of the Winter Olympic Games. The IOC has stated that by 2040, only 10 countries may have a "climate-reliable" outlook to host snow events at the Games.

Additionally, the International Ski and Snowboard Federation (FIS) reported that weather-related problems led to the cancellation of 26 out of its 616 World Cup events last season, affecting disciplines such as Alpine and cross-country skiing, snowboard park and pipe, freestyle skiing and ski jumping.

A solution taken by these governing bodies is to host their events with artificial snow. However, this is not a sustainable approach. This option requires large volumes of water and energy, often sourced from fossil fuels, leading to increased greenhouse gas emissions. Moreover, the artificial snow making process can alter the natural water cycle and affect snowmelt patterns, potentially impacting local ecosystems.

With this issue, there are many questions that arise. How many disciplines could continue in the future? How are the athletes in climate-risk countries going to train for their sports? Should these sports evolve to be hosted in indoor venues?

If, due to these problems, every sport starts to transition indoors, we should critically think about all Olympic sports and determine which ones make sense to be on the same biannual schedule for sustainability and efficiency purposes.

The potential solution of hosting the Winter Olympics in indoor venues could pave the way for integrating Winter and Summer Olympic Games into one combined event. For example, sports such as curling and ice skating, which are already hosted indoors, could be integrated easily. While incorporating other sports may present greater challenges, it is essential for Organising Committees to design venues that align with the IOC's emphasis on long-term legacy and sustainable use of facilities.

Valid concerns, therefore, exist about the feasibility of performing traditional winter sports such as biathlon, ski jumping, and cross-country skiing, which depend heavily on specific environmental conditions, in indoor venues. However, new innovations and modern technology, including virtual reality, could offer pathways to recreate snow events in alternative formats.

Despite the fact that we cannot guarantee the effectiveness of our approach, it currently appears to be one of the few viable ways to keep the Winter Olympics alive.



## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 5

### **Question 1: How can the IOC make volunteering at the Olympic Games more sustainable, inclusive and accessible?**

Volunteers have been the core and the heart of the Olympic Games since their creation. Without their dedication, energy, and goodwill, the successful delivery of the Games would be unimaginable. They willingly invest their time, travel at their own expense, and often work more than eight hours a day without pay purely for the joy of being part of the Olympic spirit, gaining experience, and meeting new people. However, in recent years, the skyrocketing costs of international travel, visa fees, and especially accommodation have made it increasingly difficult for many to participate, even those who were officially selected. This raises serious concerns about the long-term inclusivity and accessibility of Olympic volunteering.

Volunteering at the Games should not be a privilege only for those who can afford to spend a large amount of money. Currently, all committed applicants must cover their own costs, even while contributing unpaid labour. This imbalance not only limits diversity but also contradicts the Olympic values of equality and global unity. Although we must acknowledge the benefits volunteers already receive, such as, and not limited to, high-quality clothing, a unique experience, lasting friendships and connections, and potential future opportunities, these still cannot outweigh the financial burden many face.

In order to address the issue, we propose a tangible and sustainable long-term solution: the establishment of Volunteer Villages. These dedicated housing hubs, separate from athletes but integrated into the host region's infrastructure, would be located near key transit routes rather than competition venues. Whether the Games follow a single-city (e.g., Paris 2024) or multi-city model (e.g.,

Milano–Cortina 2026), these villages would provide centralised, affordable, or free housing options for volunteers.

As a short-term measure, the IOC could work with its trusted partner Airbnb to offer verified discounts of up to 20 percent for selected volunteers who provide official confirmation. While this may reduce immediate costs, it must not replace the long-term goal of establishing Volunteer Villages. Finally, the IOC and organisers should offer cultural programmes and informal events in the villages to ensure that volunteers feel valued and connected to the Olympic spirit.

In conclusion, we recommend that the IOC make volunteer accommodation a strategic priority. Volunteer Villages should become a standard part of all future Olympic Games. This should be supported by short-term housing solutions, clear safeguarding policies, and long-term legacy planning. These steps are essential to ensure that Olympic volunteering becomes truly sustainable, inclusive, and accessible to all.

### **Question 2: How does the increasing use of AI-driven performance feedback affect elite athletes' motivation and identity in high-performance sport?**

AI-driven performance feedback is changing the way elite athletes train, compete, and evaluate their progress. With real-time, personalised data, AI empowers athletes to track performance metrics with precision, fostering autonomy and innovation. However, as this technology becomes more embedded in athlete development, concerns arise about its potential to diminish vital human elements, such as empathy and connection. While AI is a powerful tool, it must not replace the essential human support systems in sport. By combining AI's analytical strengths with the emotional insight of coaches and support staff, we can enhance motivation, preserve athlete identity, and promote sustainable success both on and off the field.

AI gives athletes more control by providing immediate feedback, allowing them to make adjustments in the moment. This fosters autonomy and helps reinforce a stronger, more self-aware athlete identity. Real-time feedback helps athletes see their hard work pay off, which is empowering and engaging. AI can

also support athletes in becoming more aware of their identity and emotional state by tracking physical and mental patterns over time.

However, relying solely on technology risks limiting the creative problem-solving that makes sport dynamic. Athletes must continue to innovate and adapt, using AI as a guide rather than a rigid blueprint. Maintaining this balance encourages critical thinking and experimentation. Coaches and mentors play an essential role in fostering creativity, helping athletes interpret feedback in ways that align with their personal style and goals. By ensuring that technology complements rather than dictates training and performance, we keep athletes at the centre of decision-making. AI can be a catalyst for progress, while the human element keeps sport authentic, adaptive, and inspiring. The growing use of AI-driven feedback can also make performance feel impersonal and overly data-focused. When athletes are seen more as statistics than individuals, they may feel misunderstood or disconnected from their training, leading to reduced motivation and a weakened sense of self. To protect both motivation and identity, it is crucial to combine AI's precision with the empathy and insight of coaches.

In conclusion, while AI sharpens performance strategies, human connection remains essential to preserving motivation and identity. As technology advances, we must be intentional in how we use it, staying rooted in empathy, mentorship, and emotional support. Progress in sport is not just measured by numbers, but by the strength of the community that uplifts every athlete.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 6

### **Question 1: How can artificial intelligence support athletes in managing their finances and building long-term wealth?**

Many athletes focus on their careers without preparing for financial stability afterward. With the rise of artificial intelligence (AI), there is now a powerful tool that can help athletes manage their wealth, make smart investments, and build sustainable income streams. AI can serve as both a proactive and reactive financial guide, ensuring athletes secure their futures beyond the game.

AI-powered platforms can analyse market trends and social media engagement to help athletes optimise their personal branding and sponsorship deals. For example, machine learning algorithms can identify the most lucrative endorsement opportunities based on an athlete's performance, fan base, and industry trends. AI can also provide real-time insights into merchandising, licensing deals, and digital content monetisation, ensuring athletes maximise their earnings while still active. Existing programmes have been developed to address these gaps. However, many regions lack access to such structured support systems, and the programmes have limitations. Financial planning during an athletic career can help athletes navigate uncertain post-career situations. Many athletes face challenges in securing long-term financial stability. AI provides an efficient alternative to prepare athletes for life after a sports career. With the use of AI tools, we can provide business accelerators, mentoring and informational resources about dual careers, career transitions. AI will provide information on saving, investing, and tax management, adapted to their local context, to prepare athletes for long-term financial stability beyond their careers. AI can evaluate contracts, predict long-term benefits, and even suggest negotiation points as not all sponsorship deals are equal—some may offer quick cash

but harm an athlete's long-term brand value. Additionally, robo-advisors can create customised investment portfolios based on an athlete's risk tolerance and retirement goals, ensuring wealth grows steadily post-career.

AI is more than just a technological trend—it can be leveraged as a financial lifeline for athletes. By providing data-driven insights, personalised mentoring, and risk management, AI helps athletes transition from short-term earnings to lifetime financial security. Being one of the best athletes in terms of talent alone does not guarantee sustainable finances; AI can bridge the gap.

**Question 2: How should the IOC work with and use the AI for talent identification programme to foster inclusion?**

As the Olympic Movement begins to integrate artificial intelligence (AI) into athlete development, it is crucial to ensure this powerful technology fosters inclusion rather than reinforces exclusion. AI should be a tool that broadens access and opportunity, not one that narrows the path to success. By aligning AI use with the core Olympic values, especially respect and equality, the Movement can ensure technology serves all athletes—not just a privileged few.

The Olympic Movement must prioritise investment in all athletes, not just those labelled as “talented” at an early stage. Athlete development can be visualised as a pyramid: while only a few reach the top, that peak relies on the strength and breadth of its base. Supporting athletes across all levels and backgrounds strengthens the entire system and offers more individuals a genuine chance to progress. Moreover, success in sports depends on much more than natural talent. Qualities such as passion, discipline, and perseverance often make the difference between potential and achievement. Many athletes who don't initially stand out may still rise to excellence through consistent effort and determination. When using AI systems, we purely focus on physical or statistical indicators instead of recognising and supporting these human traits. Additionally, while AI can be useful in identifying physical attributes that align with specific sports, it should not limit an athlete's choices. A deep personal connection to a sport—regardless of one's physical profile—can drive motivation, resilience, and long-term success. AI should inform decisions, not make them, preserving the athlete's autonomy and passion.

Finally, excluding athletes based on early predictions of talent undermines the Olympic ideal of respect. Every athlete deserves a fair and open pathway to development, regardless of where they begin. By emphasising inclusion, AI can help create a more equitable and dynamic sporting future. The use of AI in the Olympic Movement presents great potential, but also significant responsibility towards the future of sports. AI can enhance athlete development, but if we want to secure the athletes of tomorrow, we need to broaden participation in a meaningful way by using principles of inclusion, fairness, and respect. Only when we let these values guide us forward, can the Olympic Movement ensure that the future of sport remains open to all.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 7

### **Question 1: What role can esports and AI play in schools and PE classes?**

Esports and AI hold great promise for transforming physical education by enhancing student engagement, motivation, and inclusivity through personalised, game-based learning and real-time feedback. Technologies like wearable devices, virtual reality, and exergames allow for tailored instruction and support diverse learning needs. However, these tools should not replace human educators, as overreliance may reduce physical activity and deepen access disparities due to high costs and infrastructure demands, particularly in under-resourced settings.

Esports and AI have the potential to revolutionise schools and PE classes by tapping into students' existing interests and learning styles. By integrating game-based activities and AI-powered feedback, educators can boost youth engagement and motivation, making physical education more appealing to digital natives. These technologies also promote inclusion, offering adaptive controls and interfaces that accommodate learners of all abilities, including students with disabilities, and deliver individualised training programmes that adjust in real time to each student's progress and needs. AI in physical education offers significant benefits such as real-time feedback, personalised training, injury prevention, and enhanced student engagement through tools like wearable devices, virtual reality, exergames, and data-driven performance analysis.

However, it's crucial to view AI and esports as supplements, not replacements, for human teachers, since the emotional support and personal connection teachers provide are irreplaceable. Overemphasis on virtual competition can inadvertently reduce traditional physical activity, undermining overall fitness goals. Additionally, the high costs and infrastructure demands of advanced

gaming hardware and AI platforms can create significant access barriers in under-resourced regions, risking a widening of educational and health gaps rather than their closure.

In conclusion, while esports and AI present innovative opportunities to enhance physical education by increasing engagement, personalisation, and inclusion, their implementation must be approached thoughtfully. These technologies should support, not replace, human interaction and traditional physical activity.

### **Question 2: What ethical issues arise from the use of AI in the selection of athletes within the context of Olympic games?**

The rise of AI is bringing a digital shift to the traditionally physical world of sports. AI tools are now widely used to analyse performance data, optimise training programmes, prevent injuries, and even assist in selecting athletes for major competitions, including the Olympic Games. While these tools enhance objectivity and efficiency, they also raise ethical questions, especially in global events like the Olympics that champion fairness, diversity, and the human spirit.

AI is a tool designed to support human decision-making, not to replace it. Yet, when AI is used in the athlete selection process, we must ask whether it truly captures the full potential of a human being. Algorithms can analyse speed, strength, and consistency, but they cannot see passion, resilience, or the untold stories behind an athlete's journey. Furthermore, AI systems depend on data, and if that data is biased or limited, such as underrepresenting certain countries, genders, or ethnicities, the selection process may unfairly exclude talented individuals. Accountability also becomes blurred: if an athlete is rejected due to AI recommendations, who will take responsibility?

In the age of AI, the Olympic Movement must adopt a proactive and ethical approach. First, access to AI tools should be equitable across all nations to avoid giving technologically advanced countries an unfair advantage. Second, transparency in how AI makes decisions must be guaranteed, allowing athletes to understand and, if necessary, challenge those decisions. Most importantly, AI should be used as a supporting tool, with final decisions always made by human experts who can evaluate the broader context. We must also ensure AI



development aligns with Olympic values, promoting inclusion and development rather than solely focusing on competition.

AI holds great promise for improving the fairness, efficiency, and precision of athlete development and selection. However, it must never replace the human values at the heart of the Olympic Games. The goal is not to reduce human excellence to an algorithm, but to amplify it with the help of technology. By ensuring transparency, accountability, and equal access, we can use AI ethically while keeping the Olympic spirit alive. In the end, AI should be a tool guided by human wisdom, not a substitute for it.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 8

### **Question 1: What measures can be undertaken in the Olympic Movement to ensure that collaboration with AI companies aligns with the sustainability guidelines created by the IOC?**

Artificial intelligence is becoming a central force across numerous industries including finance, healthcare, broadcasting, and now sport. Its growth is not only rapid but transformative, promising new possibilities for innovation and efficiency. However, this expansion also raises pressing questions—particularly about its environmental impact. As the Olympic Movement begins to explore AI integration, it must do so with a clear and responsible approach that aligns with the sustainability commitments of the International Olympic Committee (IOC).

One of the major concerns is the high energy consumption required to train and operate large AI models. These systems often rely on vast data centres that demand significant electricity, much of which is used for cooling servers. This leads to increased greenhouse gas emissions and contributes to global climate challenges. Additionally, water usage in these facilities—often necessary for cooling—remains largely unregulated and unreported, despite growing global water scarcity. There are currently no global standards for water accountability in AI, and many companies lack transparency in this area.

Despite efforts worldwide, there is still a lack of an international governing body to stay in control of creating certain environmental guidelines in accordance with the environmental regulations when it comes to the operations and usage of AI. This regulatory gap leaves room for environmentally harmful practices to go unchecked. The Olympic Movement, with its global influence and long-standing commitment to sustainability, has both the responsibility and the opportunity to lead by example.

To ensure that AI adoption aligns with environmental values, the IOC must work with partners who are committed to transparency in their energy and resource usage. Companies that cannot provide clear data on their environmental footprint—or choose not to—should not be considered suitable collaborators. Furthermore, the Olympic Movement should take the initiative in developing a tailored sustainability framework for AI in sport, building on its existing environmental strategies but adapting them to address the specific challenges of digital infrastructure.

Ultimately, the Olympic Movement has always stood for more than just sport—it represents integrity, progress, and global unity. As it embraces new technologies like AI, it must also ensure that innovation is pursued with the same principles. Leading with accountability and care, the IOC can help ensure that the future of AI is not only powerful, but also sustainable.

### **Question 2: How can AI help expand Olympic educational programmes to reach a larger population?**

Artificial intelligence (AI) holds immense potential for revolutionising Olympic education, making it more inclusive, personalised, and accessible to a broader audience worldwide. To ensure that Olympic values, such as excellence, friendship, and respect, reach every corner of society, AI must be harnessed with both innovation and cultural sensitivity. The following ideas can be implemented by the NOAs to target specific audiences:

One effective approach is to target coaches and PE teachers to customise educational content based on local realities, rather than relying on a one-size-fits-all national model. AI can analyse regional data—language, culture, interests—to create tailored programmes that resonate more deeply with communities, especially in areas where Olympic education has limited presence.

At the same time, AI can play an active role during the Games themselves. Athletes can benefit from intelligent platforms that offer real-time guidance on Olympic values, ethical conduct, and historical context. This allows them to not only perform better but also embody the spirit of the Olympics more fully.

Meanwhile, spectators should not be left behind. AI-powered chatbots (for example, creating a platform named “Olymentor” or “TorchAI”) can make watching the Olympics a more interactive and educational experience, offering

live insights, fun facts, and value-based learning, something which is especially valuable for young viewers or those new to the Olympic Movement.

A valuable reference point here is the Youth Olympic Games, where education is already integrated with competition. The upcoming Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games could serve as a first testing ground for AI-driven educational tools, allowing organisers to observe how young athletes and audiences interact with tailored content. AI can help scale and refine these programmes by analysing engagement data, measuring impact, and continuously improving how Olympic values are delivered to the next generation.

Finally, to stay relevant, Olympic education programmes must evolve. AI makes it possible to update core materials annually, ensuring they reflect current challenges, emerging technologies, and the evolving global context, while staying true to Olympic ideals. AI is not just a technological tool; it is a bridge to a smarter, more connected Olympic education system that inspires a global community through tailored, timely, and engaging content.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 9

### **Question 1: How can AI revolutionise sports venues in future Olympic Games?**

The future of the Olympic Games faces two major challenges: reducing their significant environmental impact and encouraging fans to return to stadiums, given that 64% now prefer to watch from home. In order to keep stadiums useful and eco-friendly, AI-powered upgrades are essential. AI has the potential to transform Olympic venues into efficient, engaging spaces that prioritise sustainability and appeal to modern audiences.

AI can support sustainability in many ways. One such way is through zero-waste systems. Our proposal is to use AI-powered cameras to automatically identify, sort and separate waste into the correct recycling or composting bins in real time. This would reduce contamination in recycling streams, a major cause of inefficiency in current waste management systems. The system could operate across all Olympic facilities, thereby encouraging sustainable behaviour among everyone present. Over time, the collected data could be used to refine waste management strategies and mitigate the environmental impact of large-scale events.

With streaming services offering increasingly personalised viewing experiences, many fans now prefer to watch from home. In order to attract crowds back to stadiums, they must offer unique physical experiences. Our solution uses AI to gather real-time data from cameras, wearable devices and sensors, and then delivers personalised content to spectators' phones or future AR/VR glasses. This includes live statistics, instant replay angles, historical facts and highlights tailored to users' favourite teams or players. The system can also suggest less crowded restrooms, food outlets or social activities to improve

comfort and crowd flow. In the future, AI could learn individual preferences in order to create highly personalised hybrid experiences that make attending live events more interactive and rewarding.

AI recommendation systems can also transform how audiences experience the Olympics. Like Spotify or Instagram suggestions, these systems analyse a spectator's current activity, such as enjoying a table tennis match, and instantly recommend nearby events they might like, such as a badminton game starting soon nearby. By considering timing, location, and preferences, AI not only boosts personal enjoyment but also encourages exploration of different sports. This helps balance crowds across venues, ensures smoother operations, and gives less popular sports more visibility, turning every visitor into an event explorer.

These approaches combine environmental care with enhanced experiences, making the Olympics more accessible, sustainable and enjoyable. Integrating sustainability and the fan experience using AI is not just a vision for the future, it is a necessary evolution for major global events such as the Olympics to remain relevant, responsible and inspiring.

## **Question 2: How can AI support children to be actively engaged in the Olympic values?**

Young people represent the future of sport and, in line with Pierre de Coubertin's vision of using sport to develop character and promote human virtue from an early age, it is important to explore how AI can encourage children to participate in the Olympic Movement. This could help shape the integration of the Olympic values of friendship, excellence and respect into future generations' education.

One initial way to encourage children to engage actively with Olympic values is through virtual mascots, which can promote positive behaviour by providing supportive feedback and recognising teamwork and effort. AI can also highlight inspiring Olympic moments, such as one athlete helping another, making the core values more tangible and meaningful. Furthermore, AI-powered translation and collaboration tools enable children from different countries to connect and share stories, fostering cross-cultural friendship and mutual respect.

Another interesting aspect to be considered is the creation of "Olympism Quest", which is going to be an AI-driven educational video game designed to teach Olympic values through engaging challenges and realistic situations.

Players explore virtual sports environments as they strive to become Olympic champions, making choices that embody the principles of excellence, friendship, and respect. With AI tailoring the learning experience, the game makes Olympic education more interactive and approachable for young audiences. It will be available on multiple platforms, including PlayStation and Nintendo.

Furthermore, “Friendship AR Hunt: Find the Values” is an engaging augmented reality adventure designed for children to enjoy in Olympic parks, schools and community spaces. Using a smartphone or tablet, children embark on a “Friendship Quest” to uncover hidden tokens representing the Olympic values. Guided by AI, each discovery reveals short stories, reflective prompts or activities that encourage kindness, cooperation and support for others. As they complete these challenges, especially when working with friends, they earn unique AR badges or unlock heartwarming videos of real Olympic friendships, bringing the Olympic values of friendship, respect, and excellence to life through fun, meaningful interaction.

The use of this AI has come to change the way we see and share the world. These AI-powered ideas have the potential to change the way we share Olympic values, from something taught in classrooms or seen on TV, to something that is lived, felt, and experienced by everyone. Whether a child is in a stadium or watching from home, AI can make sure they are part of the journey, learning to be excellent, to respect others, and to build real friendships across borders. It’s a chance to make the Olympic spirit truly universal.

## ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 10

### **Question 1: How can we use AI to improve the integration of the Olympic values among youth?**

When asked about the Olympic Games, a young child might simply associate them with winning a gold medal and personal achievement. However, the true essence of the Olympic Games lies in three fundamental values: excellence, striving to be the best they can be; respect, for others, for rules, and for the environment; and friendship, fostering connections across cultures. These values extend beyond athletic competition, promoting personal development, mutual understanding, and peaceful coexistence. In the context of today's rapidly evolving technological landscape, AI offers a powerful opportunity to engage younger generations. As a transformative tool in education and personal growth, AI holds significant potential to strengthen young people's connection to the core values and ideals of the Olympic Movement.

The Olympic motto, "Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together", talks about the will to be a better person every time physically, cognitively, socially and mentally. With technological advances, AI can help promote the values among youth by using tools like ethical dilemma simulations and behaviour monitoring, and the IOC AI Agenda supports a culture of respect in both sports and digital spaces. For example, a values-based computer game could present a young athlete with the choice of either cheating to win or losing fairly, and provide feedback on the consequences using AI. The game could feature a case study from the Olympic Games, with AI-powered storytelling from Olympic role models to encourage young people to embrace Olympic values.

Additionally, programmes such as the Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) can use AI tools to create global platforms where young people can



connect through stories, games, and cultural exchanges, fostering friendship through shared experiences. Real-time translation tools remove language barriers, enabling respectful communication and a deeper understanding of different cultures. AI can also be used to translate educational materials promoting Olympic values and making them more accessible. By providing greater access, fostering connections and boosting motivation, AI can help to make the values of respect, excellence and friendship more real and relevant to young people around the world.

Applications and tools of artificial intelligence that embody the Olympic values of excellence, respect and friendship could be powerful catalysts in promoting these ideals to a wider audience. By enhancing accessibility and comprehension, AI can play a significant role in bringing the Olympic spirit to life, particularly for young people across the globe. In an era marked by rapid technological advancement, it is essential to embrace innovative AI technologies as a means of engaging youth and fostering a deeper connection to the values and ethos of the Olympic Movement.

### **Question 2: How can the IOC implement the UN Sustainable Development Goals more efficiently with AI?**

The United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), adopted in 2015, comprise 17 interconnected global goals aimed at creating a more just and sustainable world by 2030. These goals address a wide range of global challenges and priorities, such as poverty and hunger, to ensure gender equality, climate action, and fostering peace. The IOC are a recognised partner of the UN in promoting the SDGs. Initiatives like Olympism 365 demonstrate the IOC's enduring dedication to sustainable development; thus, there is still room to deepen and expand its engagement. AI introduces new opportunities to amplify and accelerate the impact of these efforts. In the following essay, three SDGs have been selected to explore how AI can support the implementation.

The first SDG is Number 3: Good Health and Well-Being. AI can be used to evaluate health data and create focused public health initiatives that encourage exercise and healthy living. It is possible to develop AI-based personalised health assistants to provide the public with scientific exercise prescriptions and nutritional advice. Computer vision technology can be used to break down

sports movements and disseminate sports health knowledge to the public in the form of popular science videos, covering everything from professional sports to public health, and promoting the popularisation of health concepts. The IOC could, for example, promote the use of AI-powered wearables such as WHOOP bands to monitor athletes' sleep, stress levels, and recovery time. This would help to prevent injuries and improve their overall well-being.

The second chosen SDG is Number 4: Quality education. Education is considered essential for nurturing leadership skills. The goal of quality education is to provide every child with the opportunity to flourish. It is inclusive, ensuring that everyone has the opportunity and resources they need to learn effectively with qualified teachers in safe environments. This is important for promoting sustainable development, an area in which AI can help. With AI, the IOC can make learning more accessible, personalised, and efficient for those who do not have access to proper education. This could be achieved through a free Olympic app or platform that disseminates knowledge on a global scale.

The third SDG is Number 11: Sustainable cities and communities. Digital inclusion is a common factor shared by all cities, even if each one has its own particular needs. AI can provide everyone with access to digital infrastructure, regardless of age. Residents should be involved in designing AI-powered services so that solutions actually address their real needs. To ensure the city's sustainability, its layout can be captured and the most optimal locations for parks and urban forests can be identified. This way with the use of AI, CO2 emissions are reduced and a green based city can be achieved.

In conclusion, AI offers useful tools to enhance the Olympic Games' support of UN SDGs in promoting health, education, and sustainable communities, while making global development efforts more inclusive and effective.







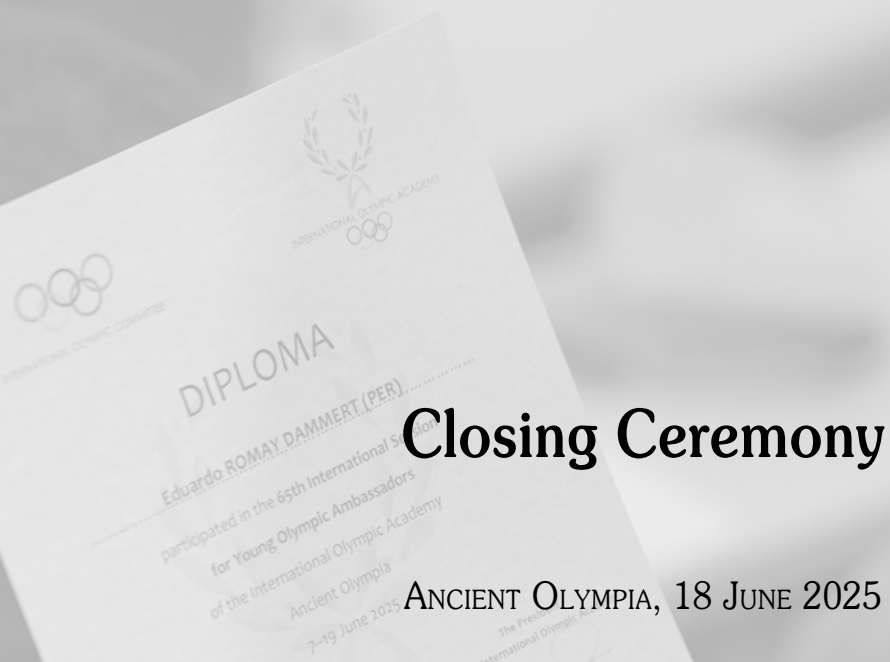
*At the end of each cycle of lectures, representatives of the working groups presented the conclusions of their discussions.*





*First place in the ISOH 2025 Olympic Poster Competition – YOA 2025 was awarded to the Romanian Olympic and Sports Committee.*





# Closing Ceremony

ANCIENT OLYMPIA, 18 JUNE 2025







**ADDRESS**  
**on behalf of the French-Speaking Young Olympic Ambassadors**  
**by Alexa PEPPER (CAN)**  
**and Guerline GUERRIER (HAI)**

Dear President Tsolakis,  
Dear Professors, Georgiadis and Gangas,  
Dear Lecturers, Staff Members of the IOA, Coordinators,  
Dear Ambassadors, Dear Olympic Family, Dear Friends coming from the four corners of the world,

Greetings to you all—what an unbelievable privilege to have the floor in the name of the French-speaking participants for the closure of the unforgettable 65th Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors.

As we gathered in Athens—the cradle of democracy—and then here in Olympia at the heart of the Olympic legacy, we were reminded not only of the origins of the Olympic values, but also of all that they can inspire in us for the future.

Through the course of the past 10 days, we have been reflecting deeply on the future of sport—and, in particular, on the role artificial intelligence could play in it. But beyond technology, we have been reflecting more on our own role: as young leaders, bridge builders, and Ambassadors of Olympism in a world that, today, often seems uncertain, divided, and in search of hope.

As Canadians, we are taught early on the power of respect, inclusion, and listening to many voices. Here, among 106 delegations, I felt that same spirit come to life—but this is also a powerful reminder that there is always more work to be done, together. Despite our different backgrounds, languages, and lived experiences, we found common ground. On the playing field, in the lecture halls, over shared meals, and under the strawberry moon, we became a community of friends—and created relationships that will last a lifetime.

We live in an era marked by political tensions, technological upheaval,

and climatic emergency. Yet here, we have chosen connection over division. Curiosity over fear. Action over indifference. And this gives me hope.

The vision of Coubertin was never just about sport—it was also about peace, education, and progress through human excellence. And today, that vision is more relevant than ever.

We now bear a responsibility: to bring the Olympic values to life in our





*Awarding of the participation diplomas by the IOA President, Prof. Charilaos Tsolakis, and the IOA Dean, Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis.*

communities—and to meet today’s challenges with courage and creativity. Whether it’s ensuring the ethical use of artificial intelligence in sport, making access to the Games more equitable, or using the power of sport to build bridges in conflict-affected areas, there is work to be done.

Together, we are the Coubertins of tomorrow. This does not mean just dreaming but also acting. Not just gathering for 10 days in Olympia but committing ourselves to decades of service to our societies.

I leave this session deeply transformed—and deeply inspired. And I know many of you feel the same way. From the upcoming 2026 FIFA World Cup in the Americas to the 2026 Youth Olympic Games in Dakar and the Milano Cortina Games, or even just for a quick game of pick-up soccer—we will see each other again.

So, let us advance with intention, as ambassadors of hope, humanity, and Olympism—and let us ensure that we leave behind more than medals: let us leave traces of inclusion, resilience, and joy.

Like they say in Haiti “*N ap re wè anko*”—We’ll see each other again.

Thank you.

**ADDRESS**  
**on behalf of the English-Speaking Young Olympic Ambassadors**  
**by Brandon SOUSA (BER)**  
**and Beier (Bell) ZHANG (Tsinghua University, China)**

Dear President Tsolakis,  
Dear Professor Georgiadis,  
Dear Lecturers, IOA Staff, Coordinators,

And my dear fellow Ambassadors, my friends from around the world. It is truly an honour to speak on behalf of the English-speaking participants as we close this unforgettable 65th Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors here at the beautiful International Olympic Academy in Ancient Olympia.

As we prepare to depart from Olympia, a place embodying timeless ideals, we are reminded of the Olympic spirit's profound origins and the boundless horizons it opens for us.

Over these 10 transformative days, our reflections have gone beyond the future of sport with the role of artificial intelligence. We have delved deeply into our collective role: as young leaders, cultural bridge-builders, and torchbearers of Olympism in a world yearning for unity and creativeness.

Beyond the lectures and sporting activities, we have experienced a bond through culture and connection, which are pillars that support Olympic values. This connection reminds us that the pursuit of human excellence is not limited to physical prowess but flourishes through artistic expression, shared heritage, and the innovative spirit that binds our diverse cultures. It is this vibrant interplay of ideas, traditions, and imaginative thought that truly forms the basis of Olympism, fostering understanding and peace across borders.

This 65th Session holds particular significance because it is the first time that Bermuda has sent representatives to participate in this prestigious experience. As a small island nation of just 65,000 people, the impact of Syria's and my experiences here resonate deeply. We truly thank you all for that. This experience

has not only inspired us but has also challenged us to teach Olympism to our future Ambassadors and all of Bermuda.

Ambassadors, I challenge each of you to take a moment to reflect, not just on the lectures attended or stories shared, but on what Olympism truly means to you now? How can Olympism shape your future actions as you live your day-to-day lives? Let these reflections fuel you to be torchbearers bringing back to each of your nations the spirit of Olympism, as we are the future of international sports.

All of us here, as Ambassadors of Olympism, will share not just stories of friendship, but tales of collaboration, the beauty of shared cultures, and the profound respect fostered among nations. Our lasting memories, photos and, of course, our evenings that some of us can't recall will forever be a part of our journey here at Olympia.

Despite our varied backgrounds, different languages, and unique lived experiences, we have forged an unbreakable bond. Over shared meals, in the 3x80 meter relays, and amidst moments of reflection, we have become a family, cultivating relationships that will remain with us for a lifetime as brothers and sisters. This shared journey has been a powerful testament to our ability to find common ground and build bridges, even when facing the unexpected.

Now Bell wishes to say a few words.

My story is a little bit different. Standing here today feels unreal. Because the truth is, I wasn't supposed to be here.

When I applied for the programme, I faced an impossible hurdle: I needed an official nomination from my NOC but I didn't work for them nor did I even know anyone there. I was just a student, representing nothing but my own Olympic dream.

So, I emailed the IOA, asking if I could represent my university. Luckily, they rejected me very quickly: No. The IOA doesn't accept any nomination from any institutions or individuals.

Family and friends comforted me "Bell, accept reality. You've done all you can." But I said "No, I will never surrender, I will never give up!" Therefore, I wrote long emails to the IOA again, telling them my Olympic story.

As a child, the first English sports term I ever learned wasn't "football" or "basketball" – it was "Olympic". I feel everything is meant to be. Beijing 2008 planted the Olympic seed in my heart I told myself, one day, I will be part of this.

That dream led me to Lausanne twice. The first time was at 17 where, standing in the Olympic Museum, I decided to devote my studies to sports. I

earned a Bachelor's in Sports Economics and a Master's in Sports Management, and now I'm pursuing a PhD in Sports Sociology. The second time was after I gave up the scholarship from Peking University, which is a QS20, just for the opportunity to work for Beijing 2022 Winter Games. But I knew every sacrifice was worth it.

Before Beijing 2022, Xinhua News, an authentic media like the Chinese BBC, made a documentary on me about my Olympic story, and I also accepted interviews from many other authentic media. At the same time, I'm also an influencer, my content about Beijing 2022 has more than a million views and more than 50,000 likes.

Days passed, then the miracle came; the IOA made an exception for me. I made it! Thank you, Professor Georgiadis, thank you Stella, thank you, IOA. Thank you for taking a chance on me based solely on the power of an individual Olympic dream. You made me finally understand: Olympism isn't about representing flags or institutions. It's about the flame we carry within—that stubborn spark that lights our path, burns away the barriers and melts the ice between people, between nations, between what is and what could be.

The vision of Olympism is more than just about sport; it is a grand aspiration for peace, education, and human progress. Today, we transition into a new chapter in which perseverance matters now more than ever. It is a torch guiding us towards a harmonious and understanding world, faster, higher, and stronger – TOGETHER.

THANK YOU

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**ADDRESS**  
**on behalf of the French-Speaking Coordinators**  
**by Iasson LAGOS (GRE)**

Dear President of the International Olympic Academy, Dr Charilaos Tsolakis,  
Dear Dean Konstantinos Georgiadis,  
Dear members of the IOA,  
Dear Coordinators and Young Ambassadors,  
Dear Friends,

June 7 was an unforgettable day for all of you. The day of the beginning of the 65th Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors.

This is where I could have spoken to you today about our adventure in Athens, our visit to Delphi, or our time here at the Academy. About the sports activities, the classes, the social evenings, or the artistic pursuits. But I'm taking advantage of this brief moment of attention to speak to you from the bottom of my heart.

Each and every one of you today holds a unique place in my heart and in that of the IOA. You are now members of an eternal family, which, despite the conflicts and divisions in the world, chooses each year to come together and open its arms, to engage in dialogue, share, and discover other cultures. To learn from each other and open up to the world.

What we experienced here is beyond words. It was the knowing glances, the endless discussions on the marble stairs, and sometimes, like today, even the discreet tears that forged eternal and indelible bonds between us. We all came from different countries, with histories and cultures that are very distinct among themselves, but we found a common language. That of respect, friendship, and excellence, the beating heart of Olympism.

It is here, dear Ambassadors, where the journey begins. Not a simple journey towards your respective countries, but a journey with a mission. That

of continuing to dream, to act with courage, to transmit, to educate, to be an example for the others and also to fight for peace.

This is here that I want to thank everyone who each year makes this experience not only possible but also special. No words can describe the sadness this separation brings. But despite this pain, I say “see you soon” somewhere in the world or “see you soon” at home, in Olympia.



**ADDRESS**  
**on behalf of the English-Speaking Coordinators**  
**by Rafael MENDOZA (MEX)**

Dear Olympic Friends,

After many days and nights of exchanging ideas, playing sports, dancing, singing, and writing poetry, our days in Olympia have come to an end, and it is with great honour that I address you on behalf of the coordinators.

Before coming to Greece, I believe most of you didn't know exactly what to expect from this Session, or what it was all about. Perhaps some of you had a vague idea of its objectives, but most of you were simply told by your National Olympic Committees or Academies to go to Olympia, represent your country, and bring back some ideas about the use of AI in sports. On your way here, you might have also wondered about your future roommates: What if I don't like them? What if they don't like me? During the group discussions, you might have hesitated to share your thoughts: What if I can't fully express what I think? What if I'm unable to articulate my ideas? What if people judge my English? And you might have asked yourself: Why are these coordinators pushing us to play sports, write poetry, dance, and share our cultures in front of everyone?

For Plato, the famous ancient Greek philosopher, education was not limited to theoretical training—it also had to include sports and the arts. For him, the goal of these practices was to harmonise the soul and create better citizens. I believe this idea is rooted in the fact that both sports and the arts dramatise the basic human condition. In sports, we experience the joy of winning, the pleasure of making a beautiful move on the pitch, or the satisfaction of having given it our all in competition. We also smile, laugh, or cry out of happiness. Yet we also experience the sadness of losing, the frustration of not fulfilling our athletic dreams, the fear of stepping onto the field, or the disappointment with ourselves for not playing as we had hoped.

In the arts, we encounter similar intensities: when we dance, write, or sing, we

expose our inner world—we connect with something beyond ourselves, and we risk our vulnerability in doing so. In a sense, to immerse ourselves in sports and arts is to immerse ourselves in a full human experience because different emotions, feelings, and sentiments that characterise human existence arise and manifest themselves.

The power of the International Olympic Academy lies not only in the fact that we engage in these activities, but that we do so in an intercultural environment. Yesterday at the track & field meet, I saw people from all continents engage in sport with intensity and joy, striving to do their best while celebrating one another's efforts. I've seen people of different backgrounds, religions, and ethnicities dance and sing together. I've seen many of you write poetry—something you didn't know you could do. That is, in these two weeks, I think, we have immersed ourselves in a full human experience.

And I believe this is what Olympism is all about, and you have experienced it. The IOA is not only a place to embrace and celebrate our differences, but, first and foremost, to recognise our common humanity. An ancient Greek poet once said that we are born human but only become fully human when we deepen our relationships with other humans. If this is true, then Olympia remains a place where we reach the essential, where we touch a spark of humanity. In this hectic world, marked by conflict and division, Olympia remains a place for joy and togetherness—a place where we get rid of our prejudices and our most ingrained beliefs about sport, knowledge, and the world.

This unforgettable experience would not have been possible without the hard work of many people. On behalf of the coordinators, I would like to begin by expressing our sincere gratitude to Professor Charilaos Tsolakis, President of the International Olympic Academy, and to Dean Professor Kostas Georgiadis, whose leadership makes this Session possible. To the IOA staff—especially Stella and Antonia, whose commitment and care made this Session so meaningful. We also thank Christos, Vaggelis, and Tolis for their invaluable support, as well as the Red Cross team and the translators who have accompanied us over the past two weeks.

Of course, I cannot leave out the coordinators, who gave it all to make your experience the best it could be. And finally, to our Head Coordinator, Fred Quek, for being the best leader and guiding the Session successfully.

Dear Ambassadors, I am pretty sure you have added a shining diamond to the treasure box of the precious moments of your lives. I hope you all have filled your hearts with joy and peace. Never forget your time here in Olympia and keep this spirit alive.

Safe travels—until we meet again.

**ADDRESS**  
**on behalf of the Lecturers**  
**by Prof. Emilio FERNÁNDEZ PEÑA (ESP)**

Dear President, Dear Dean,  
Dear Youth Olympic Ambassadors,

The experience at the International Olympic Academy is an integral experience: lectures, discussion groups, workshops, cultural activities, sports practice, social evenings, the restaurant, the café, and Zorbas. It's an experience that appeals to the human, to a holistic and complex vision of our condition as people. Each one of you is unique and unrepeatable.

These days we've been debating artificial intelligence, which should be conceived as a support for humans, making our lives easier. Artificial intelligence must be diverse; there must be many options to choose from. Consequently, freedom of access to knowledge is rich and varied, and we can freely select the appropriate tools. Artificial intelligence is not neutral; it responds to the way of thinking of its creators. In other words, it doesn't offer us an impartial view of reality; rather, its results are guided by its owners' way of seeing the world.

However, it must be at the service of people. What matters when using artificial intelligence is you, your prior knowledge, your imagination, and your creativity. Remember, you are unique and unrepeatable, and artificial intelligence is not intelligent; it cannot think for itself and responds to the wishes of its programmers.

Artificial intelligence answers the questions we can ask. The smarter the question, the better the result. The athlete, the sports manager must be at the centre of everything. In this way, artificial intelligence will be at our service, helping us in a balanced way.

Have an analytical and critical view of AI. Don't be blinded by the seemingly magical results it offers. If we think this technology produces magic, we will lose the critical attitude we need.

Consider that here you have begun the path of a comprehensive education: Olympic values, knowledge, and sport, which you must continue to develop throughout your lives to become freer every day. Begin your work as Olympic Ambassadors in the real world and online. Live with enthusiasm, love, and respect for others.

**CLOSING ADDRESS**  
**of the Session Proceedings**  
**by the President of the International Olympic Academy**  
**Prof. Charilaos TSOLAKIS**

Dear Young Olympic Ambassadors,

As we bring this 65th Session of Young Olympic Ambassadors to a close, I wish to express to all of you my deepest congratulations and heartfelt gratitude to every one of you for your inspiring participation here in Olympia. This place represents the enduring ideals of peace, fair play, friendship, and excellence – the core values of Olympism.

Located in a privileged place, next to the archaeological site where the ancient Olympic Games were held, the IOA gave you the opportunity, within a serene environment, to reflect on its historical past and experience its modern reality.

Aiming at the study and promotion of Olympism, the IOA chose this year to engage with the future and explore with the valuable contribution of respected lecturers the subject “The Olympic Movement and Artificial Intelligence”. For 10 days, you questioned and exchanged views, ideas, thoughts, and concerns about the opportunities and challenges the Olympic Movement is facing with the advent of artificial intelligence in human reality. From the navigation of human-AI interactions to the use of AI in the Olympic Games, Olympic education and sports and the challenges posed by the new technologies, the expertise and enthusiasm of our lecturers helped you gain not only the experience but also the inspiration to carry forward the Olympic spirit to your respective communities.

Artificial intelligence impacts the future of the sporting phenomenon in a multiplicity of ways. Consequently, the effects it has are crucial for the form, evolution, and resilience of sport itself. The study of these effects raises dilemmas, mainly of an ethical nature, which require our careful consideration. But you, dear ambassadors, guided by the personal experiences, memories,

and relationships you have built over the past few days, remind us all that while artificial intelligence shapes the future, it is our shared commitment to ethics, solidarity, and respect that must continue to light the way forward for sport and humanity.

During these days, you have miraculously forgotten everything that divides you, showing respect for the beliefs of your seatmate! You have tried to achieve excellence with your behaviour! And you became friends for life! You have become real Olympic Ambassadors of Olympism and its values...

On behalf of the International Olympic Academy, we wholeheartedly thank you for this.

We must also thank the world-renowned professors and Olympic experts who transmitted their experience to all of us, captivating our imagination and enriching our knowledge.

We must not forget, of course, to sincerely thank our great coordinators. Their exceptional work, meticulous preparation, and tireless dedication have been instrumental in ensuring the success of this Session. Every detail reflected their deep commitment to the IOA, and we are truly grateful for this.

We are grateful to the entire administration team, collaborators, and interpreters who worked behind the scenes to create an environment where learning, dialogue, and friendship could flourish.

Dear Friends,

As you return home, I encourage you to carry with you the spirit of Olympia, the friendships you have formed, and the responsibility to serve as Ambassadors of the Olympic values in a rapidly changing world. I urge you to become carriers of the Olympic ideals and to remember that the International Olympic Academy is the home where you will always be welcome, as you have now become an integral part of its global family.

Have a safe journey back home.

Thank you.

## ACTIVITIES AT THE IOA PREMISES, ANCIENT OLYMPIA – 2025

| Event/Organiser                                                                                                               | Dates    | No of Participants |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------|
| Awarding to Champions of 2024 – Patris Sport                                                                                  | 15/2     |                    |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 1                                                               | 24-26/2  | 104                |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 2                                                               | 27/2-1/3 | 79                 |
| Ioannina Model High School of Zosimaia School                                                                                 | 4-6/3    | 78                 |
| Athens College Elementary School                                                                                              | 6-7/3    | 192                |
| 36th Primary School of Piraeus                                                                                                | 8-9/3    | 49                 |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 3                                                               | 10-12/3  | 109                |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 4                                                               | 13-15/3  | 110                |
| 1st Joint Meeting of the National Platform for Sports Integrity (EPATHLA) and the Sports Integrity Committee of Cyprus (EDPA) | 10-12/3  | 13                 |
| Opening Ceremony of the 144th IOC Session                                                                                     | 13-19/3  |                    |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 5                                                               | 26-28/3  | 119                |
| High School of Giannouli                                                                                                      | 28/3     | 78                 |
| CGS                                                                                                                           | 28-30/3  | 73                 |
| “Iniochos” Race                                                                                                               | 29/3     | 450                |
| Educational Games                                                                                                             | 1/4      | 30                 |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 6                                                               | 31/3-2/4 | 103                |
| Primary School of Vounargo                                                                                                    | 3/4      | 78                 |
| “Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 7                                                               | 3-5/4    | 85                 |
| 1st High School of Trikala                                                                                                    | 4/4      | 50                 |
| 7th High School of Agrinio                                                                                                    | 4/4      | 40                 |

| Event/Organiser                                                                                                      | Dates          | No of Participants |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------|
| <b>Master's Degree Programme "Olympic Studies, Olympic Education, Organisation and Management of Olympic Events"</b> | <b>4/4-8/6</b> | <b>31</b>          |
| <b>"Experiencing the Olympic Values" Programme – School Visit No 8</b>                                               | <b>7-9/4</b>   | <b>96</b>          |
| Athens College                                                                                                       | 10-11/4        | 180                |
| High School of Axioupoli                                                                                             | 10/4           | 30                 |
| MV Gym                                                                                                               | 27/4           | 40                 |
| <b>"Experiencing the Olympic Values" Programme – School Visit No 9</b>                                               | <b>28-30/4</b> | <b>109</b>         |
| International Summer School on Inclusive Education                                                                   | 1-6/5          | 49                 |
| Kids' Athletics                                                                                                      | 7/5            |                    |
| <b>"Experiencing the Olympic Values" Programme – School Visit No 10</b>                                              | <b>7-9/5</b>   | <b>110</b>         |
| <b>18th International Session for NOAs' and NOCs' Delegates</b>                                                      | <b>10-15/5</b> | <b>150</b>         |
| Children's Olympic Games                                                                                             | 16/5           | 300                |
| European Fair Play Movement                                                                                          | 17-20/5        | 60                 |
| ResAlliance                                                                                                          | 21/5           |                    |
| Fullerton University                                                                                                 | 23-27/5        | 30                 |
| Spring Rheumatology Days (Eventure)                                                                                  | 23-25/5        | 50                 |
| 5th Elementary School of Preveza                                                                                     | 29/5           |                    |
| <b>65th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors</b>                                                      | <b>9-19/6</b>  | <b>187</b>         |
| I.M. Panagiotopoulos School                                                                                          | 11/6           | 133                |
| University of South Carolina                                                                                         | 17/6           | 33                 |
| IOAPA Session                                                                                                        | 21-27/6        | 36                 |
| MAiSI Summer School                                                                                                  | 22/6-6/7       | 50                 |
| International Parliamentary Day – 136th Anniversary of the Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU)                           | 30/6           | 100                |



| Event/Organiser                                                                                                      | Dates             | No of Participants |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------|
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 11</b>                                              | <b>30/6-2/7</b>   | <b>27</b>          |
| Olympism for Humanity (O4H) Academy                                                                                  | 1/7-6/7           | 21                 |
| <b>15th International Session for Educators of Higher Institutes of Physical Education</b>                           | <b>7-11/7</b>     | <b>37</b>          |
| <b>“Sport and Education Program: from Ancient Olympia to the Present”, Harvard University’s CHS</b>                  | <b>7-11/7</b>     | <b>55</b>          |
| ELIAMEP Summer Academy                                                                                               | 14-19/7           | 46                 |
| Summer School of GOALS Erasmus Mundus Master Programme                                                               | 14-18/7           | 36                 |
| <b>Hudson Global Scholars</b>                                                                                        | <b>23-26/7</b>    | <b>33</b>          |
| International Final Round of the Economics Olympiad 2025                                                             | 21-24/8           | 223                |
| International Olympiad of Humanoids                                                                                  | 29/8-2/9          | 160                |
| NOA of Colombia                                                                                                      | 6/9               | 6                  |
| Deutsche Schule Athen                                                                                                | 10-12/9           | 128                |
| Plenary of Greek Bar Associations                                                                                    | 11-14/9           | 110                |
| “Bougas” private school, Kalamata region (Hudson Global Scholars)                                                    | 18-20/9           | 34                 |
| <b>32nd International Seminar on Olympic Studies for Postgraduate Students</b>                                       | <b>21/9-9/10</b>  | <b>18</b>          |
| <b>Master’s Degree Programme "Olympic Studies, Olympic Education, Organisation and Management of Olympic Events"</b> | <b>21/9-22/11</b> | <b>28</b>          |
| <b>Harbin Institute of Technology Students</b>                                                                       | <b>24-25/9</b>    | <b>11</b>          |
| 3rd Primary School of Pyrgos                                                                                         | 26/9              | 150                |
| Avis                                                                                                                 | 30/9-1/10         | 93                 |
| 6th Primary School of Pyrgos                                                                                         | 2/10              | 162                |
| 12th International Sports Conference of the Panhellenic Sports Press Association                                     | 3-5/10            | 90                 |
| Olympia Forum IV                                                                                                     | 6-8/10            |                    |

| <b>Event/Organiser</b>                                                                         | <b>Dates</b>    | <b>No of Participants</b> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------|
| Scientific Event – Hellenic Society of Haematology                                             | 10-12/10        |                           |
| ACS Athens IB Retreat Trip                                                                     | 14-17/10        | 112                       |
| Sportschule im Olympiapark study trip (Erasmus+ programme)                                     | 14-16/10        | 40                        |
| Hellenic Red Cross educational trip                                                            | 17-19/10        | 52                        |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 12</b>                        | <b>20-22/10</b> | <b>118</b>                |
| High School of Chavari                                                                         | 24/10           | 40                        |
| MEMOS VI (Master exécutif en management des organisations sportives)                           | 26/10-5/11      | 31                        |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 13</b>                        | <b>29-31/10</b> | <b>109</b>                |
| Avgouleia-Linardatou School                                                                    | 1-2/11          | 95                        |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 14</b>                        | <b>3-5/11</b>   | <b>106</b>                |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 15</b>                        | <b>6-8/11</b>   | <b>90</b>                 |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 16</b>                        | <b>10-12/11</b> | <b>105</b>                |
| <b>Lighting of the Olympic Flame Ceremony for the 2026 Milano Cortina Winter Olympic Games</b> | <b>16-27/11</b> |                           |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 17</b>                        | <b>1-3/12</b>   | <b>104</b>                |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 18</b>                        | <b>4-6/12</b>   | <b>106</b>                |
| Department of Sports Management, Faculty of Sports Sciences, Halc University                   | 9-13/12         | 9                         |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 19</b>                        | <b>11-13/12</b> | <b>110</b>                |
| <b>“Experiencing the Olympic Values” Programme – School Visit No 20</b>                        | <b>13-15/12</b> | <b>110</b>                |



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